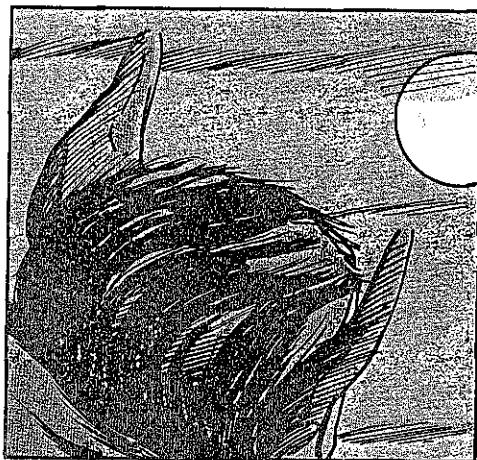
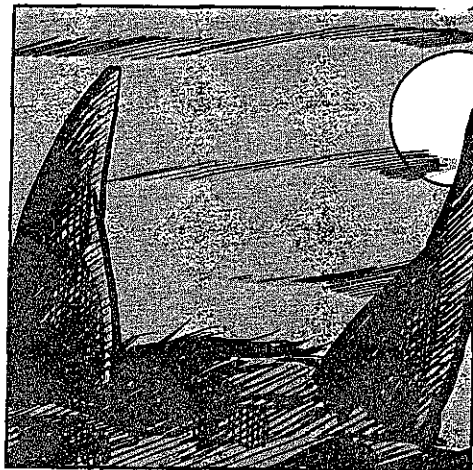
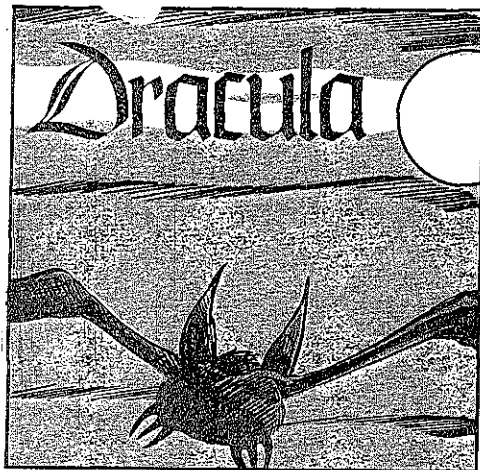




Veinot

Dracula

Hamilton Deane and John L. Balderston
Adapted from Bram Stoker's novel, *Dracula*

WEREWOLVES, VAMPIRES, BATS, the “undead” that walk in the night—these are the elements of the folk tales that have grown up around the legend of Count Dracula. The model for Dracula was a real person, a fifteenth century Romanian nobleman, much feared and hated. Although he never drank the blood of the living, he earned the name Vlad the Impaler because one of his favorite cruelties was to kill his enemies by impaling them on a wooden pole.

Using the material of the legends, Bram Stoker, in 1897, published his novel *Dracula*, destined to become a classic and probably the most famous horror story of all time. In *Dracula*, Stoker created a vampire who could, at will, assume the shape of a werewolf, a bat, or his centuries-old earthly form as a man. But Dracula is also a living, compelling dramatic presence in the story, an aristocratic, elegant nobleman whose power is difficult to resist.

In 1927, Hamilton Deane's dramatization of the story was presented in London, and since then has appeared numerous times and in various adaptations. The version here is the result of a collaboration between Deane and John L. Balderston. As a play, the story has had many revivals on the American stage; as a movie, it made Bela Lugosi famous in the 1930s. More

recently, Frank Langella won fame on stage and screen as the suave, intense, hypnotic count.

The extraordinary popularity of the novel and play has led to numerous spin-offs of television and movie vampires. None has achieved the sustained horror of the play you are about to read.

Vocabulary Preview

SANITARIUM (san-uh-TAIR-ee-um) an institution for the treatment of long-term diseases or mental illness

After six months of rest and treatment, she left the *sanitarium* completely cured.

MEDIEVAL (meed-ee-EE-vul) in the style of the Middle Ages (about 600 to 1450)

We visited a twelfth-century cathedral in the *medieval* Italian town.

TAPESTRY (TAP-ih-stree) a heavy, woven cloth with decorative designs and pictures, used as a wall hanging

A hand-woven *tapestry* on the wall of the palace showed a medieval hunting scene.

ASTUTE (uh-STOOT) having a shrewd mind

The townspeople selected their most *astute* citizen to represent them at the meeting.

INCISIVE (in-SY-siv) keen, sharp

Her *incisive* criticism of the movie made us see its weaknesses.

POSTERITY (po-STAIR-uh-tee) future generations

Although his work was not appreciated during his lifetime, he was sure that *posterity* would recognize him.

LOATHING (LOH-thing) strong dislike; disgust

He felt nothing but *loathing* when he remembered his captors and their ugly behavior.

LAIR (LAIR) the den or resting place of a wild beast

The lioness kept her cubs safe in the *lair*.

CUNNING (KUN-ing) craftiness; skill, especially at deceiving

He overcame his enemies with *cunning*, not physical strength.

DEFIANT (duh-FY-unt) openly disobedient

The *defiant* child was sent to her room.

ENTICE (en-TYS) tempt; lure

This saucer of milk will *entice* the kitten to come out of the tree.

Other Words You Will Need to Know

ANEMIA (uh-NEE-mee-uh) a blood disease which leaves its victims pale and weak

WOLFSBANE (WOOLFS-bayn) a poisonous yellow plant, found in Asia

CONVULSED (kun-VULST) upset to the point of shaking

OPPRESSIVE (uh-PRES-iv) harsh; hard to bear

LANGUID (LANG-gwid) without energy

REPULSION (ruh-PUL-shun) feeling of disgust

OCCULT (oh-KULT) relating to mystical or magical acts or beliefs

TRANSMUTE (tranz-MYOOT) change the form of

DEMATERIALIZATION (dee-muh-tir-ee-uh-lyz-AY-shun) disintegration; breaking apart

ABHORS (ab-HORZ) hates

STAKE (STAYK) a wooden stick with a sharp point at one end

PREPOSTEROUS (prih-POS-tur-us) senseless

MANIACAL (muh-NY-uh-kul) insane

AFFRONT (uh-FRUNT) insult

BENEFACTORS (BEN-uh-fak-turz) people who help

DISPENSATION (dis-pen-SAY-shun) special permission

HOST (HOHST) a wafer used in the Catholic church as a holy symbol

Characters

Miss Wells, maid

John Harker, betrothed to Lucy Seward

Dr. Seward, Director of a sanitarium

Abraham Van Helsing, doctor; friend of Dr. Seward

R. M. Renfield, patient at the sanitarium

Butterworth, attendant at sanitarium

Lucy Seward, Dr. Seward's daughter

Count Dracula

Setting

Act One

The library in Dr. Seward's Sanitarium, Purley, England

Act Two

Lucy's bedroom; following day

Act Three

SCENE 1

The library, 32 hours later

SCENE 2

A vault, just after sunrise

Dracula**ACT ONE**

The library on the ground floor of Dr. Seward's Sanitarium at Purley. Room is medieval, the walls are stone with vaulted ceiling supported by two stone pillars, but is comfortably furnished in modern style. Wooden paneling around walls. Tapestries hang on the wall. Medieval fireplace in wall Right. Fire burning. There is a couch Right Center, a large armchair Right. At Left, a desk with armchair back of it, a small chair to Right of desk. Double doors in the rear wall. Large double window across angle of room, Left rear, leading out into garden. The curtains are drawn. Door Downstage Left. Invisible sliding panel in bookcase rear wall Right.

Maid, an attractive young girl, enters, showing in John Harker. Harker is a young man of about twenty-five, handsome in appearance, a typical Englishman, but in manner direct, explosive, incisive and excitable.

HARKER. (Agitated.) You're sure Miss Lucy is no worse?

MAID. (Soothingly.) Just the same, sir.

(Dr. Seward comes in, Downstage Left. He is a psychiatrist of about fifty-five, intelligent, but a typical specialist who lives in a world of textbooks and patients, not a man of action or force of character. The Maid exits, closing doors.)

SEWARD. Oh! John.

HARKER. (As Seward extends hand.) Doctor Seward. What is it? Why have you sent for me?

SEWARD. My dear John. I told you in my wire there was nothing new.

HARKER. You said "no change, don't worry," but to "come at once."

SEWARD. (Approvingly.) And you lost no time.

HARKER. I jumped in the car and burned up the road from London. Oh, Doctor, surely there must be something more we can do for Lucy. I'd give my life gladly if it would save her.

SEWARD. I'm sure you would, my boy. You love her with the warm blood of youth, but don't forget I love my daughter, too. She's all I have. You must see that nothing medical science can suggest has been left undone.

HARKER. (Bitterly.) Medical science couldn't do much for Mina. Poor Mina.

SEWARD. Yes, poor Mina. She died after these same incredible symptoms that my Lucy has developed.

HARKER. My Lucy too.

SEWARD. Our Lucy, then.

(Wild, maniacal laugh is heard offstage left.)

HARKER. Good God, what was that?

SEWARD. (Sits at desk.) Only Renfield. A patient of mine.

HARKER. But you never keep violent patients here in your sanitarium. Lucy mustn't be compelled to listen to raving madmen.

SEWARD. I quite agree, and I'm going to have him sent away. Until just lately he was always quiet. I'll be sorry to lose him.

HARKER. What!

SEWARD. An unusual case. Zoophagous.

HARKER. What's that?

SEWARD. A life-eating maniac.

HARKER. What?

SEWARD. Yes, he thinks that by absorbing lives he can prolong his own life.

HARKER. Good Lord!

SEWARD. Catches flies and eats them. And by way of change, he feeds flies to spiders. Fattens them up. Then he eats the spiders.

HARKER. Good God, how disgusting. (Sits.) But tell me about Lucy. Why did you send for me?

SEWARD. Yesterday I wired to Holland for my old friend Van Helsing. He'll be here soon. The car has gone down to the station for him now. I'm going to turn Lucy's case over to him.

HARKER. Another specialist on anemia?

SEWARD. No, my boy, whatever this may be, it's not anemia, and this man, who speaks a dozen languages as well as his own, knows more about mysterious diseases than anyone alive.

HARKER. Heaven knows it's mysterious enough, but surely the symptoms are clear.

SEWARD. So were poor Mina's. Perfectly clear. (A dog howls at a distance. Other dogs take up the chorus far and near.) There they are, at it again, every dog for a mile around.

HARKER. (Crosses to window.) They seem howls of terror.

SEWARD. We've heard that chorus every night since Mina fell ill.

HARKER. When I was traveling in Russia, and the dogs in the village barked like that, the natives always said wolves were prowling about.

SEWARD. I hardly think you'll find wolves prowling around Purley, twenty miles from London.

HARKER. Yet your old house might be in a wilderness. (Looks out of win-

dow.) Nothing in sight except that place Carfax that Count Dracula has taken.

SEWARD. Your friend, the Count, came in again last evening.

HARKER. He's no friend of mine.

SEWARD. Don't say that. He knows that you and I gave our blood for Lucy as well as for Mina, and he's offered to undergo transfusion himself if we need another volunteer. (Sits on couch.)

HARKER. By Jove, that's sporting of him. I see I've misjudged him.

SEWARD. He seems genuinely interested in Lucy. If he were a young man I'd think . . .

HARKER. What!

SEWARD. But his whole attitude shows that it isn't that. We need sympathy in this house, John, and I'm grateful for it.

HARKER. So am I. Anyone who offers to help Lucy can have anything I've got.

SEWARD. Well, I think he does help Lucy. She always seems cheered up when he comes.

HARKER. That's fine. May I go to Lucy now?

SEWARD. (Rises.) We'll go together. (Bell rings off.) That must be Van Helsing. You go ahead and I'll come presently.

(Harker exits. Maid shows in Abraham Van Helsing, who enters briskly. Man of medium height, in his early fifties, with clean-shaven, astute face, shaggy gray eyebrows and a mass of gray hair which is brushed backward showing a high forehead. Dark, piercing eyes set far apart; nervous, alert manner; an air of resolution, clearly a man of resourceful action. incisive speech, always to the point; raps his words out sharply and quickly. Van Helsing carries small black bag.)

MAID. Professor Van Helsing.

SEWARD. (He and Van Helsing shake hands warmly as Maid goes out.) My dear Van Helsing, I can never repay you for this.

VAN HELSING. Were it only a patient of yours instead of your daughter, I would have come. You once rendered me a service.

SEWARD. Don't speak of that. You'd have done it for me. (Starts to ring.) Let me give you something to eat. (Stopped by Van Helsing's gesture.)

VAN HELSING. (Places bag on table back of couch.) I dined on the boat train. I do not waste time when there is work to do.

SEWARD. Ah, Van Helsing, you cast the old spell on me. I lean on you before you have been two minutes in my house.

VAN HELSING. You wrote of your daughter's symptoms. Tell me more of the other young lady, the one who died.

SEWARD. (*Shows Van Helsing to chair. Seward sits at desk.*) Poor Mina Weston. She was a girl just Lucy's age. They were inseparable. She was on a visit here when she fell ill. As I wrote you, she just grew weaker; day by day she wasted away. But there were no anemic symptoms; her blood was normal when analyzed.

VAN HELSING. You said you performed transfusion.

SEWARD. Yes, Sir William Briggs ordered that. (*Baring forearm.*) You see this mark? Well, Lucy herself, and her fiancée, John Harker, gave their blood as well.

VAN HELSING. So . . . Three transfusions . . . And the effect?

SEWARD. She rallied after each. The color returned to her cheeks, but the next morning she would be pale and weak again. She complained of *bad dreams*. Ten days ago we found her in a stupor from which nothing could rouse her. She . . . died.

VAN HELSING. And . . . the other symptoms?

SEWARD. None, except those two little marks on the throat that I wrote you about.

VAN HELSING. And which perhaps brought me here so quickly. What were they like?

SEWARD. Just two little white dots with red centers. (*Van Helsing nods grimly.*) We decided she must have run a safety pin through the skin of her throat, trying in her delirium to fasten a scarf or shawl.

VAN HELSING. Perhaps. And your daughter's symptoms are the same?

SEWARD. Precisely. She too speaks of *bad dreams*. Van Helsing, you've lived in the tropics. May this not be something alien to our medical experience in England?

VAN HELSING. (*Grimly.*) It may indeed, my friend.

(*Laugh is heard from behind curtain at window. Van Helsing rises, followed by Seward, who crosses to window and draws curtains. Renfield is standing there. Repulsive youth, face distorted, shifty eyes, tousled hair.*)

SEWARD. (*Astounded, drawing Renfield into room.*) Renfield. How did you . . . ?

VAN HELSING. Who is this man?

SEWARD. (*Crosses to bell; rings.*) One of my patients. This is gross carelessness.

VAN HELSING. Did you hear us talking?

RENFIELD. Words . . . words . . . words . . .

SEWARD. Come, come, Renfield, you know you mustn't wander about this way. How did you get out of your room?

RENFIELD. (*Laughs.*) Wouldn't you like to know?

SEWARD. How are the flies? (*To Van Helsing.*) Mr. Renfield makes a hobby of eating flies. I'm afraid you eat spiders, too, sometimes. Don't you, Renfield?

RENFIELD. Will you walk into my parlor, said the spider to the fly. Excuse me, Doctor, you have not introduced me to your friend.

SEWARD. (*Reprovingly.*) Come, come, Renfield.

VAN HELSING. Humor him.

(*Enter Maid.*)

SEWARD. Tell the Attendant to come here at once.

MAID. Yes, sir. (*Exits.*)

SEWARD. Oh, very well. Professor Van Helsing, Mr. Renfield, a patient of mine.

(*Van Helsing steps toward him. They shake hands. Van Helsing rubs Renfield's fingers with his thumb and Renfield jerks hand away.*)

RENFIELD. Ah, who does not know of Van Helsing! Your work, sir, in investigating certain obscure diseases, not altogether unconnected with forces and powers that the ignorant herd do not believe exist, has won you a position that posterity will recognize.

(*Enter Attendant dressed in uniform. He starts at seeing Renfield, then looks at Seward sheepishly.*)

SEWARD. (*As severely as his mild nature permits.*) Butterworth, you have let your patient leave his room again.

ATTENDANT. No, really, sir, I locked the door on him, and I've got the key in my pocket now.

SEWARD. But this is the second time. Only last night you let him escape and he tried to break into Count Dracula's house across the grounds.

ATTENDANT. He didn't get out the door this time, sir, and it's a drop of thirty feet out of the windows. (*Crosses to Renfield.*) He's just an eel. Now you come with me. (*As they start toward door; holds Renfield by coat collar and right arm.*)

SEWARD. Renfield, if this happens again you will get no more sugar to spread out for your flies.

RENFIELD. (*Drawing himself up.*) What do I care for flies . . . now? (*Attendant gives Van Helsing a look.*) Flies. Flies are but poor things. (*As he speaks he follows with his eyes a fly. Attendant sees fly too; releases Renfield indulgently. With a sweep of his hand he catches fly, holds closed hand to ear as if listening to buzz of fly as he crosses a few steps, then carries it to his mouth. Then seeing them watching him, releases it quickly.*) A low form of life. Beneath my notice, I don't care a pin about flies.

ATTENDANT. Oh, don't you? Any more of your tricks and I'll take your new spider away.

RENFIELD. (*Babbles; on knees.*) Oh, no, no! Please, dear Mr. Butterworth, please leave me my spider. He's getting so nice and fat. When he's had another dozen flies he'll be just right, just right. (*Gives little laugh. Rubs hands together, then catches fly and makes gesture of eating.*)

VAN HELSING. Come, Mr. Renfield, what makes you want to eat flies?

RENFIELD. (*Rises.*) The wings of a fly, my dear sir, typify the aerial powers of the psychic faculties.

SEWARD. (*To attendant, wearily.*) Butterworth, take him away.

VAN HELSING. One moment, my friend. (*To Renfield.*) And the spiders?

RENFIELD. (*Impressively.*) Professor Van Helsing, can you tell me why that one great spider lived for centuries in the tower of the old Spanish church—and grew and grew? He never ate, but he drank, and he drank. He would come down and drink the oil of all the church lamps.

SEWARD. (*To attendant.*) Butterworth.

RENFIELD. One moment, Doctor Seward . . . (*Van Helsing gets wolfsbane from bag on table.*) I want you to send me away, now, tonight, in a straitjacket. Chain me so I can't escape. This is a sanitarium, not a lunatic asylum. This is no place for me. My cries will disturb Miss Lucy, who is ill. They will give your daughter *bad dreams*, Doctor Seward, *bad dreams*.

SEWARD. (*Soothingly.*) We'll see about all this in the morning. (*Nods to Attendant, who moves toward Renfield.*)

VAN HELSING. Why are you so anxious to go?

RENFIELD. (*Crosses to Van Helsing; hesitates, then with gesture of decision.*) I'll tell you. Not that fool Seward. He wouldn't understand. But you . . . (*A large bat dashes against window. Renfield turns to the window, holds out his hands and gibbers.*) No, no, no, I wasn't going to say anything . . .

(*Attendant crosses up; watches Renfield.*)

SEWARD. What was that?

RENFIELD. (*Looks out window, then turns.*) It was a bat, gentlemen. Only a bat! Do you know that in some islands of the Eastern seas there are bats which hang on trees all night? And when the heat is stifling and sailors sleep on the deck in those harbors, in the morning they are found dead men . . . white, even as Miss Mina was.

SEWARD. What do you know of Miss Mina? (*Pause.*) Take him to his room!

VAN HELSING. (*To Seward.*) Please! (*To Renfield.*) Why are you so anxious to be moved from here?

RENFIELD. To save my soul.

VAN HELSING. Yes?

RENFIELD. Oh, you'll get nothing more out of me than that. And I'm not sure I hadn't rather stay. After all, what is my soul good for? Is not . . . (*Turns to window.*) . . . what I am to receive worth the loss of my soul?

SEWARD. (*Lightly.*) What's got him thinking about souls? Have you the souls of those flies and spiders on your conscience?

RENFIELD. (*Puts fingers in his ears, shuts eyes, distorts face.*) I forbid you to plague me about souls! I don't want their souls. All I want is their life. The blood is the life.

VAN HELSING. So?

RENFIELD. That's in the Bible. What use are souls to me? (*To Van Helsing.*) I couldn't eat them or dr . . . (*Breaks off suddenly.*)

VAN HELSING. Or drink . . . (*Holding wolfsbane under his nose, Renfield's face becomes convulsed with rage and loathing. He leaps back.*)

RENFIELD. You know too much to live, Van Helsing! (*He suddenly lunges at Van Helsing. Seward and Attendant shout at the attack and as they drag Renfield to door he stops struggling and says clearly:*)

RENFIELD. I'll go quietly. (*Seward lets go of him.*) I warned you to send me away, Doctor Seward. If you don't, you must answer for my soul before the judgment seat of God!

(*Renfield and Attendant exit. Wild laughter can be heard off. Van Helsing puts wolfsbane in bag as Seward closes door.*)

SEWARD. My friend, you're not hurt?

VAN HELSING. No.

SEWARD. My deepest apologies. You'll think my place shockingly managed.

(*Van Helsing waves apology aside with impatient gesture.*)

What was your herb that excited him so?

VAN HELSING. Wolfsbane. *(A little look out of window as he crosses.)*

SEWARD. Wolfsbane? What's that? I thought I knew all the drugs.

VAN HELSING. It grows only in the wilds of Central Russia.

SEWARD. But why did you bring it with you?

VAN HELSING. It is a form of preventive medicine.

SEWARD. Well, we live and learn. I never heard of it.

VAN HELSING. Seward, I want you to have that lunatic securely watched.

SEWARD. Anything you say, Professor Van Helsing, but it's my Lucy I want you to look after first.

VAN HELSING. I want to keep this man under observation.

SEWARD. *(Annoyed and hurt.)* An interesting maniac, no doubt, but surely you'll see my daughter.

VAN HELSING. I must see the records of his case.

SEWARD. But Doctor . . .

VAN HELSING. Do you think I have forgotten why I am here?

SEWARD. *(As they start to go out left.)* Forgive me. Of course I'll show you the records, but I don't understand why you're so curious about Renfield, because in your vast experience . . .

(They exit. The room is empty for a few seconds; then Lucy enters, supported by Harker. She is a beautiful girl of twenty, clad in filmy white dressing gown, her face unnaturally pale. She walks with difficulty. Round her throat is wound a scarf. She crosses to desk and leans on it as Harker closes door.)

HARKER. Why, I thought they were here, Lucy.

LUCY. John, do you think this new man will be any better than the others?

HARKER. *(Moving her to the couch.)* I'm sure he will. Anyway, Lucy, now that I'm back I'm going to stay with you till you get over this thing.

LUCY. *(Delighted.)* Oh, John. But can you? Your work in town?

HARKER. *(Seating her, then sitting next to her.)* You come first.

LUCY. *(A change comes over her.)* I . . . don't think you'd better stay, John. *(A look about room.)* Sometimes . . . I feel that I want to be alone.

HARKER. My dear. How can you say that you don't want me with you when you're so ill? You love me, don't you? *(Taking her hand.)*

LUCY. *(Affectionately.)* Yes, John, with all my soul.

HARKER. Just as soon as you're well enough I'm going to take you away. We'll be married next month. We won't wait till June. We'll stretch that honeymoon month to three months and the house will be ready in July.

LUCY. *(Overjoyed.)* John, you think we could?

HARKER. Of course, why not? My mother wanted us to wait, but she'll understand, and I want to get you away. *(Starts to kiss her. She shudders as he does so.)* Why do you shrink when I kiss you? You're so cold, Lucy, always so cold . . . now . . .

LUCY. *(With tenderness but no hint of passion.)* Forgive me, dear. I am yours, all yours. *(Clings to him. He embraces her. She sinks back.)* Oh John, I'm so tired . . . so tired.

(Seward and Van Helsing return.)

SEWARD. Lucy dear, this is my old friend, Professor Van Helsing.

(She sits up; extends her hand to him.)

VAN HELSING. My dear Miss Seward, *(He kisses Lucy's hand.)* you don't remember poor old Van Helsing. I knew you when you were a little girl. So high, and now what charm, what beauty. A little pale, yes, but we will bring the roses back to the cheeks.

LUCY. You were so kind to come, Professor.

VAN HELSING. And this, no doubt, is the fortunate young man you are to marry?

SEWARD. Yes, John Harker, Professor.

HARKER. Look here, Professor. I'm not going to get in your way, but if Doctor Seward will have me I'm going to make him give me a bed here until Lucy gets over this thing. *(Turns to Seward.)* It's absolute hell, being away in London, and of course I can't do any work.

SEWARD. You're most welcome to stay, my boy.

VAN HELSING. Indeed, yes. I should have asked you to stay. I may need you. *(Takes chair from desk to left of couch; turns to Lucy.)* Now lie back, so. *(Examines her eyelids carefully and feels her pulse.)* And now tell me when did this, this weakness first come upon you? *(Sits, after examining eyelids; looks at her gums, examines tips of fingernails, then takes out watch as he feels her pulse.)*

LUCY. Two nights after poor Mina was buried I had . . . a bad dream.

VAN HELSING. *(Releases pulse, after looking at watch.)* A bad dream? Tell me about it.

LUCY. I remember hearing dogs barking before I went to sleep. The air seemed oppressive. I left the reading lamp lit by my bed, but when the dream came there seemed to come a mist in the room.

VAN HELSING. Was the window open?

LUCY. Yes, I always sleep with my window open.

VAN HELSING. Oh, of course, you're English. *(Laughs.)* We Continentals are not so particular about fresh air. And then . . .

LUCY. The mist seemed so thick I could just see the lamp by my bed, a tiny spark in the fog, and then . . . *(Hysterically.)* I saw two red eyes staring at me and a livid white face looking down on me out of the mist. It was horrible, horrible!

(Harker makes move toward her. Van Helsing stops him by a gesture.)

VAN HELSING. There, there. *(Soothingly, taking her hands from her face.)* Go on, please.

LUCY. *(Gives little start when Van Helsing touches her hands. Looks at Harker and starts; and at Seward and starts, then at Van Helsing and relaxes.)* The next morning my maid could scarcely wake me. I felt weak and languid. Some part of my life seemed to have gone from me.

VAN HELSING. There have been other such dreams?

LUCY. Nearly every night since then has come the mist . . . the red eyes and that awful face.

(She puts hands to her face again. Van Helsing soothes her, "There, there, now.")

SEWARD. We've tried transfusion twice. Each time she recovered her strength.

LUCY. But then would come another dream. And now I dread the night. I know it seems absurd, Professor, but please don't laugh at me.

VAN HELSING. I'm not likely to laugh.

(Gently, without answering, he unwinds scarf from her throat. She puts hand up to stop him and cries, "No, no." A look at Harker when her neck is bare. As Van Helsing does so he starts, then quickly opens small black bag on table and returns with magnifying glass; examines two small marks on throat. Lucy with eyes closed. Controlling himself with difficulty, Van Helsing puts magnifying glass back in bag, closes it, puts back chair by desk.)

And how long have you had these little marks on your throat?

(Seward and Harker start violently and come to couch. They look at each other in horror.)

LUCY. Since . . . that first morning.

HARKER. Lucy, why didn't you tell us?

SEWARD. Lucy, you've worn that scarf around your throat to hide them!

(Lucy makes convulsive clutch at throat.)

VAN HELSING. Do not press her. Do not excite her. *(To Lucy.)* Well?

LUCY. *(Constrained; to Seward and Harker.)* I was afraid they'd worry you, for I knew that . . . Mina had them.

VAN HELSING. *(With assumed cheerfulness.)* Quite right, Miss Lucy, quite right. They're nothing, and old Van Helsing will see that these dreams trouble you no more.

MAID. *(Appears at door.)* Count Dracula.

(Dracula enters. He is a tall, mysterious man of about fifty. Polished and distinguished. Continental in appearance and manner. Lucy registers attraction to Dracula.)

SEWARD. Ah, good evening, Count.

DRACULA. Gentlemen. *(He bows to men; then goes to the couch and bows in courtly fashion.)* Miss Seward, how are you? You are looking more yourself this evening.

(Lucy registers thrill. Alternate moods of attraction and repulsion, unaccountable to herself, affect Lucy in Dracula's presence. But this should be suggested subtly.)

LUCY. *(Quite natural.)* I feel better already, Count, now that father's old friend has come to help me.

(Dracula turns to Van Helsing. Lucy looks up at Dracula, recoils, and turns to Harker.)

SEWARD. Count Dracula, Professor Van Helsing.

(The two men bow.)

DRACULA. A most distinguished scientist, whose name we know even in the wilds of Transylvania. *(To Seward.)* But I interrupt a consultation.

SEWARD. Not at all, Count. It's good of you to come, and we appreciate your motives.

HARKER. Doctor Seward has just told me of your offer, and I can't thank you enough.

DRACULA. It is nothing. I should be grateful to be permitted to help Miss Lucy in any way.

LUCY. But you do, Count. I look forward to your visits. They seem to make me better.

VAN HELSING. And so I arrive to find a rival in the field.

DRACULA. *(Crosses to Lucy.)* You encourage me, Miss Seward, to make them more frequent, as I should like to.

LUCY. *(Looking at him fixedly.)* I am always glad to see you.

DRACULA. Ah, but you have been lonely here. And my efforts to amuse you with our old tales will no longer have the same success, now that you have Professor Van Helsing with you, and especially now that Mr. Harker is to remain here.

HARKER. How did you know I was going to stay, Count?

DRACULA. (*Little start.*) Can the gallant lover ask such a question? I inferred it, my friend.

HARKER. You're right. Nothing is going to shift me now until Lucy's as fit as a fiddle again.

DRACULA. Nothing?

LUCY. Please come as before, Count, won't you?

(*Dracula bows to her; kisses her hand. Van Helsing meanwhile has been talking to Maid.*)

VAN HELSING. You understand, you will not answer bells. She must not be alone for a single moment under any circumstances, you understand.

(*As Dracula crosses to below desk, Lucy leans toward him, extends her hand, then recovers herself. Van Helsing registers that he sees her look at Dracula.*)

MAID. Yes, sir.

VAN HELSING. (*To Lucy.*) Good. Your maid will take you to your room. Try to rest for a little, while I talk to your father.

(*Maid comes to couch to get Lucy. Pause, as Lucy looks at Dracula.*)

SEWARD. Wells, remember, don't leave her alone for a moment.

MAID. Oh, no, sir.

(*Lucy exchanges a long look with Dracula as Maid takes her out.*)

DRACULA. Professor Van Helsing, so you have come from the land of the tulip, to cure the nervous prostration of this charming girl. I wish you all the success.

VAN HELSING. Thank you, Count.

DRACULA. Do I appear officious, Doctor Seward? I am a lonely man. You are my only neighbors when I am here at Carfax, and your trouble has touched me greatly.

SEWARD. Count, I am more grateful for your sympathy than I can say.

VAN HELSING. You, like myself, are a stranger in England, Count?

DRACULA. Yes, but I love England and the great London, so different from my own Transylvania, where there are so few people and so little opportunity.

VAN HELSING. Opportunity, Count?

DRACULA. For my investigations, Professor.

SEWARD. I hope you haven't regretted buying that old ruin across there?

DRACULA. Oh, Carfax is not a ruin. The dust was somewhat deep, but we are used to dust in Transylvania.

HARKER. You plan to remain in England, Count?

DRACULA. I think so, my friend. The walls of my castle are broken, and the shadows are many, and I am the last of my race.

HARKER. It's a lonely spot you've chosen, Carfax.

DRACULA. It is, and when I hear the dogs howling far and near I think myself back in my Castle Dracula with its broken battlements.

HARKER. Ah, the dogs howl there when there are wolves around, don't they?

DRACULA. They do, my friend. And they howl here as well, although there are no wolves. But you wish to consult the anxious father and the great specialist. May I read a book in the study? I am so anxious to hear what the Professor says and to learn if I can be of any help.

SEWARD. By all means, Count. (*Dracula bows; exits. Seward watches him leave. Dogs howl offstage.*) Very kind of Dracula, with his untimely friendliness, but now what about my daughter?

HARKER. Yes, Professor, what do you think is the matter with Lucy?

VAN HELSING. (*Crosses to window, looks out. Long pause before he speaks.*) Your patient, that interesting Renfield, does not like the smell of wolfsbane.

SEWARD. Good Heavens. What has that got to do with Lucy?

VAN HELSING. Perhaps nothing.

HARKER. In God's name, Professor, is there anything unnatural or occult about this business?

SEWARD. Occult? Van Helsing! Oh . . .

VAN HELSING. Ah, Seward, let me remind you that the superstitions of today are the scientific facts of tomorrow. Science can now transmute the electron, the basis of all matter, into energy, and what is that but the dematerialization of matter? Yet dematerialization has been known and practiced in India for centuries. In Java I myself have seen things.

SEWARD. My dear old friend, you can't have filled up your fine old brain with Eastern moonshine.

VAN HELSING. Moonshine?

SEWARD. But anyway, come now, what about my daughter?

VAN HELSING. Ah! Seward, if you won't listen to what will be harder to believe than any Eastern moonshine, if you won't forget your textbooks . . . keep an open mind, then, Seward, your daughter's life may pay for your pig-headedness.

HARKER. Go on, go on, Professor!

SEWARD. I am listening.

VAN HELSING. Then I must ask you to listen calmly to what I am going to say. Sit down. (*Van Helsing crosses to window; closes curtains. Seward and Harker exchange glances, then both look at Van Helsing as they sit.*) You have both heard the legends of Central Europe, about the Werewolf, the Vampires?

SEWARD. You mean ghosts, who suck the blood of the living?

VAN HELSING. If you wish to call them ghosts. I call them the undead.

HARKER. (*Quickly.*) For God's sake, man, are you suggesting that Mina, and now Lucy . . .

SEWARD. (*Interrupting.*) Of course, I have read these horrible folk tales of the Middle Ages, Van Helsing, but I know you better than to suppose . . .

VAN HELSING. (*Interrupting.*) That I believe them? I do believe them.

SEWARD. (*Incredulously.*) You mean to tell us that vampires actually exist and . . . and that Mina and Lucy have been attacked by one?

VAN HELSING. Your English doctors would all laugh at such a theory. Your police, your public would laugh. (*Impressively.*) *The strength of the vampire is that people will not believe in him.*

SEWARD. (*Shaking head.*) Is this the help you bring us?

VAN HELSING. (*Much moved.*) Do not despise it.

HARKER. (*To Seward.*) Doctor, this case has stumped all your specialists. (*To Van Helsing.*) Go on, Professor.

VAN HELSING. Vampires are rare. Nature abhors them, the forces of good combine to destroy them, but a few of these creatures have lived on for centuries.

HARKER. (*Excited.*) What is a vampire?

VAN HELSING. A vampire, my friend, is a man or a woman who is dead and yet not dead. A thing that lives after its death by drinking the blood of the living. It must have blood or it dies. Its power lasts only from sunset to sunrise. During the hours of the day it must rest in the earth in which it was buried. But, during the night, it has the power to prey upon the living. (*Incredulous move from Seward.*) My friend, you are thinking you will have to put me amongst your patients?

SEWARD. Van Helsing, I don't know what to think but I confess I simply can't follow you.

HARKER. What makes you think that Lucy has been attacked by such a creature?

VAN HELSING. (*From now on dominating them.*) Doctor Seward's written account of these ladies' symptoms at once aroused my suspicion. Anemia? The blood of three people was forced into the veins of Miss Mina. Yet she died from loss of blood. Where did it go? Had your specialist any answer? The vampire attacks the throat. He leaves two little wounds, white with red centers. (*Harker rises slowly.*) Seward, you wrote me of those two marks on Miss Mina's throat. An accident with a safety pin, you said. So I thought, I suspected, I did not know, but I came on the instant, and what do I find? These same wounds on Miss Lucy's throat. Another safety pin, Doctor Seward?

SEWARD. Do you mean to say that you've built up all this nightmare out of a safety pin? It's true I can't make out why she hid those marks from us.

VAN HELSING. I could tell you that.

SEWARD. (*Pause.*) What! I don't believe it. Of course Lucy's trouble can't be that.

HARKER. I do believe it. This theory accounts for all the facts that nobody has been able to explain. We'll take her away where this thing can't get at her.

VAN HELSING. She will not want to go.

SEWARD. What!

VAN HELSING. If you force her, the shock may be fatal.

HARKER. But why won't she go if we tell her that her life depends on it?

VAN HELSING. Because the victim of the vampire becomes his creature, linked to him in life and after death.

SEWARD. (*Incredulous, shocked; rises.*) Professor, this is too much!

HARKER. Will Lucy become an unclean thing, a demon?

VAN HELSING. Yes, Harker. Now will you help me?

HARKER. Yes, anything. Tell me what to do.

VAN HELSING. It is dangerous work. Our lives are at stake, but so is Miss Lucy's life, so is her soul. We must stamp out this monster.

HARKER. How can we stamp it out now?

VAN HELSING. This undead thing lies helpless by day in the earth or tomb in which it was buried.

SEWARD. A corpse, in a coffin?

VAN HELSING. A corpse, if you like, but a living corpse, sustained by the blood of the living. If we can find its earth home, a stake driven through the heart destroys the vampire. But this is our task. In such a case the police, all the powers of society, are as helpless as the doctors. What bars or chains can hold a creature who can turn into a wolf or a bat?

HARKER. A wolf! Doctor Seward, those dogs howling! I told you they howl that way in Russia when wolves are about. And a bat, Renfield said there was a bat.

SEWARD. Well. What of it?

VAN HELSING. (*Reflectively.*) Your friend Renfield does not like the smell of wolfsbane.

SEWARD. But what in the world has your wolfsbane to do with all this?

VAN HELSING. A vampire cannot stand the smell of wolfsbane.

HARKER. You suspect that lunatic?

VAN HELSING. I suspect no one and everyone. Tell me, who is this Count Dracula?

SEWARD. Dracula? We really know very little about him.

HARKER. When I was in Transylvania I heard of Castle Dracula. A famous Voivode Dracula who fought the Turks lived there centuries ago.

VAN HELSING. I will make inquiries by telegraph. No, but after all this Thing must be English. Or at least have died here. His lair must be near enough to this house for him to get back there before sunrise. (*To Seward.*) Oh, my friend, I have only the old beliefs with which to fight this monster that has the strength of twenty men, perhaps the accumulated wisdom and cunning of centuries.

HARKER. This all seems a nightmare. But I'm with you, Professor.

VAN HELSING. And you, Doctor Seward?

SEWARD. It all seems preposterous to me. But everyone else has failed. The case is in your hands at present.

VAN HELSING. (*Sternly.*) I need allies, not neutrals.

SEWARD. Very well, then, do what you will.

VAN HELSING. Good. Then bring your daughter here.

SEWARD. What are you going to do?

VAN HELSING. To set a trap. Miss Lucy is the bait.

HARKER. We can't let you do that!

VAN HELSING. There's no other way. I believe this Thing knows that I plan to protect Miss Lucy. This will put it on its guard and the first moment she is alone it will no doubt try to get at her, for a vampire must have blood or its life in death ceases.

HARKER. No, I forbid this.

SEWARD. She's my daughter, and I consent. We'll show the Professor he's mistaken.

HARKER. You allow it only because you don't believe, and I do believe. Doctor, I've heard that lunatic laugh; life-eating, you said he was, and you subject Lucy to that risk.

VAN HELSING. (*Interrupting harshly.*) I must be master here or I can do nothing! I must know in what form this Thing comes before I can plan how to stamp it out. Bring your daughter here.

(*Seward turns and sees Harker looking at him; stares at Harker. There is a short pause, then Harker reluctantly exits. Seward follows him. Van Helsing thinks a moment, then looks about, noting the positions of doors, furniture, etc. He then turns out lights. The room is dark except for the firelight. Van Helsing moves into firelight, looks at couch, then walks back to door and turns, looking at couch, satisfying himself that the light from the fire is sufficient to see anything that happens. Opens curtains. Suddenly, the double doors open sharply and Van Helsing starts violently; the Attendant enters.*)

ATTENDANT. Beg pardon, sir. Is Doctor Seward here?

VAN HELSING. What do you want with him?

ATTENDANT. Old Flycatcher's escaped again, sir.

VAN HELSING. Escaped, how?

ATTENDANT. Out of the window. The door's still locked and I was in the corridor all the while. It's a drop of thirty feet to the stone flagging. That loonie's a flyin' squirrel he is.

VAN HELSING. (*Commandingly.*) Say nothing to Doctor Seward at present. Nothing, do you hear? Now go.

(*Attendant exits. Van Helsing switches on lights again. Enter Lucy, supported by Harker and Seward.*)

LUCY. Oh! Oh!

SEWARD. Lucy, you have nothing to fear.

(*They take her to the couch.*)

VAN HELSING. I want you to lie down here, my dear.

LUCY. But, Doctor . . .

VAN HELSING. You trust me, do you not? (*She smiles weakly at him; nods.*

They place her on the couch.) I want you to lie here for just a little.

LUCY. But I am so frightened.

VAN HELSING. Make your mind passive. Try not to think. Sleep if you can.

LUCY. I dare not sleep. It is when I sleep . . .

(Harker takes her hand.)

VAN HELSING. *(Arranging her on the couch, head on pillows, soothingly.)* I know, my dear. I know. I am going to cure you, with God's help.

LUCY. Oh, but Father. . . .

SEWARD. You must do as the Professor says. Come, Harker.

VAN HELSING. Come, Harker.

(Van Helsing leads Seward to the door. Seward exits. Harker lingers and Van Helsing calls him. Van Helsing switches off lights as he and Harker go out. No movement. Lucy closes her eyes. Low howl is heard outside, howl of a wolf. It is followed by a distant barking of dogs. Firelight grows dimmer. Dracula's hand appears from back of couch, then his face. Lucy screams; swoons. Harker and Seward are heard offstage.)

HARKER. Lucy! Lucy!

SEWARD. Professor, what is it?

(Van Helsing enters, followed by Seward and Harker. Van Helsing switches on lights. They are just in front of door as a bat flies in the room from window to center, then out of the window.)

VAN HELSING. You saw?

SEWARD. What was that?

HARKER. Lucy, Lucy, speak to me!

VAN HELSING. Take her to her room, Harker, quickly.

(Harker carries Lucy to door as Dracula enters. He looks about, his glance taking in everyone.)

DRACULA. *(Mildly, sympathetically.)* The patient is better, I hope?

(Renfield gives a wild laugh offstage right. Van Helsing, Seward and Harker turn. Renfield gives a second wild laugh.)

CURTAIN

Act I

1. Before Count Dracula even appears onstage, the playwrights prepare the audience for the presence of a vampire. How do these events serve to alert the viewer?
 - (a) Seward tells Harker that Renfield has always been a quiet patient. Recently he has become wild and uncontrollable.
 - (b) Ever since Mina became ill, the dogs in the village have been howling as if in terror, as though wolves were present.
 - (c) After each blood transfusion, Mina grew stronger, but in the morning she was pale again and showed two little marks on the throat.Can you think of any other clues the writers provide?
2. Lucy appears with a scar around her throat. What is she hiding? Who else had a similar injury?
3. Renfield is an inmate of the sanitarium because of a strange illness. What is it? Why does it make him particularly susceptible to Dracula's power?
4. Several times a bat appears, trying to fly into the window. What does its purpose seem to be?

Building Vocabulary

The following sentences are based on the play. Decide which of the words following the sentences best fits each blank. Write your answers on a separate sheet of paper.

1. The action of the play takes place in Dr. Seward's _____, a place generally more restful than it is during the events of this drama.
2. The building is very old, dating back to _____ times; its wooden, paneled walls decorated with hanging _____.
3. Dr. Van Helsing has an alert manner and sharp _____ speech, always to the point.
4. Professor Van Helsing turns to the power of religion rather than to the forces of the _____ to subdue Dracula.
5. Dracula conceals his _____ with great _____.
6. Dracula stares at the cross with _____.
7. Van Helsing's investigations win him a position that _____ will recognize.
8. The promise of insects to eat is enough to _____ Renfield to work for Dracula.

occult	cunning	loathing	posterity
lair	medieval	sanitarium	tapestries
wolfbane	incisive	entice	

ACT TWO

Lucy's bedroom. Window Right rear, closed but curtains open. Chairs, small table with toilet articles on it by window. Couch against wall up Left Center. Mirror on wall. Small stand, with flowers in vase, near couch. Doors, Right, leading into bedroom, Left, leading into hall. Arch Left Center.

The next evening.

Dogs howling. As curtain rises, Maid enters from bedroom, glances up at window over her left shoulder, takes a few steps, looks back over right shoulder, then to couch and takes newspaper. Sits on couch; reads newspaper. As she turns a page, Attendant knocks on hall door.

MAID. *(Starts.)* Who is that?

ATTENDANT. *(Enters; smiles at her.)* Excuse me, Miss. Did you happen to have seen anything of the Guv'ner's pet looney? He's out again, he is.

MAID. *(Holding paper.)* And what would he be doing here? You'll not hold your job, you won't, if you can't keep that man safe and sound. Why, he gets out every night. *(She crosses toward bedroom door.)*

ATTENDANT. Don't go, miss.

MAID. Miss Lucy's asked for the evening paper.

(Maid smiles as she goes off; indicates speedy return. Attendant looks out of window and then looks under couch. Maid returns. Her line comes just as Attendant bends over, causing him to jump back, frightened.)

MAID. Well, have you found him?

ATTENDANT. No, I haven't. *(Confidentially.)* And I'll tell you, Miss, this job is gettin' on my nerves.

MAID. Your nerves? And what about my nerves? Isn't it enough to have dogs howling every night and foreign counts bobbing up out of the floor, and Miss Lucy taking on the way she does, with everybody having their veins drained of blood for her, and this Dutch Sherlock Holmes with the X-ray eyes about, without you letting that Renfield loose?

ATTENDANT. *(Grieved.)* I haven't let him loose. Just now I hears a noise like a wolf howling. I opens his door with me key, and what do I see but his legs goin' through the window as though he was goin' to climb down that smooth wall. He ain't human, he ain't.

MAID. Climb down the wall?

ATTENDANT. *(Gloomily.)* I don't expect no one to believe it, but I seen it, and what's more, I grabbed hold of his feet, I did.

MAID. *(Laughs unbelievably.)* Climbing down, head first, like a bat?

DRACULA. (*Winningly.*) I can remove this pain.

MAID. I don't understand, sir.

DRACULA. Such pains yield readily to suggestion.

MAID. (*Raises arm slightly to shield herself.*) Excuse me, sir, but if it's hypnotism you mean, I'd rather have the pain.

DRACULA. Ah, you think of hypnotism as an ugly waving of arms and many passes. That is not my method. (*As he speaks he gestures quietly with his left hand and she stares at him, fascinated. Placing his left thumb against her forehead, he stares straight into her eyes. She makes a feeble effort to remove his hand, then remains still. He now speaks coldly; turns her face front before speaking.*) What is given can be taken away. From now on you have no pain. And you have no will of your own. Do you hear me?

MAID. (*Murmurs.*) I hear you.

DRACULA. When you awake you will not remember what I say. Doctor Seward ordered you today to sleep with your mistress every night in the same bed because of her bad dreams. Is it not so?

MAID. (*Murmurs.*) Yes, Master.

DRACULA. Your mistress is threatened by horror and by death, but I will save her. A man whose will is at cross purposes with mine has come to this house. I will crush him. Receive your orders. You hear me?

MAID. Yes, Master.

DRACULA. Hear and obey. From now on you will carry out any suggestion that reaches you from my brain instantly without question. When I will you to do a thing it shall be done. My call will reach you soon.

(*Green spot dims out slowly. Dracula exits through window. Lights come on. Dogs howl outside. Maid looks up at window as Van Helsing enters left. She starts when door shuts.*)

VAN HELSING. (*His face is paler. He looks drawn and weak. He carries box tied with string.*) You've not left your mistress alone?

MAID. Doctor Seward is with her, sir. (*Sways a little.*)

VAN HELSING. (*Looking at her keenly.*) What's wrong with you, my girl?

MAID. Nothing, sir.

VAN HELSING. You've just had a severe shock.

MAID. It's nothing, sir. I . . . I suddenly felt queer. (*Looks toward window.*) That's all. I can't remember anything.

VAN HELSING. Mr. Harker has just arrived. Ask Doctor Seward to come here. Remain with Miss Lucy yourself.

MAID. Yes, sir. She's dreadfully upset, sir.

VAN HELSING. Upset over what?

MAID. It's in the evening paper, sir. About the Hampstead Horror. (*Van Helsing motions Maid to silence.*) Yes, sir.

VAN HELSING. (*Shaken.*) Oh, God, she has seen it!

(*Maid goes into bedroom. Harker enters left.*)

HARKER. (*Worried.*) Everything just the same? (*Van Helsing nods. Harker closes door.*) When I leave this house even for a few hours I dread what I . . . I dread what I may find when I come back.

VAN HELSING. And well you may, my friend. (*He places box on table under mirror.*)

HARKER. God must have sent you here to help us. Without you there'd be no hope. And this morning, Professor, when you opened your veins to revive Lucy again . . .

VAN HELSING. It was the least I could do, for my lack of foresight was responsible for this attack.

HARKER. Don't say that.

VAN HELSING. Her maid slept with her and yet we found the wolfsbane thrown off the bed to the floor.

HARKER. She was so weak, so pale, the two little wounds opened fresh again.

VAN HELSING. (*With gesture to box.*) I have prepared a stronger defense. But our main task is not defense, but attack. What have you found in London?

HARKER. A lot, but heaven knows what it means or whether it's any use.

VAN HELSING. I, too, have had news of which I can make nothing.

SEWARD. (*Enters.*) Ah, John, back from town.

HARKER. Yes. (*Sits.*)

VAN HELSING. We must try to piece together what we have learned today. (*Producing telegram of several sheets.*) My colleague in Bucharest wires that the Dracula family has been extinct for five hundred years.

SEWARD. Can the Count be an impostor?

VAN HELSING. (*Referring to telegram.*) The castle he calls his own is a desolate ruin near the border. It was built, as you said, Harker, by the terrible Voivode Dracula, who was said to have had dealings with evil spirits. He was the last of his race. But for many generations the peasants have believed the Castle Dracula inhabited by a vampire.

HARKER. Then it must be he.

VAN HELSING. (*Shakes head; puts telegram back in pocket.*) My friends, I am bewildered.

SEWARD. But surely this confirms your suspicions. I was incredulous till I saw that creature hovering over Lucy.

VAN HELSING. A vampire from Transylvania cannot be in England.

SEWARD. But why?

VAN HELSING. Because, as I have told you, the vampire must rest by day in the earth in which the corpse it inhabits was buried.

HARKER. (*Rises.*) In the earth.

VAN HELSING. The vampire must return to its burial place by sunrise.

HARKER. (*Excited.*) I found today that Dracula arrived at the Croydon air-drome in a three-engined German plane, on March sixth.

SEWARD. March the sixth? Three days before Mina first was taken ill.

HARKER. This plane had made a nonstop flight from Sekely in Transylvania. It left just after sunset. It arrived two hours before dawn. It carried only the Count and six packing cases.

VAN HELSING. Did you learn what was in those cases?

HARKER. He told the customs people he wanted to see whether Transylvania plants would grow in a foreign climate in their native soil.

VAN HELSING. Soil? What was in those boxes?

HARKER. Just plain dirt. He left in a truck, with the six coffinlike boxes, before sunrise.

VAN HELSING. Before sunrise! The King of Vampires, my friends. (*Crosses between Seward and Harker.*) This creature is the terrible Voivode Dracula himself! In his satanic pride and contempt, he even uses his own name. For who could suspect? For five hundred years he has been fettered to his castle because he must sleep by day in his graveyard. Five centuries pass. The airplane is invented. His chance has come, for now he can cross Europe in a single night. He prepared six coffins filled with the earth in which he must rest by day. He leaves his castle after sunset. By dawn he is in London and safe in one of his cases—a great risk, but he has triumphed. He has reached London with its teeming millions, with its “opportunity,” as he said.

SEWARD. God protect my Lucy!

HARKER. (*To Van Helsing, new tone.*) I saw the estate agent from whom he bought Carfax here and got the address of four old houses he has leased in different parts of London.

VAN HELSING. One of his coffin retreats is in each of those houses.

SEWARD. Two heavy boxes were delivered at Carfax the day after he took possession.

VAN HELSING. He has scattered them, for safety. If we can find all six, we can destroy him.

SEWARD. But how?

VAN HELSING. His native earth will no longer receive his unclean form if each box is sanctified with holy water.

HARKER. Then we must get at those boxes, tear them open one by one. If we find him, Professor, I demand that my hand shall drive the stake into this devil's heart and send his soul to hell!

(*Seward motions no noise because of Lucy.*)

VAN HELSING. Your plan is too dangerous.

SEWARD. But why? These attacks on Lucy continue. Are we to delay while my child is dying?

HARKER. No, not for a moment.

VAN HELSING. Patience, my friends. This creature is more than mortal. His cunning is the growth of the ages. What if we find five of his boxes and close them against him, and cannot find the sixth?

SEWARD. Well?

VAN HELSING. Then he will bury himself in his last refuge, where we can never find him and sleep until we are all dead.

HARKER. Then Lucy will be safe.

VAN HELSING. For her life, yes, but his unclean kiss has claimed her for his own. When she dies she will become as he is, a foul thing of the night. The vampire can wait. No, my friends, there is only one way to save her from him, to destroy him.

SEWARD. You're right, as always.

VAN HELSING. We have one great advantage. By day he is a confined corpse. Of our search by day he can know nothing, if we leave no traces.

HARKER. God, this delay!

VAN HELSING. We must make the round of his houses and find all six boxes, without his knowledge, and then we act.

SEWARD. But what about the caretakers or servants?

VAN HELSING. All the houses will be empty. The vampire plays a lone hand.

(*Maniacal laugh heard behind curtains of window. Seward crosses quickly to window.*)

SEWARD. Renfield!

dow and screams. Seward moves toward couch. Harker crosses to Lucy to protect her.) The Master is at hand!

(Renfield crosses back on knees. Attendant appears at door.)

SEWARD. Butterworth!

(Seward helps Renfield up, then Attendant grasps him and takes him to door.)

RENFIELD. (At door.) Goodbye, Miss Seward. Since you will not heed my warning, I pray that I may never see your face again.

(He exits with Attendant.)

LUCY. What did he mean, Professor? What did he mean? Why did he say that?

(She goes off into bedroom, in hysterics. Harker follows her.)

SEWARD. That crazy thing in league with the devil; horrible, and Lucy already upset by something in the paper.

VAN HELSING. Go in and get that paper from her.

SEWARD. Whatever it is, she keeps on reading that article again and again.

VAN HELSING. Take it away from her, man, and come back to me. (Places hand on forehead as if faint.)

SEWARD. Don't overdo it, Van Helsing. God knows where we should be if you went under. After a transfusion operation, at your age you really ought to be in bed . . . the loss of so much blood is serious.

VAN HELSING. I never felt more fit in my life.

SEWARD. I only ask you not to overestimate your strength now, when we lean on you. (As he exits.) Feeling fit, are you? Just look at yourself in the glass.

(Van Helsing, alone, registers as tired and exhausted, and walks slowly across room, looking at his drawn face in mirror. Dracula, with stealthy tread, in evening dress and cloak as before, enters from window and walks slowly to directly behind Van Helsing.)

VAN HELSING. (Looking at himself, touching face, shakes head.) The devil.

DRACULA. Come. (Van Helsing turns suddenly to him and looks back into the mirror.) Not as bad as that. (Suave, cold, ironical.)

VAN HELSING. (Long look in mirror, then turns to Dracula. Controlling himself with difficulty.) I did not hear you, Count.

DRACULA. I am often told that I have a light footstep.

VAN HELSING. I was looking in the mirror. Its reflection covers the whole room, but I cannot see . . .

(Pause. He turns to mirror. Dracula, face convulsed by fury, picks up small vase with flowers from stand, smashes mirror, pieces of mirror and vase tumbling to floor. Van Helsing steps back; looks at Dracula with loathing and terror.)

DRACULA. (Recovering composure.) Forgive me, I dislike mirrors. They are the playthings of man's vanity. And how's the fair patient?

VAN HELSING. (Meaningly.) The diagnosis presents difficulties.

DRACULA. I feared it might, my friend.

VAN HELSING. Would you care to see what I have prescribed for my patient?

DRACULA. Anything that you prescribe for Miss Lucy has the greatest interest for me.

(Van Helsing crosses to table to get box. Dracula crosses, meets Van Helsing coming back with box. Van Helsing deliberately turns away from him, goes to small table right of arch, turns front as he opens pocketknife and, in cutting string of parcel, cuts his finger. He gives slight exclamation of pain; holds up finger covered with blood. Dracula starts for Van Helsing with right hand raised, then keeping control with difficulty, turns away so as not to see blood. Van Helsing stares at him a moment, then walks up and sticks bleeding finger in front of him.)

VAN HELSING. The prescription is a most unusual one.

(Dracula, baring teeth, makes sudden snap at finger. Van Helsing turns away quickly; ties handkerchief around it. Dracula again regains poise with an effort.)

DRACULA. The cut is not deep. I . . . looked.

VAN HELSING. (Opening parcel.) No, but it will serve. Here is my medicine for Miss Lucy. (Dracula comes up to Van Helsing, who quickly holds handful of wolfsbane up to his face. Dracula leaps back, face distorted with rage and distress, shielding himself with cloak. Putting wolfsbane back in box.) You do not care for the smell?

DRACULA. You are a wise man, Professor, for one who has not lived even a single lifetime.

VAN HELSING. You flatter me, Count.

DRACULA. But not wise enough to return to Holland at once, now that you have learned what you have learned.

dren, committed after dark by a mysterious and beautiful woman in Hampstead, are reported today. Narratives of three small girls, all under ten years of age, are alike in essential details. Each child speaks of a beautiful lady in white who gave her chocolates, enticed her to some secluded corner and there bit her slightly in the throat." (He looks at Seward and Lucy.)

LUCY. Go on.

HARKER. (Reading.) "The wounds are trivial. The children suffered no other harm and do not seem to have been frightened. Indeed, one small girl told her mother she hoped she might see the beautiful lady again."

(He turns to Lucy. Seward takes paper from Harker.)

VAN HELSING. So soon . . . so soon.

(Harker and Seward look at each other.)

SEWARD. You know what has been happening, Lucy? (Lucy nods.)

HARKER. Professor Van Helsing knows, too, Lucy, and he knows how to protect you.

LUCY. Is it not too late?

VAN HELSING. No, Miss Lucy, it is not too late.

SEWARD. These poor innocent children . . .

VAN HELSING. (To Seward.) You think Count Dracula . . .

LUCY. (Shudders.) Not that name.

VAN HELSING. You think the Werewolf has done this too?

SEWARD. Of course, in the form of a woman. Who else could it be?

VAN HELSING. It is worse. Far worse.

HARKER. Worse? What do you mean?

(Lucy is motionless, her face frozen in horror.)

VAN HELSING. Miss Lucy knows.

LUCY. The woman in white . . . is Mina.

HARKER. Mina. But she's dead, Lucy.

LUCY. She has joined . . . the Master.

SEWARD. Oh, God, have pity on us all. (Drops newspaper on chair.)

VAN HELSING. My dear Miss Lucy, I will not ask you how you know. After tonight no more little children will meet the woman in white. She will remain at rest in the tomb where you laid her. And her soul, released from this horror, will be with God.

LUCY. How can you do this?

VAN HELSING. Do not ask me.

LUCY. (Takes hold of Van Helsing's arm.) Professor, if you can save Mina's soul after her death, can you save mine?

HARKER. Oh, Lucy! (Sitting on couch, arm around her.)

VAN HELSING. (Takes her hand.) I will save you. I swear it. In this room tonight.

LUCY. Then promise me one thing. Whatever you plan to do, whatever you know, do not tell me. (Turns to Harker.) Not even if I beg you to tell me, swear that you will not, now, while I am still yours, while I am myself, promise it.

HARKER. I promise it. (Takes her in his arms; tries to kiss her.)

LUCY. (Breaks away from him, horrified.) No, no, John! You musn't kiss me. Promise that you never will, not even if I beg you to.

HARKER. I promise.

VAN HELSING. My dear Miss Lucy, from tonight on one of us will be awake all night, here in this room, next to your bedroom, with your door open.

LUCY. (Murmurs.) You are so good.

VAN HELSING. Yes, and I will make the room safe for you. Your maid will be with you. (Harker talks to Lucy on couch while Van Helsing takes handful of wolfsbane.) Doctor, rub these over the window in the little room there. See, like this. (He starts rubbing around edge of window.) Rub it around the sashes and especially above the lock. (Seward watches Van Helsing rubbing, then takes wolfsbane from Van Helsing quickly, and goes out through arch. Van Helsing turns, goes to table and takes out wreath of wolfsbane.) See, I have made this wreath that you must wear around your neck tonight. While you wear this those . . . dreams . . . cannot come to you. (Hangs wolfsbane around her neck. Takes out of pocket crucifix on cord, which he also hangs around her neck.) Swear to me that you will not take these off.

LUCY. I promise.

VAN HELSING. Swear it on the cross.

LUCY. (Kisses cross.) I swear it!

(Van Helsing crosses toward door.)

HARKER. Professor, surely the Host is more powerful than this wolfsbane.

VAN HELSING. Of course.

HARKER. Then leave the Host with her, nothing can harm her then.

VAN HELSING. No, the Host cannot be used where there has been pollution. (Screams off left.) What is it?

Act II

1. Dracula offers to hypnotize the maid to rid her of the pain in her head. What is his real purpose?
2. Van Helsing says that a vampire from Transylvania cannot be in England. Why not? How does travel by plane make Dracula's presence possible?
3. Van Helsing confirms his suspicions that Dracula is a vampire with three tests. One is accomplished with a mirror, the second with a cut in Van Helsing's finger, the third with a handful of wolfsbane. Explain the significance of each test. How do Dracula's reactions prove that Van Helsing's suspicions are right?
4. Lucy is drawn to a newspaper story which she reads with dread. What is it about? Who is the mysterious and beautiful woman in the news report?
5. Lucy asks Harker to promise that he will not tell her anything he plans to do in his struggle against the vampire and that he will not allow her to kiss him. Why not?

ACT THREE

SCENE I:

The library. Thirty-two hours later, shortly before sunrise.

A stake and hammer are on desk. Dogs howl. Curtains move as if someone is entering window. Then chair back of desk, which is turned Upstage, moves around, facing front. After a moment, Van Helsing enters with Seward. Van Helsing paces up and down; Seward sits at desk. The Center doors are flung open and the Attendant comes in.

VAN HELSING. What is it?

ATTENDANT. (To Van Helsing.) Anybody who wants my job, sir, can have it.

(Seward rouses himself.)

SEWARD. What's the matter?

ATTENDANT. I knows what I knows, and what I seen I saw, and I hops it by the first train, and don't ask for no wages instead of notice.

VAN HELSING. Where's Renfield?

ATTENDANT. If you asks me, I says he's probably payin' a little visit to hell.

SEWARD. You've let him escape again?

ATTENDANT. Look here, sir. Having, so to speak, resigned, I don't have to put up with any more from any of you. (Look at Van Helsing and Seward.) What a man can't help, he can't help, and that's that.

(Seward sinks back on desk, head in hands.)

VAN HELSING. Can't you see, man, that Doctor Seward is not well? Will you desert him when he needs all the help he can get?

ATTENDANT. Puttin' it that way, sir, I ain't the man to run under fire. But I'm sick and tired of being told off for what ain't my fault.

VAN HELSING. We don't blame you. No bolts or bars could hold Renfield.

ATTENDANT. (Seward looks up at him.) Now, sir, you're talkin' sense. I had him in a straitjacket this time. Nearly all yesterday I worked at clampin' bars across the window. Now I finds them bars pulled apart like they was made o' cheese and him gone.

VAN HELSING. Then try to find him.

ATTENDANT. Find him, sir? Find him? I can't chase him up and down the wall. I ain't no bloody mountain goat! (Exits.)

VAN HELSING. The Thing mocks us. A few hours after he finds out what we

know, and what we have done, he comes here, and drags that poor creature of his to himself.

SEWARD. (*In dull, hopeless tone.*) What can the vampire want with Renfield?

VAN HELSING. Renfield is serving an apprenticeship to join the Vampire King after his death. We must prevent that.

SEWARD. What does Renfield matter? If we are beaten, then there is no hope.

VAN HELSING. (*Crosses to him.*) We dare not despair, Seward.

SEWARD. To figure out in advance what anyone would do who got on his track!

VAN HELSING. I thought we had him when we broke into Carfax and found two earth boxes there and then found one box in each of his four other houses, and when I pried up the lid of the sixth box I was sure we would find him there, helpless.

SEWARD. (*Bitterly.*) Empty.

VAN HELSING. An empty packing case, left as a blind.

SEWARD. He only brought six in his plane, so there can be only the one left.

VAN HELSING. Only one, but hidden where we can never find it. And now we've put him on his guard.

SEWARD. Yes. (*Chair turns back. Curtains flap out. Seward looks at wrist watch.*) It's not half an hour till sunrise. (*Rises and crossing to fireplace.*) Poor John has been sitting up with Lucy for nine hours. She'll be safe at dawn and he can get some sleep, if anyone can sleep in this house.

VAN HELSING. Whoever else sleeps or does not sleep, Miss Lucy will sleep at dawn.

SEWARD. Another horror?

VAN HELSING. Oh, you've noticed how she keeps awake all night now and sleeps by day.

SEWARD. Is that part of . . . the change?

VAN HELSING. Of course. And sometimes the look that comes into her face.

SEWARD. (*Turns face away in horror.*) Don't, man. I can't bear it!

VAN HELSING. We must face the facts, for her sake.

SEWARD. How could it have got at her with the wolfsbane and the cross around her neck? (*Pause.*) Suggestion, conveyed from the Monster?

VAN HELSING. Yes. He must have impelled the maid to take away the wolfsbane and cross and open the window. I should have foreseen that.

SEWARD. Don't blame yourself. The devil is more cunning than we are. (*Sits on couch.*) Yet Lucy seems better. Until this last attack she's always been

exhausted, but at sunset last night, when she woke up after sleeping all day . . .

VAN HELSING. There was blood in her cheeks again.

SEWARD. Yes, thank goodness.

VAN HELSING. (*With terrible emphasis.*) My poor friend, *where does that blood come from?*

SEWARD. What do you suggest now? What fresh horror . . .

(*Door left opens a crack. Long skinny hand protrudes into room. Seward sees it first and starts in alarm. Rises. Van Helsing turns quickly. Door opens slowly and Renfield slinks in.*)

RENFIELD. Is not half past five in the morning a strange hour for men who aren't crazy to be up and about? (*Crosses to window.*)

VAN HELSING. (*Aside to Seward.*) We may get help from this thing that's still half-human. (*To Renfield.*) Renfield.

RENFIELD. (*Crosses, with growing hysteria.*) He's after me! He's going to kill me!

VAN HELSING. Help us, Renfield, and we'll save you.

RENFIELD. You, you poor puny man, you measure your brains against his? You don't know what you're dealing with! You, a thick-headed Dutchman and a fool of a psychiatrist, and a young cub of a boy. Why, not all the soldiers and police in London could stop the Master from doing as he likes.

VAN HELSING. But God can stop him!

RENFIELD. God permits evil. Why does he permit evil if He is good? Tell me that?

SEWARD. How did you escape through those iron bars?

RENFIELD. (*Cunningly.*) Madmen have a great strength, Doctor.

VAN HELSING. Come, Renfield, we know you didn't wrench those bars apart yourself.

RENFIELD. (*Sane.*) No, I didn't. I wanted them there. I hoped they'd keep him out. He did it, then he called to me and I had to come. (*Back to insanity.*) The Master is angry. He promised me eternal life and live things, live things, big ones, not flies and spiders; and blood to drink, always blood. I must obey him but I don't want to be like him. I am mad, I know, and bad, too, for I've taken lives, but they were only little lives. I'm not like him. I wouldn't like a human life. (*Lucy laughs offstage and says, "Oh, John!" as she enters with Harker. Lucy has changed; there is blood in her cheeks, she is stronger and seems full of vitality. She and Harker*

stop in surprise at seeing Renfield. To Lucy.) And why did I seek to betray him? For you. *(She smiles.)* I said I'd serve the devil, but I didn't serve him honestly. I don't like women with no blood in them. *(Lucy laughs.)* And yet I warned you and made him angry, and now . . . *(Working into frenzy.)* . . . perhaps he will kill me. *(Lucy laughs.)* And I won't get any more live things to eat. There'll be no more blood.

(Renfield starts for Lucy's throat. Harker grasps him by right arm, Van Helsing by left arm, then Seward steps in and takes Harker's place as Renfield struggles violently. Seward and Van Helsing bear him away, struggling and screaming.)

HARKER. Lucy, darling, you mustn't mind that poor, crazed creature.

LUCY. *(With low laugh as before.)* I don't. He amuses me.

(She crosses to the couch and sits.)

HARKER. Oh, Lucy, how can you? The poor devil! Thank goodness, it will soon be dawn now.

LUCY. Dawn. The ebb tide of life. I hate the dawn. How can people like daylight? At night I am really alive. The night was made to enjoy life, and love. *(Harker turns to her; hesitates.)* Come to me, John, my own John.

(He comes and sits next to her.)

HARKER. Lucy, I'm so happy that you are better and strong again.

LUCY. I've never been so well, so full of vitality. I was only a poor, washed-out, pale creature. I don't know what made you love me, John. There was no reason why you should. But there is now.

HARKER. I worship you.

LUCY. Then tell me something, John. *(Harker turns slightly away.)* If you love me, you'll tell me. Now don't turn away from me again.

HARKER. *(Wearily and sadly.)* You made me promise that I wouldn't tell you . . . anything.

LUCY. Oh, but I release you from your promise. There, now. What were you and Father and the funny Professor doing all day?

HARKER. I can't tell you. I promised.

LUCY. *(Angrily.)* You say you love me, but you don't trust me.

HARKER. I would trust you with my life, my soul.

LUCY. Then prove it. What were you doing over there in Carfax? With the hammer and the horrible iron stake. *(He shakes his head. She registers anger. He puts his head in his hands, as though crying.)* You don't think I'm asking you because . . . I'm just trying to find out whether you really

love me. *(Harker recoils from her, facing up.)* So you try to hide your schemes and your plots. Afraid I'd give them away, are you? You fools. Whatever he wants to know, he finds out for himself. He knows what you do. He knows what you think. He knows everything.

HARKER. Lucy!

(He puts his head in her lap and sobs. Lucy makes claw-like movement with both her hands, then as he sobs she changes attitude and gently strokes his head.)

LUCY. My dear, I'm sorry. Let me kiss away the tears.

(She starts to kiss him. He quickly rises; backs away a few steps.)

HARKER. No, you mustn't kiss me! You made me promise not to let you kiss me.

LUCY. You don't know why I said that, John darling. It was because I love you so much. I was afraid of what might happen. You've always thought me cold, but I've blood in my veins, hot blood, my John. And I knew if I were to kiss you . . . but I'm not afraid now. Come, will you make me say it?

HARKER. Lucy, I don't understand you.

LUCY. *(Moves toward him.)* I love you. I want you. *(Stretches out her arms to him.)* Come to me, my darling. I want you.

HARKER. *(Goes to her, his resistance overcome, carried away by her passion.)* Lucy, Lucy!

(He seizes her in his arms. Slowly she takes his head and bends it back. Slowly, triumphantly she bends her head down; her mouth hovers over his. Dogs howl outside. She bends his head further back quickly. Her mouth seeks his throat. Doors center open. Van Helsing rushes in, holding crucifix.)

VAN HELSING. Harker! Harker, save yourself! *(Harker rises, draws away. With outstretched arm, Van Helsing holds crucifix between them. Lucy's face becomes convulsed with loathing and rage. She snarls like an animal, retreats, fainting onto the couch. Van Helsing follows, holds crucifix to her; strokes her forehead with left hand.)* I warned you, my poor friend. *(He kneels beside Lucy; begins to chafe her temples. She revives slowly, looks about her, sees cross and seizes it and kisses it passionately. Van Helsing, fervently.)* Oh, thank goodness!

(Pause. Harker crosses to couch.)

LUCY. (*Broken-hearted.*) Don't come to me, John. I am unclean.
 HARKER. (*Sits beside her.*) My darling, in my eyes you are purity itself.
 VAN HELSING. You love her, and in love there is truth. She is pure, and the evil thing that has entered her shall be rooted out.
 LUCY. (*In weak voice as in previous acts; to Van Helsing.*) You said you could save Mina's soul.
 VAN HELSING. Mina's soul is in heaven.
 LUCY. (*Murmurs.*) Tell me how.

(*Seward enters, comes up to group in alarm, but Van Helsing motions silence.*)

VAN HELSING. It is your right to know now. I entered her tomb. I pried open the coffin. I found her there, sleeping, but not dead, not truly dead. There was blood in her cheeks, a drop of blood like a red ruby on the corner of her mouth. With a stake and hammer I struck to the heart. One scream, a convulsion, and then . . . the look of peace that came to her face when, with God's help, I had made her truly dead.
 LUCY. If I die, swear to me that you will do this to my body.
 VAN HELSING. It shall be done.
 HARKER. I swear it.
 SEWARD. And I.
 LUCY. My lover, my father, my dear friend, you have sworn to save my soul. And now I am done with life. I cannot live on to become . . . what you know.
 VAN HELSING. No, no, Miss Lucy, by all you hold sacred, you must not even think of suicide. That would put you in his power forever.
 LUCY. I cannot face this horror that I am becoming.
 HARKER. (*Rises.*) We will find this *Thing* that has fouled your life, destroy him and send his soul to burning hell, and it shall be by my hand.
 LUCY. You must destroy him if you can, but with pity in your hearts, not rage and vengeance. That poor soul who has done so much evil needs our prayers more than any other.
 HARKER. No, you cannot ask me to forgive.
 LUCY. Perhaps I, too, will need your prayers and your pity.
 VAN HELSING. My dear Miss Lucy, now, while you are yourself, help me. (*Takes her hand.*)
 LUCY. How can I help you? Don't tell me, no, you mustn't tell me anything.
 VAN HELSING. Each time the white face, the red eyes came you were pale, exhausted afterwards. But that last time . . .

LUCY. (*Shudders.*) Last time he came he said I was his bride, he would seal me to him for the centuries to come.
 VAN HELSING. And then?
 LUCY. And then . . . (*Rises; crosses toward door.*) No, no, I can't tell you. I can't.
 VAN HELSING. But you must.
 SEWARD. You must, Lucy!
 LUCY. He scratched open one of his veins. He pressed my mouth down to it. He called it a mystic sacrament. He made me . . . he made me drink . . . I can't, I can't . . . go on. . . . (*Lucy rushes off hysterically. Seward follows her.*)
 VAN HELSING. I warned you, my poor friend. I broke in when I heard the dogs howling.
 HARKER. The dogs. Then the Werewolf is about.
 VAN HELSING. He is pursuing Renfield.
 HARKER. We must do something!
 VAN HELSING. And at once. I shall leave Renfield here, as I did Miss Lucy. If the *Thing* appears, we three will bar the two doors and the window.
 HARKER. (*Crosses Up toward window. Laughs bitterly.*) Bar? Against *that*?
 VAN HELSING. Even against *that*, for we shall each carry the sacred element.
 HARKER. And then?
 VAN HELSING. Then I do not know. It will be terrible, for we do not know his full powers. But this I know. . . . (*Looks at watch.*) It is eight minutes to sunrise. The power of all evil things ceases with the coming of day. His one last earth box is his only refuge. If we can keep him here till daybreak he must collapse. And the stake and the hammer are ready. (*Dogs howl. Harker crosses to window, goes out.*) He is here. Quickly! (*Van Helsing runs to window. Seizes Renfield.*)
 RENFIELD. (*As he is dragged in by Van Helsing.*) No, no!
 VAN HELSING. But you must, man, and this may save your soul and your life as well.
 RENFIELD. No, no, no, not alone! Don't leave me alone! (*Van Helsing shoves him forward. Renfield falls. Van Helsing hurries out, closing door and putting lights out. Renfield slowly rises; looks about him. Renfield howls in terror; crouches in firelight as far away as possible from doors and window. Dracula appears, door center, in pale blue light, in evening clothes, dress and cloak as before. Red light from fireplace covers Dracula. As Dracula moves, Renfield's back is to audience.*) Master! I didn't do it! I said nothing. I am your slave, your dog! (*Dracula steps toward him.*)

Master, don't kill me! Punish me . . . torture me . . . I deserve it . . . but let me live! I can't face God with all those lives on my conscience, all that blood on my hands.

DRACULA. (*With deadly calm.*) Did I not promise you that you should come to me at your death, and enjoy centuries of life and power over the bodies and souls of others?

RENFIELD. Yes, Master, I want lives, I want blood, but I didn't want human life.

DRACULA. You betrayed me. You sought to warn my destined bride against me.

RENFIELD. Mercy, mercy, mercy, don't kill me!

(Dracula raises right arm very slowly toward Renfield, who screams, this time in physical pain. Renfield, like a bird before a snake, drags himself to Dracula, who stands motionless. As Renfield reaches Dracula's feet, Dracula, with swift motion, stoops, seizes him by the throat, lifts him up, his grip stifling Renfield's screams. Doors Center are thrown open. Van Helsing switches on lights. Dracula drops Renfield, who falls into corner below couch and remains there during following scene. Dracula starts toward Van Helsing, who takes case containing Host out of inside breast pocket and holds it out toward Dracula in his clenched right fist. Dracula recoils; turns quickly to window. Harker appears through window and holds crucifix toward Dracula in clenched fist. Dracula recoils. Seward enters window, holding crucifix. The three men stand during the following scene with right arms pointing toward Dracula. He turns, walks to fireplace, turns and faces them.)

DRACULA. (*Ironically.*) My friends, I regret I was not present to receive your calls at my house.

VAN HELSING. (*Looks at watch.*) Four minutes until sunrise.

DRACULA. (*Looking at wrist watch.*) Your watch is correct, Professor:

VAN HELSING. Your life in death has reached its end.

SEWARD. By God's mercy.

DRACULA. (*Harker steps toward Dracula. Dracula, turning to them, suavely.*) Its end? Not yet, Professor. I have still more than three minutes to add to my five hundred years.

HARKER. And three minutes from now you'll be in hell, where a thousand years of agony will not bring you one second nearer the end of your punishment.

VAN HELSING. Silence, Harker. Miss Lucy forbade this. She asked for prayer,

and for pity. (*To Dracula.*) Make your peace with God, Man-That-Was. We are not your judges, we know not how this curse may have come upon you.

DRACULA. (*Furiously.*) You fools! You think with your wafers, your wolfsbane, you can destroy me, me, the king of my kind? You shall see. Five of my earth boxes you have polluted. Have you found the sixth?

VAN HELSING. You cannot reach your sixth refuge now. Take your true form as Werewolf if you will. Your fangs may rend us, but we have each sworn to keep you here (*looks at watch*) for two minutes and a half, when you must collapse and we can make an end.

DRACULA. You keep me. Fools, listen and let my words ring in your ears all your lives, and torture you on your deathbeds! I go, I go to sleep in my box for a hundred years. You have accomplished that much against me, Van Helsing. But in a century I shall wake, and call my bride to my side from her tomb, my Lucy, my Queen. (*Harker and Seward move closer.*) I have other brides of old times who await me in their vaults in Transylvania. But I shall set her above them all.

HARKER. Should you escape, we know how to save Lucy's soul, if not her life.

DRACULA. (*Moving left.*) Ah, the stake. Yes, but only if she dies by day. I shall see that she dies by night. She shall come to an earth box of mine at her death and await her Master. To do to her what you did to my Mina, Van Helsing, you must find her body, and that you will not.

HARKER. Then she shall die by day.

DRACULA. You will kill her? You lack the courage, you poor rat of flesh and blood!

SEWARD. Silence, John, he is doomed. This is his revenge. He hopes to trouble us . . . afterwards.

VAN HELSING. (*Looks at watch.*) Thirty seconds.

(They move in.)

DRACULA. (*Calmly, suavely again.*) I thank you for reminding me of the time.

VAN HELSING. Harker, open the curtains. (*Harker opens curtains. Red light of approaching dawn outside.*) That is the East. The sun will rise beyond the meadow there.

(Dracula pulls cape over his head.)

SEWARD. (*Glancing behind, leaves wolfsbane on desk as he looks up at window.*) The clouds are coloring.

HARKER. Daybreak.

(Harker leaves crucifix on desk. Van Helsing checks watch. Seward and Harker step in.)

DRACULA. *(Coolly. Turns Upstage, with back to them.)* A pleasant task you have set yourself, Mr. Harker.

VAN HELSING. Ten seconds. Be ready when he collapses.

(Seward crosses to hold Dracula's cape on Left of Dracula. Harker holds cape on Right of Dracula.)

HARKER. The sun! The stake, Professor, the stake! Hold him, Doctor.

SEWARD. I've got him.

(Dracula, with loud burst of mocking laughter, vanishes on the word "sun," leaving the two men holding the empty cape. A flash goes off in front of fireplace. Harker backs Down Left, drops empty cape in front of desk. The three men look around them.)

HARKER. Up the chimney, as a bat. You heard what he said?

SEWARD. God will not permit it. What's to be done now, Van Helsing?

VAN HELSING. *(Crosses, after looking at the prostrate Renfield; motions Harker and Seward to him. Whispers to them.)* We'll trick Renfield into showing us! *(Then, loudly.)* Dare we leave Renfield on earth to become the slave when he dies?

SEWARD. But he's human. We can't do murder?

HARKER. I'll do it if you won't, Doctor!

VAN HELSING. *(To Seward.)* Go to your office and get some painless drug.

RENFIELD. *(Sensing their drift without hearing their words, has been edging toward panel. Looks around room, then at panel.)* They're going to kill me, Master! Save me! I am coming to you.

(Panel in bookcase opens, Renfield exits and panel closes.)

VAN HELSING. He has shown us the way! Where does that passage go?

SEWARD. I never knew there was a passage.

(Harker hastens to desk; gets stake and hammer. They rush to panel.)

VAN HELSING. Only that devil has the combination. We'll break through somehow. Harker, quick, the hammer.

BLACKOUT

CURTAIN

SCENE II:

A vault.

Absolute darkness. Coffin Right Center and back of gauze drop. Flash of electric torch seen coming slowly downstairs Center. Coffin contains body of Dracula.

VAN HELSING'S VOICE. Be careful, Seward.

SEWARD'S VOICE. These stairs go down forever.

VAN HELSING'S VOICE. May God protect us.

SEWARD'S VOICE. Is Harker there?

VAN HELSING'S VOICE. He's gone for a lantern.

SEWARD'S VOICE. I've got to the bottom.

VAN HELSING'S VOICE. Be careful. I'm right behind you.

(Torch flashes around vault and they walk about slowly.)

SEWARD'S VOICE. What can this place be?

VAN HELSING'S VOICE. It seems an old vault. *(Stifled scream from Seward. Torch out. The torch is seen to jerk back.)* What is it? Oh, where are you, man?

SEWARD'S VOICE. Sorry. I'm all right. A big rat ran across my foot.

(Light seen coming downstairs. Harker appears carrying lighted lantern which reaches floor; partially illuminates bare vault. He has stake and hammer in left hand.)

HARKER. Where are you? What is this place?

VAN HELSING. We can't see.

(Harker moves with lantern.)

HARKER. The place smells horribly of bats.

VAN HELSING. It has an animal smell, like the lair of a wolf.

HARKER. That's what it is.

SEWARD. *(Still flashing torch about.)* There's absolutely nothing here.

HARKER. *(At extreme Left with lantern.)* Here's another passage.

VAN HELSING. *(Moving Left.)* I thought so. That must lead to Carfax. The sixth earth box is hidden somewhere here.

HARKER. And the monster is in it.

SEWARD. You can't be sure. *(As he speaks, light from his torch falls on Renfield, stretched on floor. Renfield screams as light falls on him; scurries off right into darkness.)* Renfield!

(Harker and Van Helsing hurry across.)

VAN HELSING. Where is he?

SEWARD. Over there somewhere. Even if Renfield knew about this place, that doesn't prove the vampire's here.

VAN HELSING. (*As Seward is speaking Van Helsing moves Right; seizes Renfield.*) It is the vampire's life or yours! (*Drags Renfield into light of lantern.*) Look at him, man, look at him. He knows.

RENFIELD. I know nothing. Let me go! Let me go, I say! (*Breaks away; goes Right.*)

VAN HELSING. He was stretched out here, but he wouldn't let me drag him back. Ah! Here it is. Quick, that stake.

(*Harker and Van Helsing, with stake, pry up stone slab and open coffin. The three men gaze in horror and triumph at coffin.*)

SEWARD. What a horrible undead thing he is lying there!

HARKER. Let me drive it in deep!

(*Van Helsing takes stake from Harker, lowers it into the coffin. Renfield stands at right end of coffin.*)

VAN HELSING. (*Almost in a whisper.*) That's over the heart, Doctor?

SEWARD. (*Back of coffin.*) Yes. (*Van Helsing hands hammer to Harker. Harker raises hammer high over head; pounds stake with full force. Low groan. Silence. Stake remains fixed in Dracula's body.*)

VAN HELSING. See his face now . . . the look of peace.

SEWARD. He is crumbling away.

RENFIELD. We're free!

LUCY. (*Comes down stairway and halts at bottom.*) Father, Father, John!

HARKER. Lucy!

VAN HELSING. (*Takes handful of dust; scatters it over the body.*) Dust to dust . . . ashes to ashes.

CURTAIN

(*The curtain rises again and the entire cast comes Downstage before a black drop for curtain speech.*)

VAN HELSING. (*To Audience.*) Just a moment, ladies and gentlemen! Just a word before you go. We hope the memories of Dracula and Renfield won't give you bad dreams, so just a word of reassurance. When you get home tonight and the lights have been turned out and you are afraid to

look behind the curtains and you dread to see a face appear at the window . . . why, just pull yourself together and remember that after all there are such things.

THE CURTAIN FALLS

Act III

1. A change has taken place in Lucy. How do her appearance and behavior show that she is now more in Dracula's power? What shows that there is still hope for her?
2. Van Helsing, Harker and Seward corner Dracula and try to prevent his escape from the library of the sanitarium. What power do they have over him?
3. Final destruction of the vampire takes place when the three men track him to his lair. Where do they find him? How do they dispose of him?

Hamilton Deane and John L. Balderston

 193

Thinking It Through

"Dracula" is more than a melodrama of horror and suspense. The writers show the forces of good battling the forces of evil and ultimately overcoming them. Throughout the play we see the human yearning for salvation from the power of polluted spirits.

1. How does Renfield, although half-crazed and under Dracula's control, rescue Lucy?
2. Lucy, already in Dracula's power, struggles to save herself and Harker from eternal damnation. How?
3. The forces of evil, represented by Dracula, take the life's blood of their victims. How do the forces of good, represented by Van Helsing, Dr. Seward and Harker, try to give life back to their victims? What life-giving activities have been performed before the play opens and continue throughout?
4. The triumph of goodness is complete when Lucy asks the men to destroy Dracula, "with pity in your hearts, not rage and vengeance." What should their feeling be? In what spirit must they approach their task? Why?

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ACT THREE

SCENE I:

The library. Thirty-two hours later, shortly before sunrise.

A stake and hammer are on desk. Dogs howl. Curtains move as if someone is entering window. Then chair back of desk, which is turned Upstage, moves around, facing front. After a moment, Van Helsing enters with Seward. Van Helsing paces up and down; Seward sits at desk. The Center doors are flung open and the Attendant comes in.

VAN HELSING. What is it?

ATTENDANT. (To Van Helsing.) Anybody who wants my job, sir, can have it.

(Seward rouses himself.)

SEWARD. What's the matter?

ATTENDANT. I knows what I knows, and what I seen I saw, and I hops it by the first train, and don't ask for no wages instead of notice.

VAN HELSING. Where's Renfield?

ATTENDANT. If you asks me, I says he's probably payin' a little visit to hell.

SEWARD. You've let him escape again?

ATTENDANT. Look here, sir. Having, so to speak, resigned, I don't have to put up with any more from any of you. (Look at Van Helsing and Seward.) What a man can't help, he can't help, and that's that.

(Seward sinks back on desk, head in hands.)

VAN HELSING. Can't you see, man, that Doctor Seward is not well? Will you desert him when he needs all the help he can get?

ATTENDANT. Puttin' it that way, sir, I ain't the man to run under fire. But I'm sick and tired of being told off for what ain't my fault.

VAN HELSING. We don't blame you. No bolts or bars could hold Renfield.

ATTENDANT. (Seward looks up at him.) Now, sir, you're talkin' sense. I had him in a straitjacket this time. Nearly all yesterday I worked at clampin' bars across the window. Now I finds them bars pulled apart like they was made o' cheese and him gone.

VAN HELSING. Then try to find him.

ATTENDANT. Find him, sir? Find him? I can't chase him up and down the wall. I ain't no bloody mountain goat! (Exits.)

VAN HELSING. The Thing mocks us. A few hours after he finds out what we

Dracula Monologue

English
J.Veinot

After reading Act II of Dracula, complete the following assignment:

- Select a character from the play. This should be a character you are familiar with, as you will need to take on the persona.
- Prepare a one- page monologue in which the character describes a stressful day in his life.
- Be sure to use stage directions describing facial changes, changes in position, and changes in tone. (Please review the example monologue for examples)

Your finished product should:

- Be typed
- Be one page in length
- Include a rough draft
- Contain at least 5 stage directions
- Have a title

Due: Monday

Brent Hosford
Class 96
Ms. Vienot
October 18, 2006

Lucy, "Dazed and Confused" Monologue

Lucy's bedroom in Seward's sanitarium. Lucy rereads "Hampstead Horror" article while she lies on the couch. There is only a dim light from the fire keeping the room alight.

LUCY: *(In a maniacal tone.)* Is this what is to become of me? I envy you Mina. At least your fate has been decided. *(Puts down paper, rises from couch.)* At first I was scared. But now, now I crave the time of night when my master visits me. There is nothing more romantic. *(Begins pacing the room.)* With John I share my heart, but with *him* I can share so much more... My blood. My soul. In the end, my lifetime with Harker would be temporary. A short fling compared to the centuries I will be able to spend with my master. *(With loathing.)* Van Helsing thinks he has me all figured out. He thinks I am innocent. But his futile attempts against foiling the master's plans are pathetic. I used to believe he was my benefactor, but now I see how weak he is. *(Imitates Van Helsing with sarcastic voice.)* The power of Christ compels you! *(Stops, gives a gives a shrill, cold laugh.)* His greatest weapon is based on a false hope. I was completely ashamed of myself when I first questioned my faith... But now I see I was right. If God were to help me, he would have helped me in my time of need. It is too late for me now. Master, you are my Lord and savior now. And Van Helsing... the nerve of his actions astounds me still. Wolfsbane? *(Cold sneer.)* No plant can stop the master from doing what he pleases.

Bradley Hauer
Class 91
Ms. Veinot
Due October 26, 2005

Dracula, King of the Night Monologue

Dark street outside Seward's sanitarium. A dark, overcast night gives the scene an ominous feel. Street lamps cast dim, gloomy shadows. We see Dracula silhouetted against a window. He steps into a dim patch of light and speaks.

DRACULA: Night... the sweet embrace of darkness, and with it, freedom. Freedom to find sustenance and fuel my living death; and, to propagate my race. *(Low, evil chuckle.)* Miss Mina was only the first of many in this town to be doomed and yet, not doomed – for can one truly consider eternal life, immortality, power no mortal could ever dream of, to be doom? *(Dracula begins walking, street lights causing eerie shadows to play over the sidewalk.)* And Miss Lucy too... she as well is beginning to succumb to my power. *(Sadistic smirk)* Ironical how her friends offer their blood to her by day, only for me to take by night. Yet my task would be infinitely easier if not for one man... *(At the thought, his eyes narrow, his face twists into a snarl, and there is a moment of silence. When he speaks, his voice is one of malice and hate.)* ... Van Helsing. *(Clenches fists and stops walking. From where he stands, we can barely make him out against the darkness.)* My mortal nemesis, the one who knows my every power and my every weakness... but what he knows not is my determination, for if this insipid mortal truly believes that I, Count Voivode Dracula, will be brought down by a single man, then this professor still has much to learn. *(Continues walking, now at a much faster pace, silent for a moment, as the only sound is his footsteps. He crests a hill, and, seeing the many houses below, relaxing his fists. He speaks calmer now, and quieter.)* 500 years, five long, long centuries, I have

EDGAR ALLAN POE

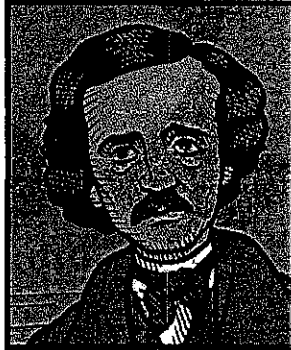
JANUARY 19, 1809–OCTOBER 7, 1849

NATIONALITY:

AMERICAN

ASTROLOGICAL SIGN:

CAPRICORN



MAJOR WORKS:

THE TELL-TALE HEART (1843)

THE RAVEN (1845)

CONTEMPORARIES & RIVALS:

NATHANIEL HAWTHORNE, JAMES RUSSELL LOWELL

HENRY WADSWORTH LONGFELLOW

LITERARY STYLE:

MYSTERY AND GOTHIC

WORDS OF WISDOM

**"IN MY MIND, ALL TIME
IS A MIDNIGHT DREARY."**

Today you can find Edgar Allan Poe's face reproduced on everything from bookstore walls to bottles of beer. But that wasn't always the case. America's most famous literary export died penniless and largely unloved in his own country. It was up to the French (who insist on referring to him as "Edgar Poe" for reasons unknown) to resuscitate his reputation and exalt him to the iconic status he enjoys today. Thank you, François. We can talk about Jerry Lewis later.

Edgar Allan Poe was the father of macabre fiction, a writer whose eerie stories and atmospheric poems paved the way for H. P. Lovecraft and Stephen King. He was also afraid of the dark. "I believe that demons take advantage of the night to mislead the unwary," he once confessed to a friend. "Although, you know," he quickly added, "I don't believe in them." Maybe Poe just sensed he was living under a dark cloud. You couldn't blame him. An orphan at age three, he was raised by a wealthy couple named John and Frances Allan in Richmond, Virginia. Raised, not adopted, because snooty John Allan refused to allow the son of theatrical performers to taint his pristine family tree. Nevertheless, Poe took his stepfather's surname as his middle name. He also inherited some of John's priggish manner.

Besides affection, the other thing John Allan failed to give his stepson in any great quantity was money. Indeed, destitution was a hallmark of Poe's short life. At the University of Virginia, he ran up gambling debts to meet his needs, which by then included copious amounts of alcohol. The pattern repeated itself when Poe entered the U.S. Military Academy at West Point in 1830. A disgrace to the uniform, he spent most of his time drinking and dreaming up ways to get booted out. In January 1831 he finally succeeded. He disobeyed direct orders and failed to show up for drills often enough that he was court-martialed for "Gross Neglect of Duty." He retains the dubious dual distinction of being the only major American writer to attend West Point, and the only one to get kicked out.

Poe fit the mold of the classic, falling-down drunk. A college classmate wrote that his "passion for strong drink was as marked and as peculiar as that for cards . . . without a sip or a smack of the mouth he would seize a full glass and send it home at a single gulp." That one glass was usually enough to put him into an alcoholic stupor. Part of the problem was no doubt due to his slight build and sickly disposition. At West Point, Poe appeared so frail and old that the other cadets joked that his stepfather had taken his place. John Allan eventually

got so fed up with Poe's dissolute ways that he disowned him, promising to have his stepson arrested if he ever appeared on Allan's property.

Bereft of both money and family, Poe moved in with an aunt, Maria Clemm, at her home in Baltimore. He also began cranking out short stories for magazines. In 1836, at age twenty-seven, he married his thirteen-year-old cousin Virginia, Clemm's daughter, after a bizarre three-year courtship during which he was repeatedly warned of the impropriety of marrying someone so young. Together they moved around a lot—to New York, to Philadelphia, back to New York again. Poe was always one step ahead of his creditors and one stiff drink away from a three-day bender. Then, just when his writing career began to pick up, his wife contracted tuberculosis and died.

Poe's life was indeed a nightmare, and it had a fittingly oneiric conclusion. Stopping off in Baltimore on a trip to New York in late September 1849, he disappeared for five days. He was picked up off the street in front of an Irish tavern, semiconscious and drunk as a skunk, dressed in ragged clothes that clearly belonged to someone else. Admitted to Washington College Hospital, the delirious versifier spent the next two days calling out for a mysterious man named Reynolds and begging the attending physician to blow his brains out. At last, crying out from his sickbed, "Lord, help my poor soul!" he keeled over and died.

No one's sure what happened during those five lost days. Evidence suggests that Poe may have been shanghaied by a gang of electoral goons, plied with drink, and forced to stuff ballot boxes in the Baltimore mayoral election. The ensuing alcoholic binge may have exacerbated an existing health condition, such as syphilis, diabetes, or perhaps rabies. Whatever the cause, his death was an unpleasant one—as was the reputation concocted for him by his earliest biographer, an embittered editor named Rufus Griswold, whose work Poe had once slogged in print. Griswold's 1850 "memoir" maliciously depicts Poe as a drug-addicted degenerate who had incestuous sex with his own aunt. It was all false, cheap, posthumous score settling, but it was decades before the literary establishment (with a little help from the French) accepted Poe into the pantheon of great American authors.

THE SUM OF ALL FEARS

It's no wonder Poe was afraid of the dark. He was educated in a cemetery—literally. When Poe attended boarding school in England, the classroom abutted a graveyard. Too cheap to buy textbooks, the headmaster conducted math lessons outside among the slumbering dead. Each child was instructed to choose a headstone and then find the deceased's age by subtracting the year of birth from the year of death. Gym class took place in the same cheery environment. On the first day of school, each student was presented with a small wooden shovel. If a parish member died during the semester, the children were sent out to dig the grave, thereby engaging in some invigorating aerobic exercise.

QUOTH THE RAVEN, "YOU GOT HOSED"

Poe was very proud of "The Raven," calling it "the greatest poem that was ever written." (Modesty was not his strong suit.) Yet he earned nearly nothing from the work, thanks in large part to his ignorance of copyright law. Eager to get his creation in print, he published it in a newspaper, *The New York Evening Mirror*, unaware that doing so released him from all copyright protection. Anyone could then reprint the poem—and many people did, making a killing. When Poe finally got around to publishing his own edition, the poem was already so widely circulated that no one bought it.

DICKENS LOSES HIS GRIP

Poe's famous raven was in fact inspired by the avian pet of British author Charles Dickens. Grip, Dickens's babbling bird, appears as a character in his serialized mystery novel *Barnaby Rudge*, which Poe reviewed in 1841. Poe complimented Dickens on the use of the talking raven, deeming that it should have played a larger role in the plot.

When Dickens and Poe met for the first and only time, in 1842, the beloved bird had recently died. (It had apparently drunk from an open paint bottle Dickens left lying around the stable.) Dickens related the sad story to Poe, who returned home that night and inserted an ominous talking raven into an existing poem called "To Lenore," which he had put aside. "Lenore" rhymed perfectly with "Nevermore," which became the sinister black bird's now-famous mantra.

WHEN POETS ATTACK

There's nothing as entertaining as a catfight between poets. Poe's arch nemesis was Henry Wadsworth Longfellow, the eminent author of "Song of Hiawatha" and other poems. For reasons still unclear nearly two centuries later, Poe went from fawning admiration to outright hostility toward the man, his poetry, and his character. In 1840 he wrote a scathing review of Longfellow's latest poem, accusing him of plagiarizing it from Alfred Lord Tennyson. When that provoked no response, Poe claimed that Longfellow had ripped off one of *his* poems as well. The so-called "Longfellow War" was on. Unfortunately for Poe, it was nothing but a waste of ammunition. He never produced a shred of evidence that Longfellow was a plagiarist, and the New England poet serenely refused to respond to the younger man's ad hominem attacks. After Poe's death, Longfellow had nothing but nice things to say about him, adding: "The harshness of his criticisms I have never attributed to anything but the irritation of a sensitive nature, chafed by some indefinite sense of wrong." Oh, smack!

AS A CHILD, POE WAS LITERALLY EDUCATED IN A CEMETERY. HE LEARNED MATH BY ADDING AND SUBTRACTING THE DATES ON GRAVESTONES.

UP, UP, AND AWAY

Poe was not above a little journalistic hoaxing, especially when he was hard up for cash. In April 1844, a destitute Poe sold a story to the *New York Sun* about the world's first transatlantic balloon crossing. "The great problem is at length solved," he wrote triumphantly. "The Air, as well as Earth and the Ocean, has been subdued by science, and will become a common and convenient highway for mankind." Poe's incredibly well thought out, five-thousand-word article went on to describe in exquisite detail the dirigible in question, its operator (a real-life balloonist named Henri Giffard), and the voyage itself. The only problem: It was all a lie. The next day, the *Sun* printed a retraction: "The mails from the south... not having brought confirmation of the balloon from England... we are inclined to believe that the intelligence is erroneous."



STONED AGAIN

The black cloud of bad luck that seemed to follow Poe throughout his life lingered awhile even after his death. The headstone ordered to mark his grave was run over by a runaway train. As a result, until his body was exhumed and reburied in 1875, he rested beneath a generic lot marker that read "No. 80."

CHEERS, MATE!

Anyone who tries to market Poe-branded kitchen appliances has to reckon with a shadowy figure known as the Poe Toaster. Every year since 1949, this mysterious black-cloaked stranger has appeared at Poe's gravesite on the night of the author's birthday. The graveyard groupie may sound like a character from one of Poe's macabre tales, but as the cemetery groundskeepers (and the numerous scholars who debate his identity) will tell you, he is all too real. The ritual is always the same: He drinks a toast to the deceased and then leaves behind a half-empty bottle of cognac and three red roses as tokens of admiration. Why three roses? They may represent Poe, his mother-in-law, and his wife, all of whom are interred in the same plot. Why cognac? Nobody knows. Why any of it? No one has ever tried to intercept the toaster to ask—out of respect for Poe and the solemnity of this annual ceremony.

EVERYONE'S A CRITIC

Poe seems to divide the literary community. There are those, like the French, who revere him as a god. And then there are those who can't stand him or any of his works. Notable Poe detractors include T. S. Eliot, who described him as having "the intellect of a highly gifted person before puberty"; Mark Twain, who once remarked, "To me, his prose is unreadable—like Jane Austen's" (a rare two-for-one literary smackdown!); and W. H. Auden, who took the most personal potshot, dismissing Poe as "an unmanly sort of man whose love life seems to have been largely confined to crying in laps and playing mouse."

POE RELATION

Actor Edgar Allan Poe IV, a direct descendant of the master of the macabre, has gotten a lot of career mileage out of the association with his great-great-uncle Poe: the fourth played Poe the first in the feature film *Monkeybone* and on a 1999 episode of *Scrubs: The Teenage Witch*. When not aping his legendary relative, he has specialized in portraying crazed, lowlifes and carnival barkers in such movies as *Sex Puppets* and *Oliver Twisted*.

ARE YOU READY FOR SOME FOOTBALL?

In 1996 professional football returned to Baltimore after a thirteen-year absence. A contest was conducted to select a name for the new franchise in tribute to the city's most famous resident. Ravens won out over Marauders and Americans. After two years without a mascot, in August 1998 the team unveiled not one but three (an elaborate and bizarre on-field ceremony before a preseason game against the Philadelphia Eagles): each of the ravens was hatched from an enormous egg. They are, in order of emergence: Edgar, a tall, strong, competitive Raven with long flowing feathers and sharp pointy eyes; Allan, a short, skinny and agile bird; and Poe, the "chubby, lazy but undeniably lovable" runt of the litter. So far, none of the trio seems to have developed the raging alcohol problem that was Poe's defining characteristic.

A & E's *Biography of Edgar Allan Poe* Symbolism Assignment

Poe is often referred to as the "master of macabre" or the "Stephen King of his time" thanks to his terrifying short stories and chilling poems. Sadly, his life was shrouded in death and darkness due to his parents' early deaths, his depression, addiction, lack of financial success, death of his wife and to his own mysterious demise at the age of forty.

After watching A & E's *Biography of Edgar Allan Poe*, and using your knowledge of symbolism, create a symbolic representation of the man's life. Use a minimum of three symbols, and explain the rationale of your choices on the back of the picture.

Evaluation

Teacher Name: _____

Student Name: _____

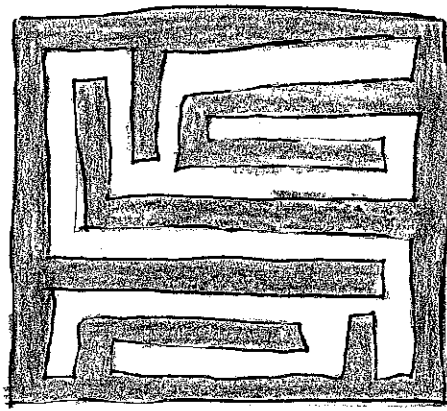
CATEGORY	4	3	2	1
Symbolism	Student shows understanding of symbolism by appropriate and creative use of at least three symbols.	Student shows understanding of symbolism by appropriate use of two symbols.	Student shows understanding by appropriate use of one symbol.	Student shows little to no understanding of appropriate symbols.
Relates Graphics to Text	Student accurately explains how each symbol is related to Poe's life.	Student accurately explains how two symbols are related to Poe's life.	Student accurately explains how one of the symbols are related to Poe's life.	Student has difficulty relating symbols to Poe's life.

Baby in a Basket



The baby in the basket symbolizes Edgar Allan Poe's life because the picture is mainly about abandonment, and he was abandoned by almost everyone. His father left, his mother died, his foster father disowned him, his foster mother died, his childhood sweetheart died, and his wife died. When a baby is left on someone's doorstep, it's because they're not wanted. Poe was a very aggressive man, and he got into conflicts with almost everybody, due to his critical outlook on life, so he was not well liked.

Maze

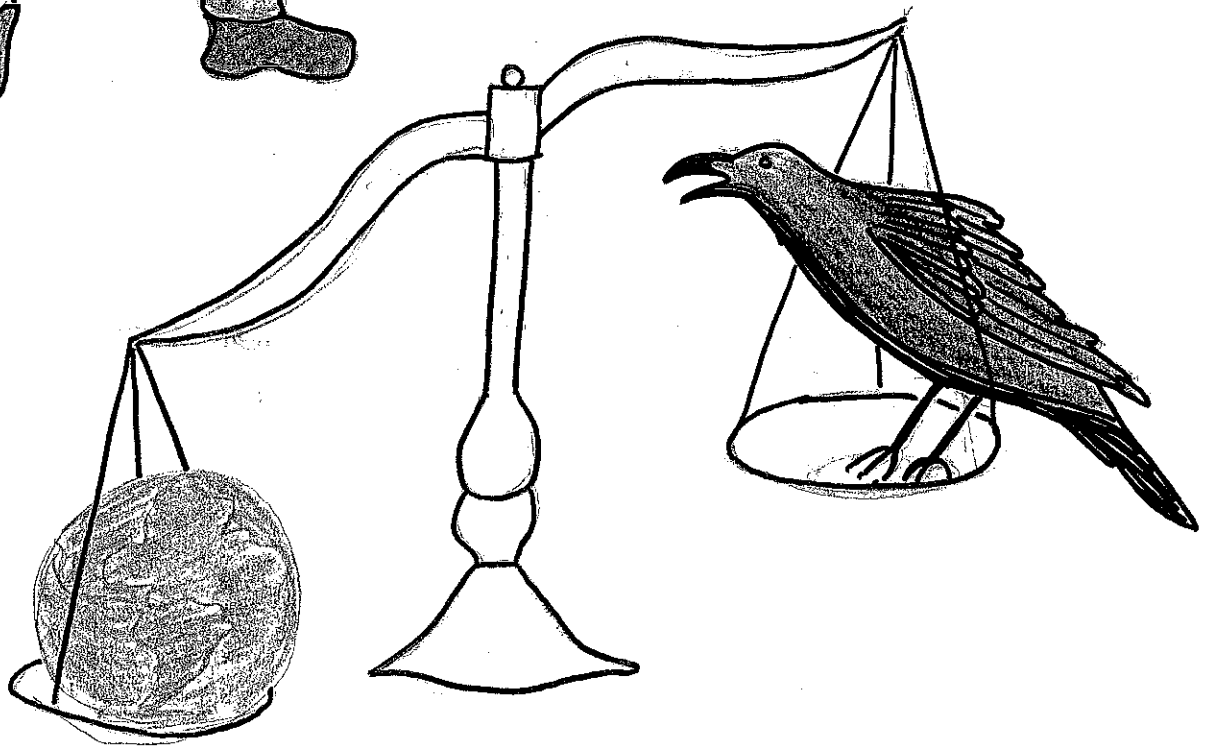
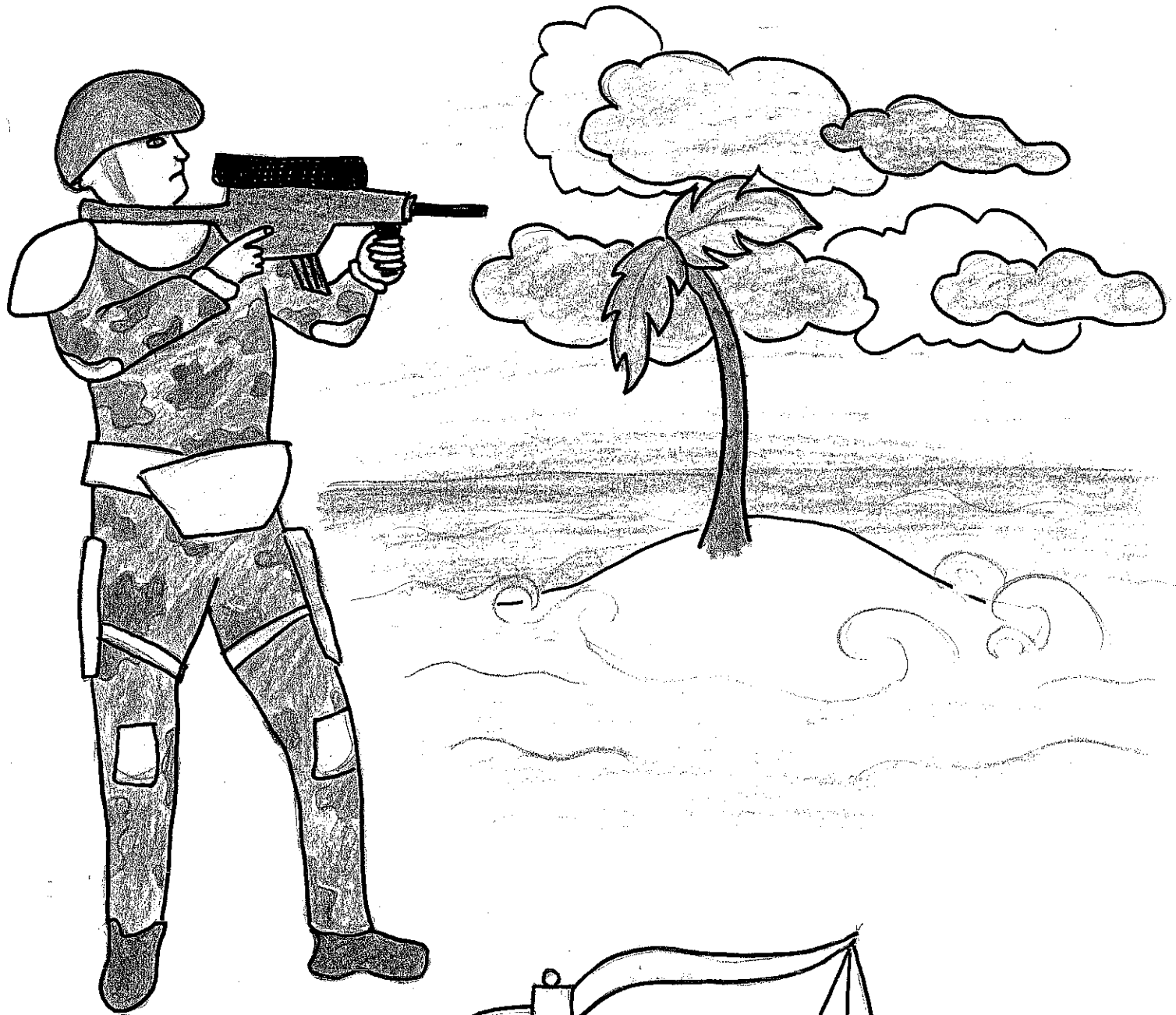


This picture of a red maze represents Poe's life in 2 ways. Firstly, Poe was a very lost man. He had at any one time barely any family to call his own. He was addicted to liquor, and was 'lost' in his depression. How he died is not clearly known, just as the way out of a maze is not always clear. Secondly, I chose to color the maze red because this is one of the main things I associate Poe with, because most of his loved ones died of 'The Red Death', because of his short story 'The Masque of the Red Death', and because red is the color of blood and I have always thought of Poe as a very morbid person.

Jessica D. & Mrs. Verno, Knife and Gavel



The knife and the gavel symbolize a big part of Poe's life. Poe was always looked down upon by the upper class men, including his foster father. Because of this, Poe was forever craving justice, hence the gavel. In almost all of his work, justice is served, although sometimes in very unorthodox ways. The knife shows what he thinks those who have wronged him deserve as justice, an out-of-the-ordinary punishment for their crimes. It also symbolizes the revenge he wishes he could carry out, but which he must content himself with living out in his poems.



Jessica Rosko
Class 92
Ms. Veinot
Nov.1, 2008

Throughout his life, Edgar Allan Poe was constantly at battle, whether it be with society, within the literary world, or with himself. The soldier depicts the battles Poe was relentlessly faced with, but he is not in the usual camouflage attire worn by soldiers as Poe was not one to blend in or hide from conflicts. In fact, it sometimes seemed that he sought them out, with instances such as accusing others of plagiarism and trying to get kicked out of the army. Another thing Poe battled was his addiction to alcohol, which it seems he eventually lost, as he was found terribly drunk and delirious right before he died. Poe also watched most of the people he loved battle illnesses like tuberculosis, and lose. Edgar Allan Poe was definitely involved in more battles than a human being should be, but these battles were his inspirations and at least part of the reason that he wrote such brilliant stories and poems.

The second symbol is a desert island, representing how Poe was abandoned by his loved ones several times throughout his life, either by choice or because sickness and death stole them from him. The weather around the island is bleak and ominous, portraying the grim circumstances that were constantly occurring in Poe's life and the bad luck that persistently tended to accompany him. Like the tree on the island, Poe was forced to lead quite a solitary existence, and was constantly plagued with horrible occurrences, with no way of escaping them. The fact that Edgar Allan Poe was abandoned by his father – a very important figure in one's life – at such a young age probably had something to do

with how he never quite succeeded in life – at least in the parts that he had control over. However, without the terrible hardships Poe faced, he may not have written the wonderful, albeit grim works that he did.

Lastly, the unbalanced scale containing a globe and a raven signify how unjust Poe's life was. Poe is obviously portrayed by the raven, for many reasons. Firstly, for the fact that Poe's most famous poem is called "The Raven", but also because ravens are omens of death, something that Poe's life contained an abundance of. Most of his stories and poems revolved around or included death as Poe probably looked to his own life for inspiration and also used his writing to voice his emotions. Poe is also related to the raven as they are a symbol of intelligence, which is one of the things that Edgar Allan Poe was not deprived of. Not only do they symbolize intelligence, but also war, and Poe definitely had more than his share of battles during his lifetime. Another thing that connects Poe to ravens is the fact that they signify mystery and the unknown. Poe was very interested in forbidden knowledge and mystery; especially the ultimate mystery – death. On the other side of the balance scale – on the side outweighing Poe – there is a globe. This globe represents society. In his life, it always seemed that society prevailed, leaving him poor, distressed, and generally unlucky. The yellow colour of the scale represents the happiness, wealth, and hope that Poe was frequently unable to obtain. Although Edgar Allan Poe endured countless treacherous happenings throughout his lifetime, these events ultimately lead to him becoming one of the most recognized writers ever.

EVOLUTION

In October 1347, a fleet of Genoese trading ships reached the port of Messina. By the time the fleet reached Messina, all the crew members were dead or dying; it is also presumed that the ships carried infected rats. From there, the disease spread northwest across Europe, striking France, Spain, and Great Britain by June 1348, then turned and spread east through Germany and Scandinavia from 1348 to 1350, and finally to northwestern Russia in 1351. Some parts of Europe were largely spared by the plague, including the Kingdom of Poland and parts of Belgium and the Netherlands.

Whether or not this theory is accurate, what is clear is that there were several preexisting conditions that contributed to the severity of the Black Death. Disastrous weather reached a peak in the first half of the fourteenth century with devastating results. In the years 1315 to 1322 a catastrophic famine struck all of Northern Europe. Food shortages and skyrocketing prices were a fact of life for as much as a century before the plague. Wheat, oat, hay and livestock were all in short supply and their scarcity resulted in hunger and malnutrition. The consequence was a mounting vulnerability to disease due to weakened immunity. The economy entered a vicious cycle in which hunger and small scale disease reduced the productivity of laborers, and so the grain output suffered, causing the grain prices to increase. The famine was self-perpetuating, and allowed the plague to be especially devastating.

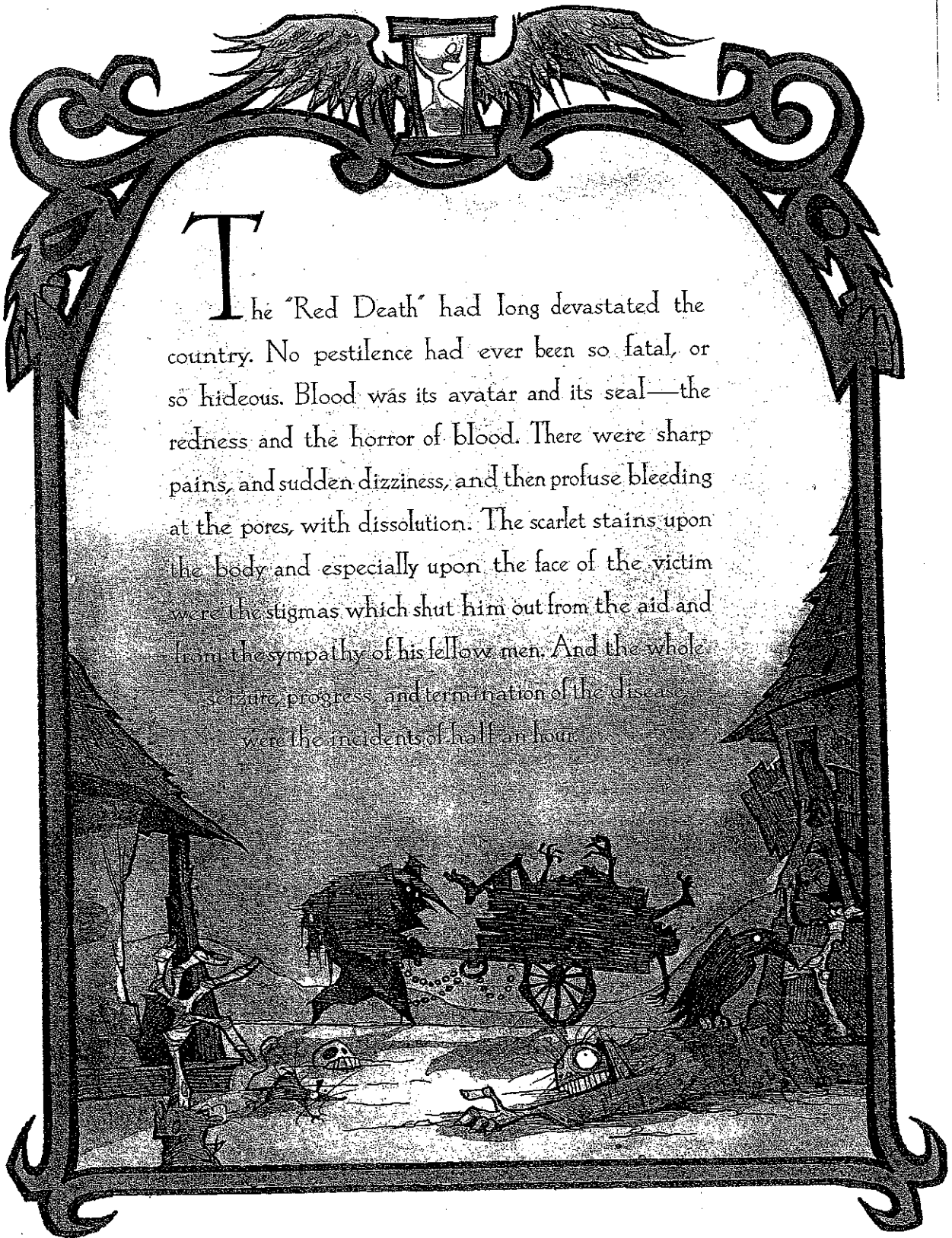
FORMS OF THE PLAGUE

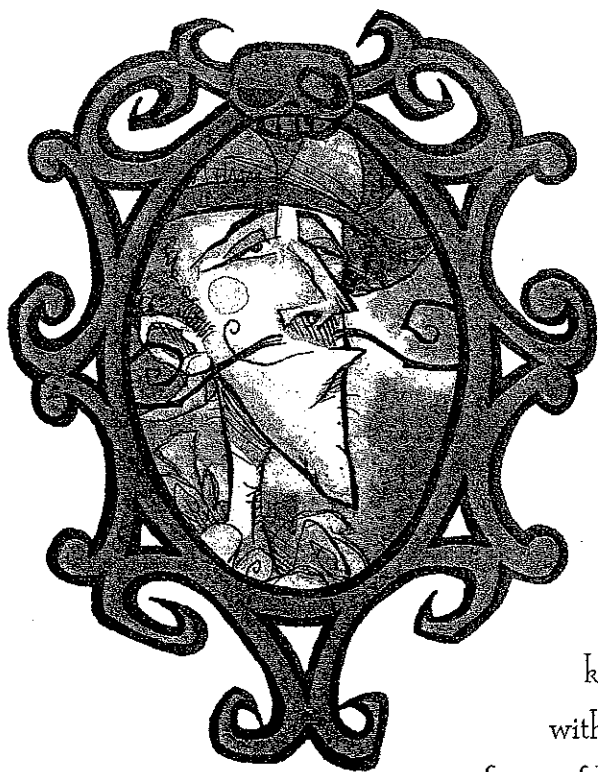
The plague consisted of three forms: bubonic, pneumonic, and septicemic. The septicemic and bubonic plague were transmitted with direct contact with fleas, while the pneumonic plague was transmitted through airborne droplets of saliva coughed up by bubonic or septicemic infected humans. The bacteria multiplied inside a flea, blocking its stomachs and causing it to become very hungry. The flea would then start voraciously biting a host and continue to feed because it was unable to satisfy its hunger. During the feeding process infected blood carrying the plague bacteria flows into the wound. The plague bacteria then has a new host and the fleas eventually die from starvation. The pneumonic plague has a different form of transmission. It is transmitted through infected droplets sprayed from the lungs and mouths of infected people. The bacteria then enters the lungs through the windpipe and starts attacking the lungs and throat.

The Masque of the Red Death

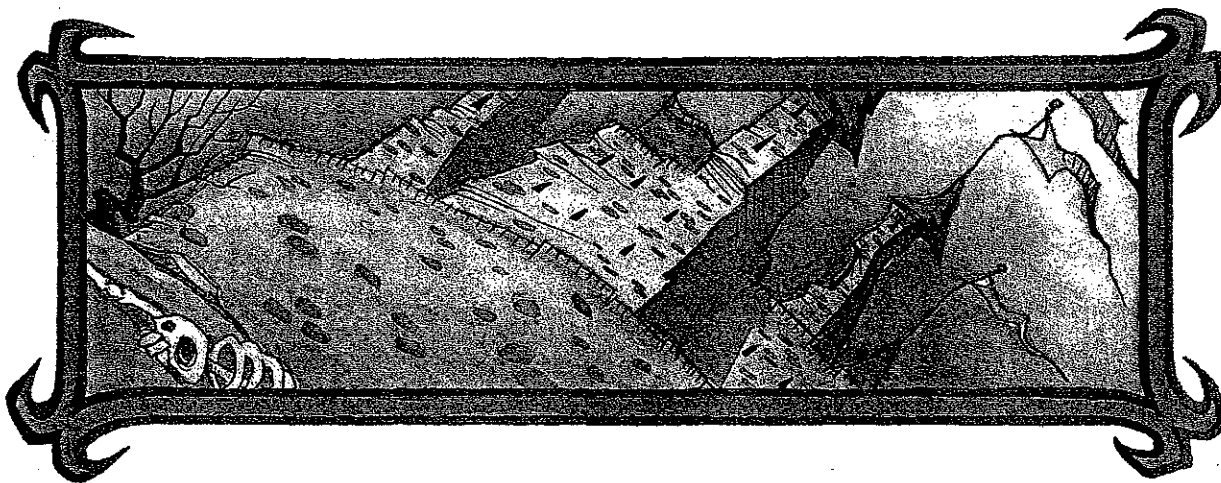


The "Red Death" had long devastated the country. No pestilence had ever been so fatal, or so hideous. Blood was its avatar and its seal—the redness and the horror of blood. There were sharp pains, and sudden dizziness, and then profuse bleeding at the pores, with dissolution. The scarlet stains upon the body and especially upon the face of the victim were the stigmas which shut him out from the aid and from the sympathy of his fellow men. And the whole seizure, progress, and termination of the disease, were the incidents of half an hour.

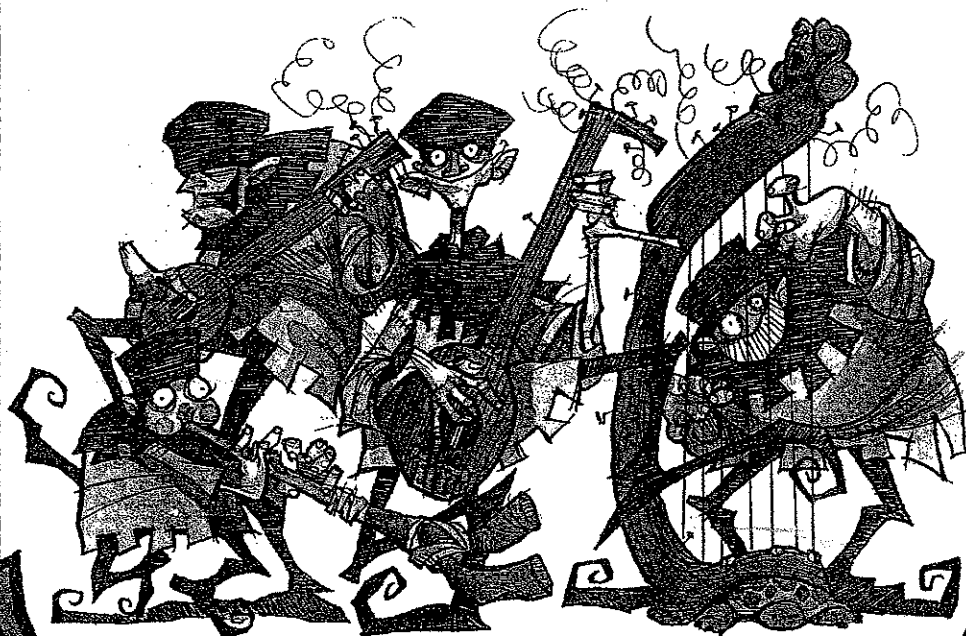


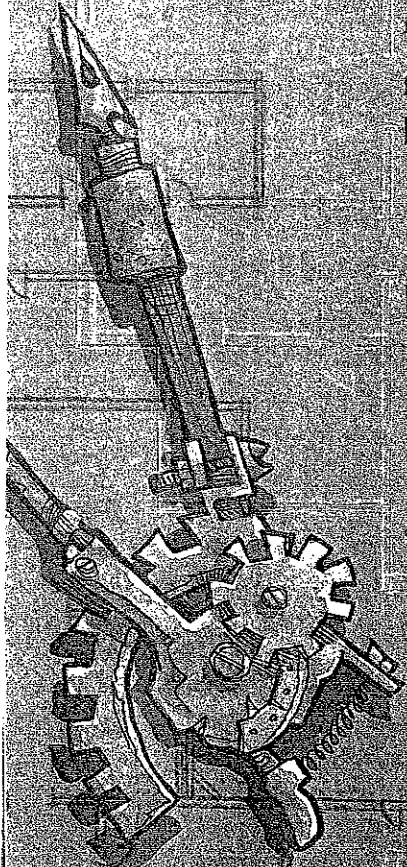


But the Prince Prospero was happy and dauntless and sagacious. When his dominions were half depopulated, he summoned a thousand hale and light-hearted friends from among the knights and dames of his court, and with these retired to the deep seclusion of one of his castellated abbeys. This was an extensive and magnificent structure, the creation of the prince's own eccentric yet august taste. A strong and lofty wall girdled it in. This wall had gates of iron. The courtiers, having entered, brought furnaces and massy hammers, and welded the bolts.



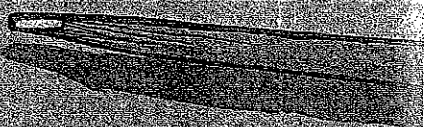
The abbey was amply provisioned. With such precautions the courtiers might bid defiance to contagion. The external world could take care of itself. In the meantime it was folly to grieve, or to think. The prince had provided all the appliances of pleasure. There were buffoons, there were ballet dancers, there were musicians, there was Beauty, there was wine. All these and security were within. Without was the "Red Death."



A detailed illustration of a fountain pen nib and a complex mechanical gear assembly. The pen nib is positioned vertically on the left, pointing upwards. Below it, a series of interlocking gears and mechanical components are shown, including a large gear with a central hub and several smaller gears and levers. The entire illustration is rendered in a dark, textured style with fine lines and shading.

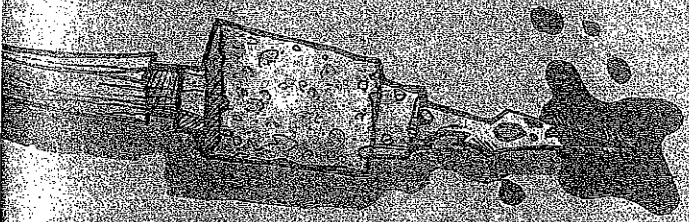
It was toward the close of the fifth or sixth month of his seclusion, and while the pestilence raged most furiously abroad, that the Prince Prospero entertained his thousand friends at a masked ball of the most unusual magnificence.

It was a voluptuous scene, that masquerade. But first let me tell of the rooms in which it was held. There were seven — an imperial suite. In many palaces, however, such suites form a long and straight vista, while the folding doors slide back nearly to the walls on either hand, so that the view of the whole extent is scarcely impeded. Here the

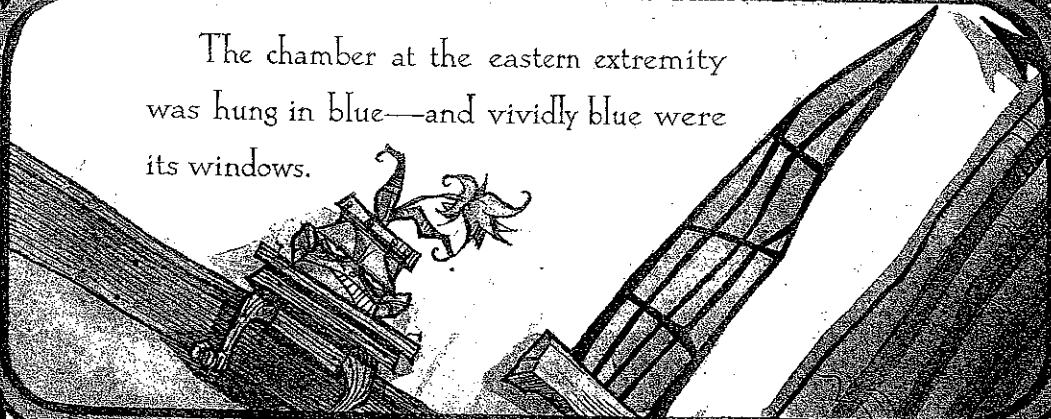
A simple illustration of a pen nib, pointing horizontally to the right. It is rendered in a dark, textured style with fine lines and shading.



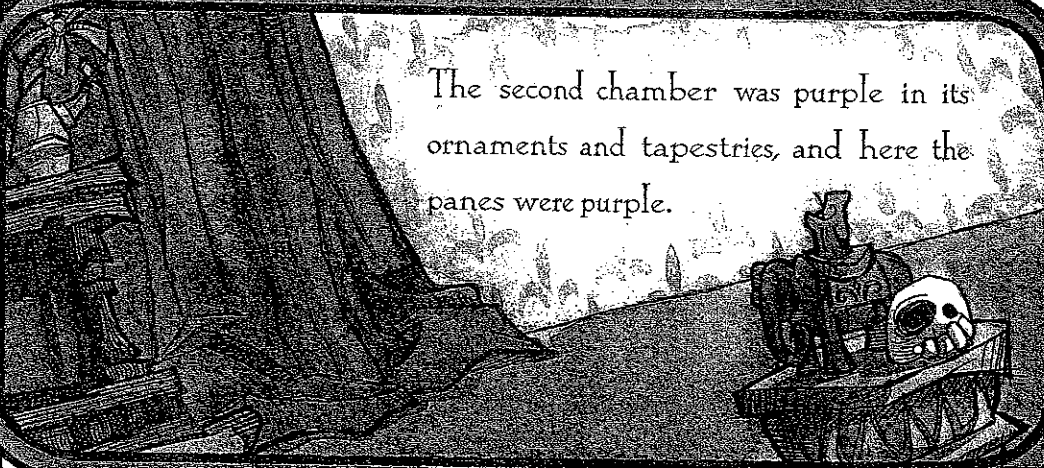
case was very different, as might have been expected from the prince's love of the bizarre. The apartments were so irregularly disposed that the vision embraced but little more than one at a time. There was a sharp turn at every twenty or thirty yards, and at each turn a novel effect. To the right and left, in the middle of each wall, a tall and narrow Gothic window looked out upon a closed corridor which pursued the windings of the suite. These windows were of stained glass whose color varied in accordance with the prevailing hue of the decorations of the chamber into which it opened.



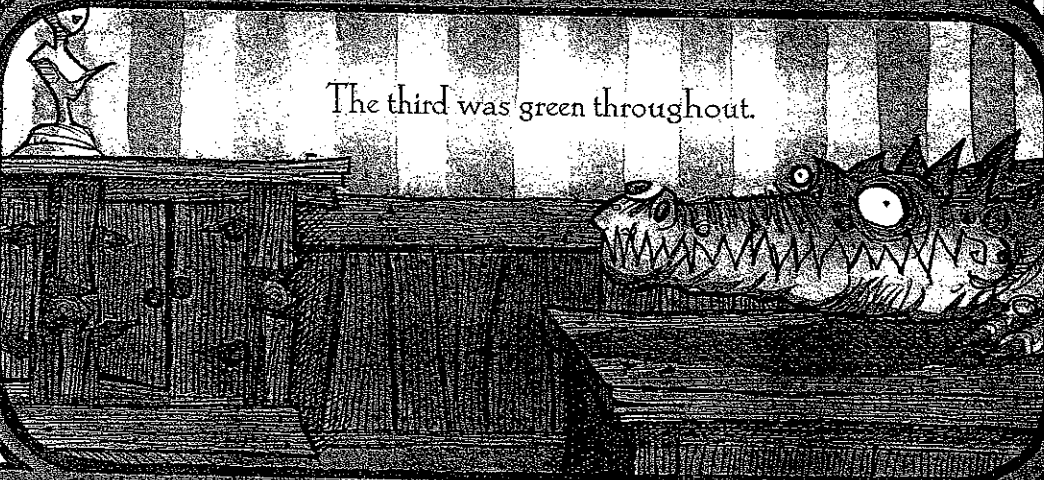
The chamber at the eastern extremity
was hung in blue—and vividly blue were
its windows.

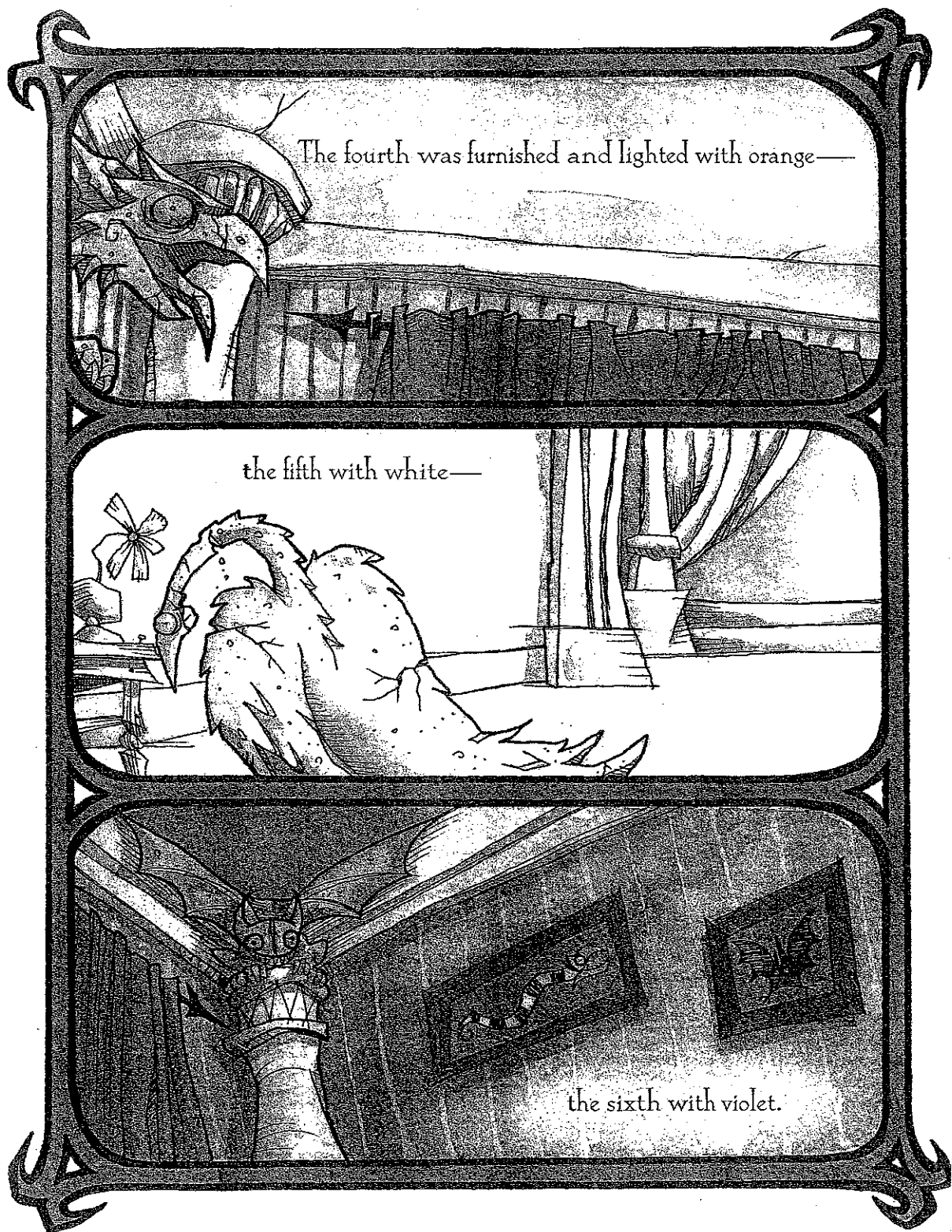


The second chamber was purple in its
ornaments and tapestries, and here the
panes were purple.



The third was green throughout.



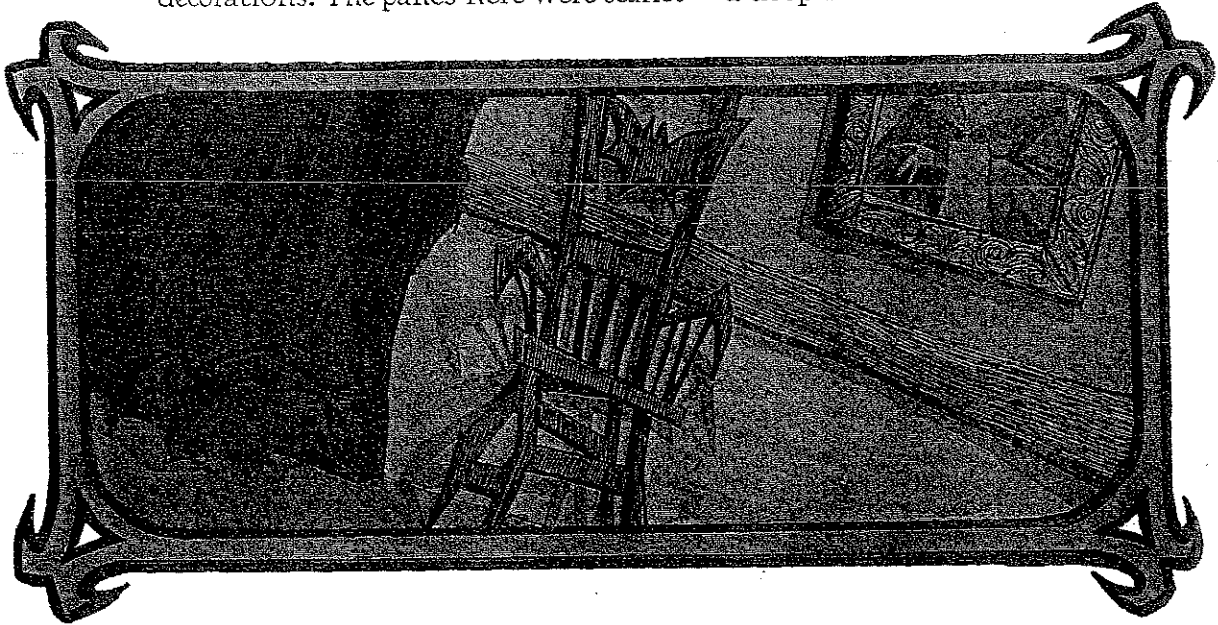


The fourth was furnished and lighted with orange—

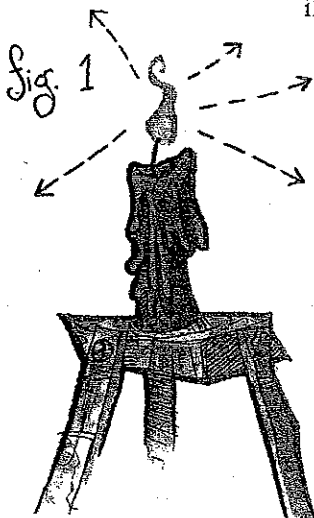
the fifth with white—

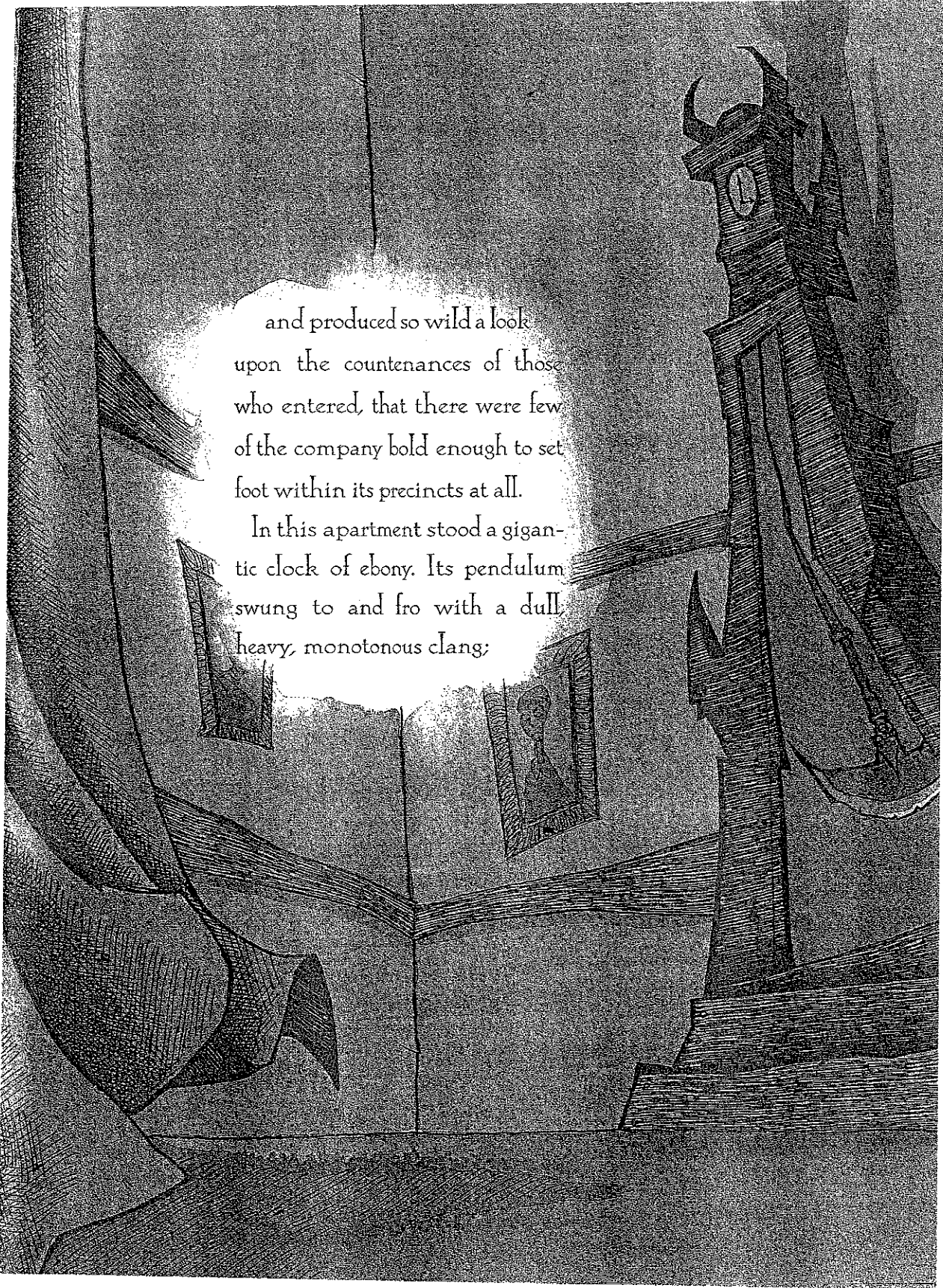
the sixth with violet.

The seventh apartment was closely shrouded in black velvet tapestries that hung all over the ceiling and down the walls. But in this chamber only, the color of the windows failed to correspond with the decorations. The panes here were scarlet—a deep blood color.



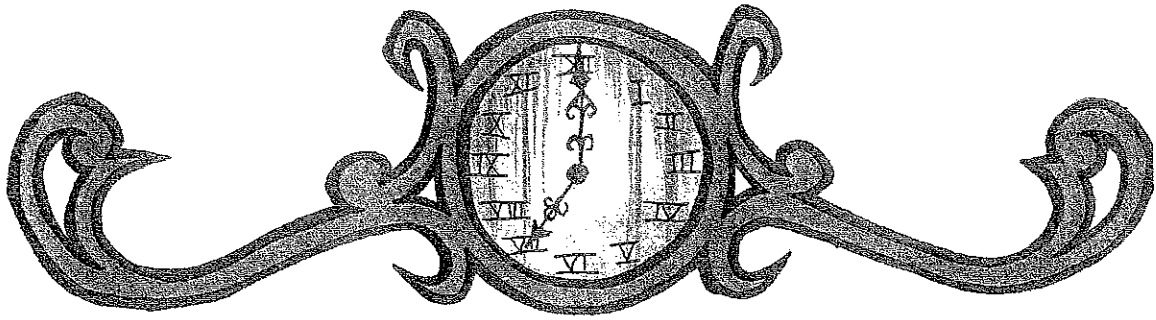
Now in not one of the seven apartments was there any lamp or candelabrum, but in the corridors that followed the suite, there stood, opposite to each window, a heavy tripod, bearing a brazier of fire that projected its rays through the tinted glass and so glaringly illumined the room. But in the western or black chamber the effect of the fire-light that streamed upon the dark hangings through the blood-tinted panes, was ghastly in the extreme,



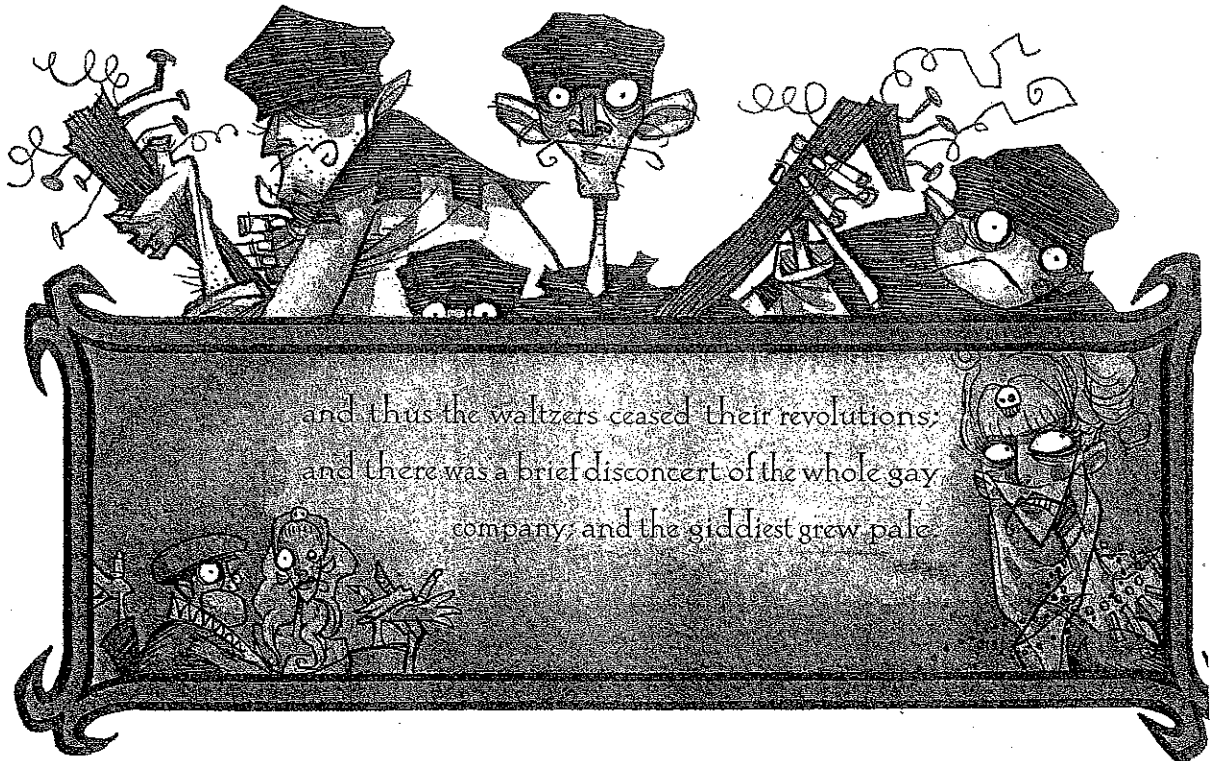
The background is a dark, textured illustration. On the right side, there is a tall, ornate clock tower or structure with a circular clock face near the top. The structure has a jagged, almost demonic appearance with pointed elements. On the left, there are dark, angular shapes that look like parts of a large, ancient structure or perhaps shadows. In the center, where the text is located, there is a bright, glowing area that illuminates the scene. On the wall in the background, there is a framed portrait of a person. The overall mood is mysterious and somewhat ominous.

and produced so wild a look
upon the countenances of those
who entered, that there were few
of the company bold enough to set
foot within its precincts at all.

In this apartment stood a gigan-
tic clock of ebony. Its pendulum
swung to and fro with a dull,
heavy, monotonous clang;

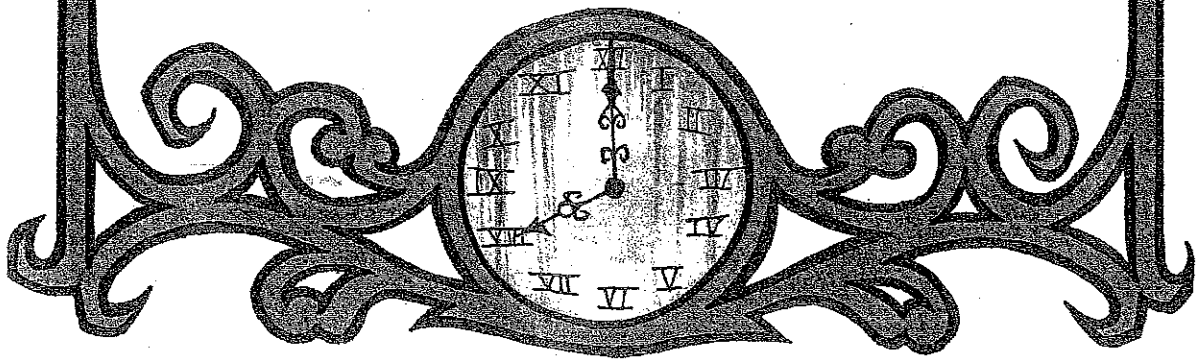


and when the minute-hand made the circuit of the face, and the hour was to be stricken, there came from the brazen lungs of the clock a sound of so peculiar a note and emphasis that, at each lapse of an hour, the musicians of the orchestra were constrained to pause, momentarily, in their performance,



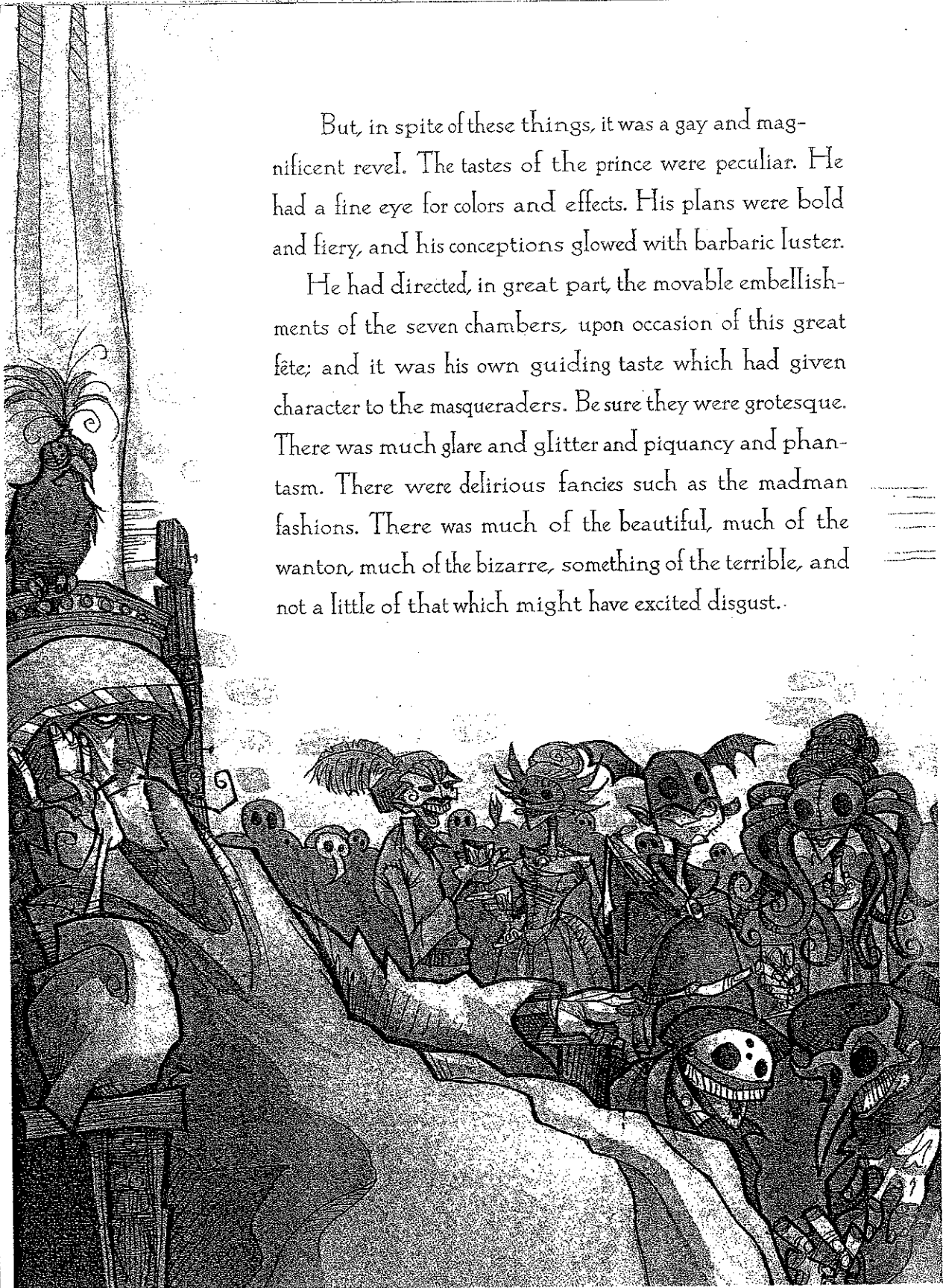


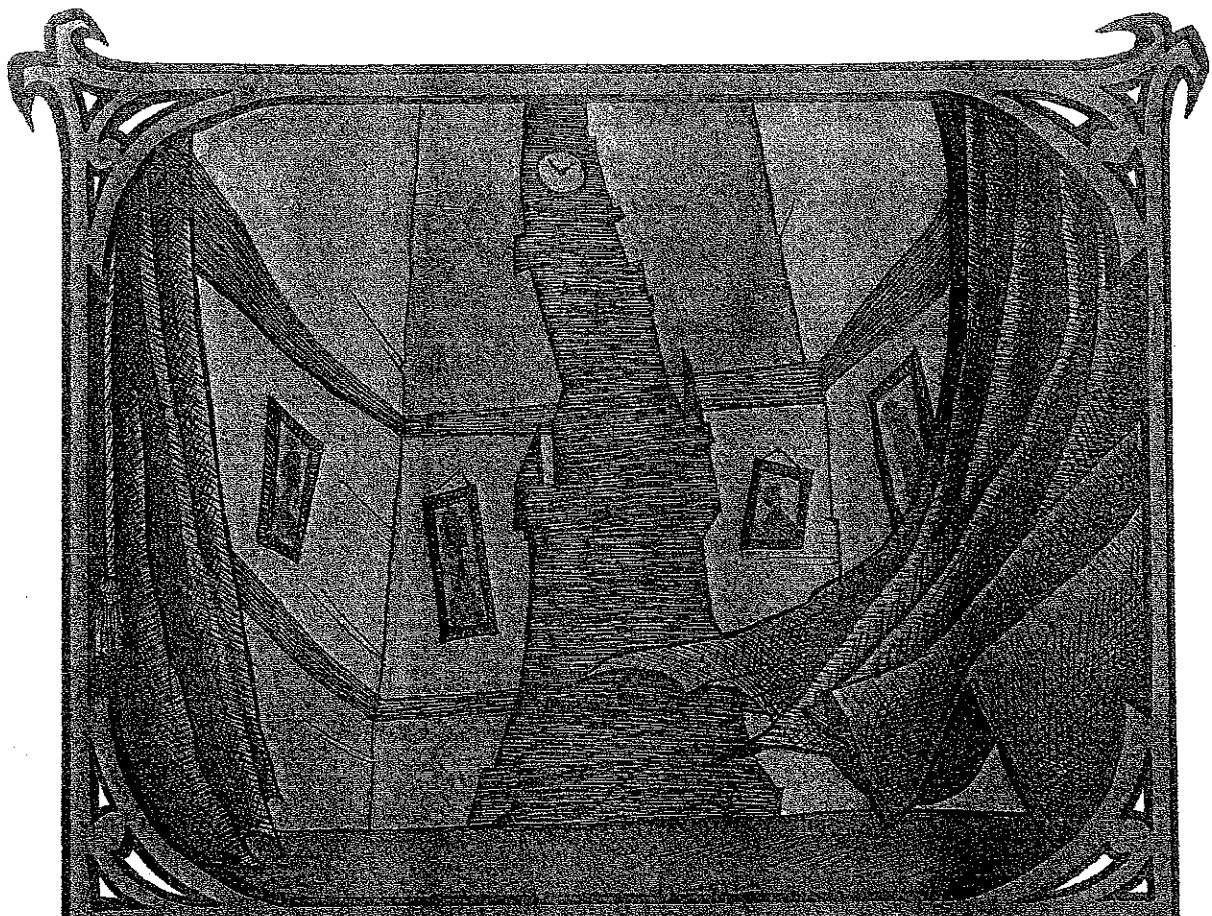
But when the echoes had fully ceased, a light laughter at once pervaded the assembly; the musicians looked at each other and smiled as if at their own nervousness, and made whispering vows, each to the other, that the next chiming of the clock should produce in them no similar emotion; and then, after the lapse of sixty minutes, there came yet another chiming of the clock, and then were the same disconcert and tremulousness and meditation as before.



But, in spite of these things, it was a gay and magnificent revel. The tastes of the prince were peculiar. He had a fine eye for colors and effects. His plans were bold and fiery, and his conceptions glowed with barbaric luster.

He had directed, in great part, the movable embellishments of the seven chambers, upon occasion of this great fête; and it was his own guiding taste which had given character to the masqueraders. Be sure they were grotesque. There was much glare and glitter and piquancy and phantasm. There were delirious fancies such as the madman fashions. There was much of the beautiful, much of the wanton, much of the bizarre, something of the terrible, and not a little of that which might have excited disgust.



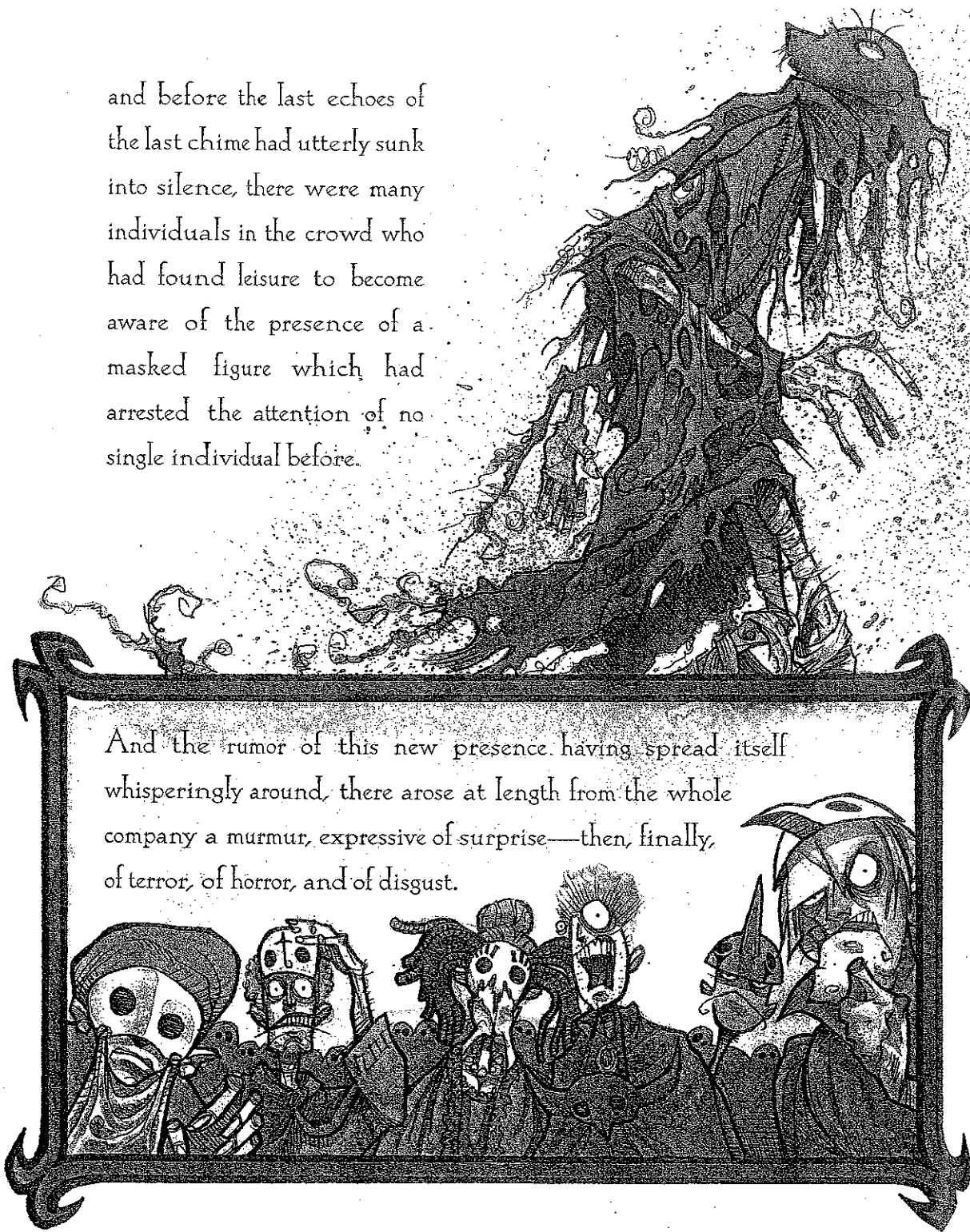


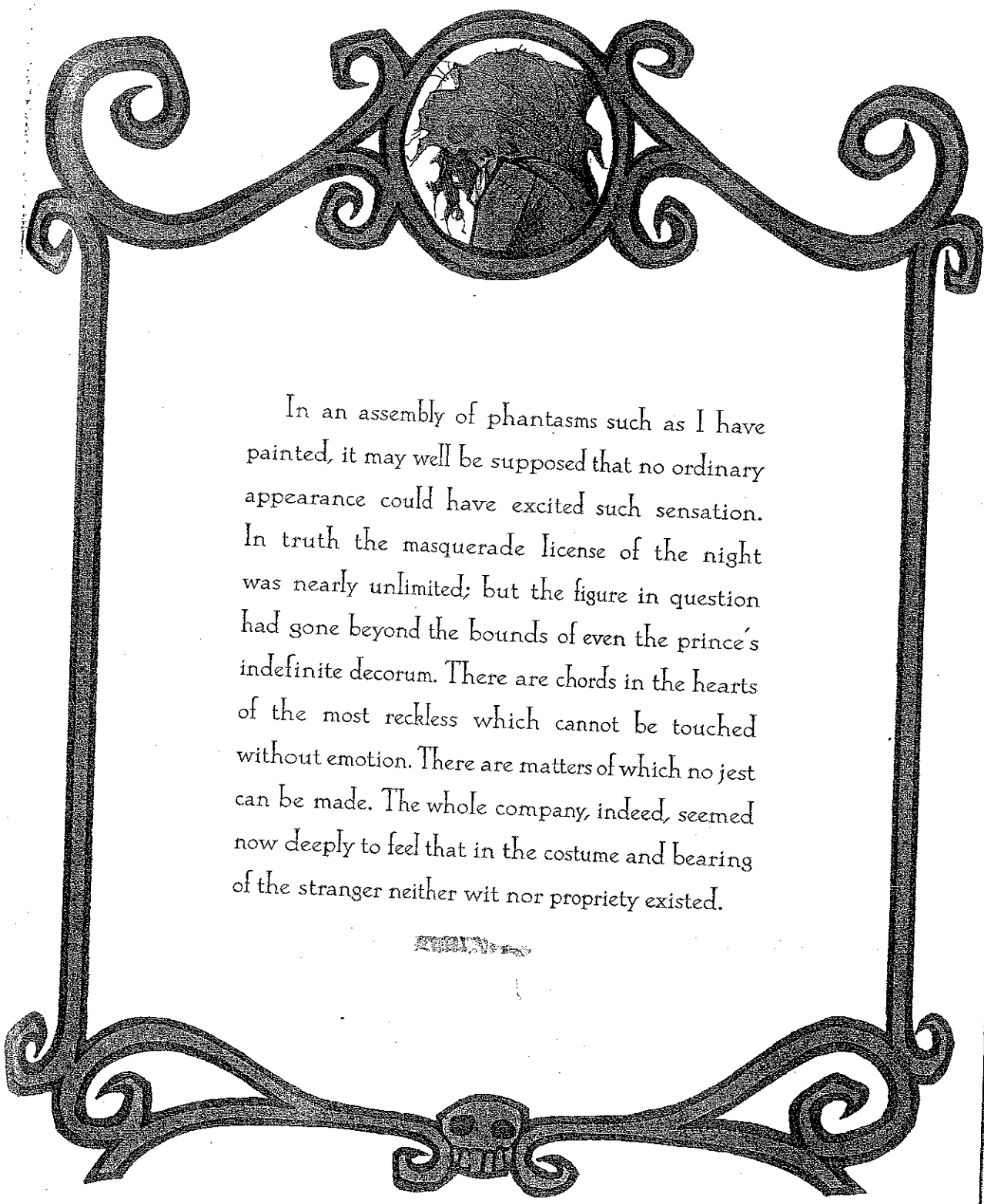
To the chamber which lies most westwardly of the seven, there are now none of the maskers who venture; for the night is waning away, and there flows a ruddier light through the blood-colored panes; and the blackness of the sable drapery appalls; and to him whose foot falls upon the sable carpet, there comes from the near clock of ebony a muffled peal more solemnly emphatic than any which reaches their ears who indulge in the more remote gaities of the other apartments.

But these other apartments were densely crowded, and in them beat feverishly the heart of life. And the revel went whirlingly on, until at length there commenced the sounding of midnight upon the clock. And then the music ceased, as I have told; and the revolutions of the waltzers were quieted; and there was an uneasy cessation of all things as before. But now there were twelve strokes to be sounded by the bell of the clock,



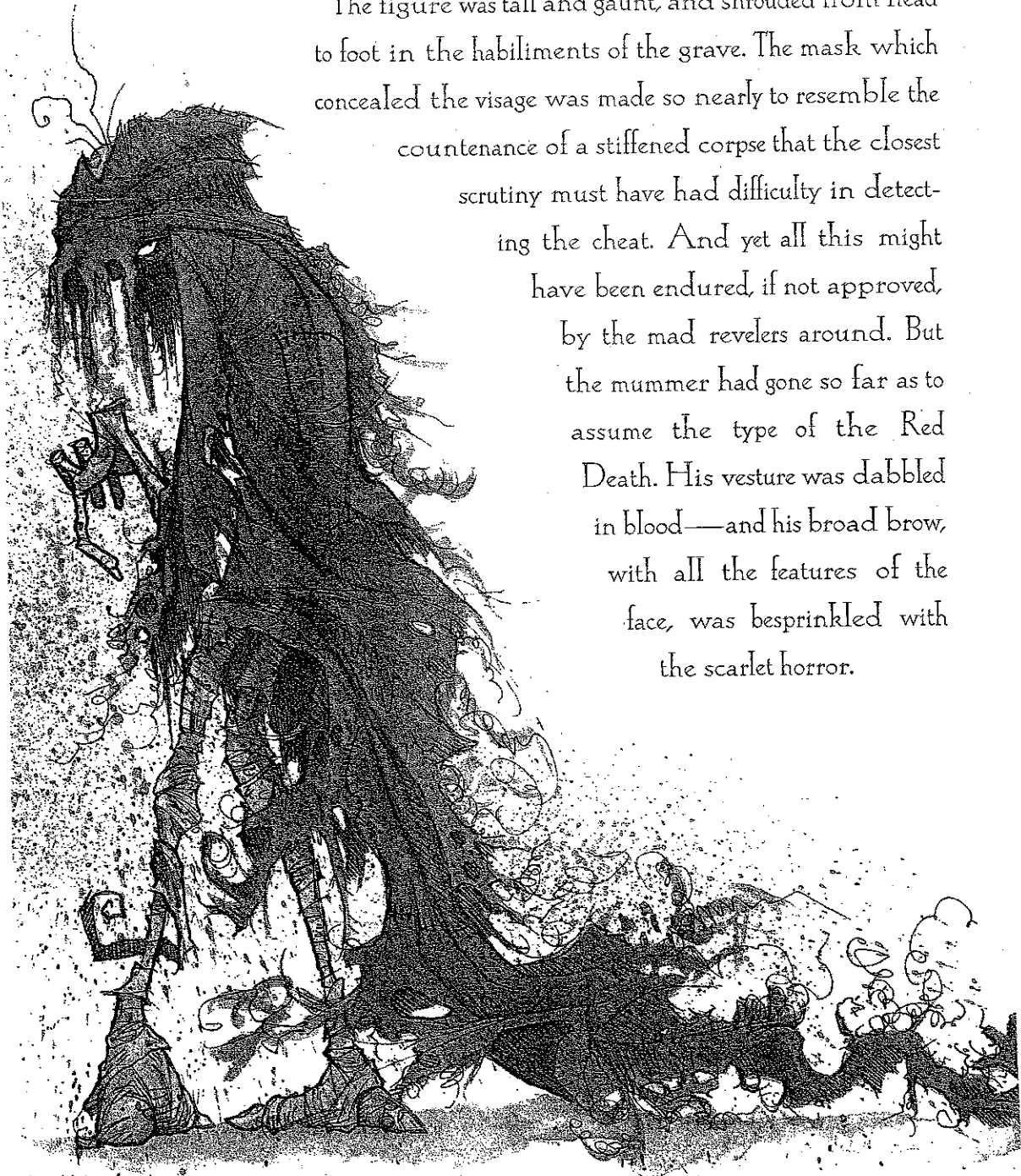
and before the last echoes of the last chime had utterly sunk into silence, there were many individuals in the crowd who had found leisure to become aware of the presence of a masked figure which had arrested the attention of no single individual before.





In an assembly of phantasms such as I have painted, it may well be supposed that no ordinary appearance could have excited such sensation. In truth the masquerade license of the night was nearly unlimited; but the figure in question had gone beyond the bounds of even the prince's indefinite decorum. There are chords in the hearts of the most reckless which cannot be touched without emotion. There are matters of which no jest can be made. The whole company, indeed, seemed now deeply to feel that in the costume and bearing of the stranger neither wit nor propriety existed.

The figure was tall and gaunt and shrouded from head to foot in the habiliments of the grave. The mask which concealed the visage was made so nearly to resemble the countenance of a stiffened corpse that the closest scrutiny must have had difficulty in detecting the cheat. And yet all this might have been endured, if not approved, by the mad revelers around. But the mummer had gone so far as to assume the type of the Red Death. His vesture was dabbled in blood—and his broad brow, with all the features of the face, was besprinkled with the scarlet horror.



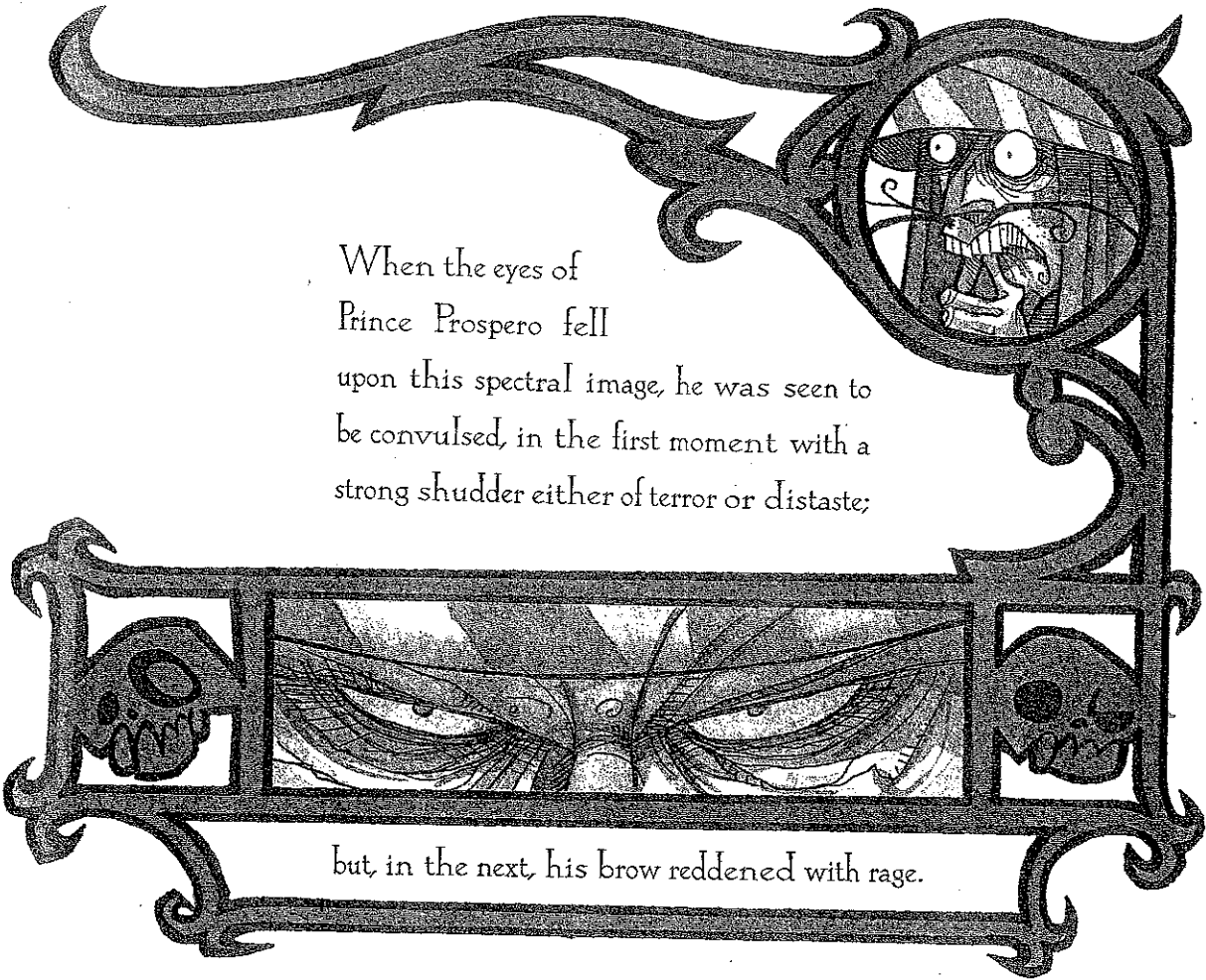
When the eyes of
Prince Prospero fell
upon this spectral image, he was seen to
be convulsed, in the first moment with a
strong shudder either of terror or distaste;

but, in the next, his brow reddened with rage.

"Who dares?"

he demanded hoarsely of the courtiers
who stood near him—

"Who dares insult us with this
blasphemous mockery? Seize him
and unmask him—that we may know
whom we have to hang, at sunrise
from the battlements!"



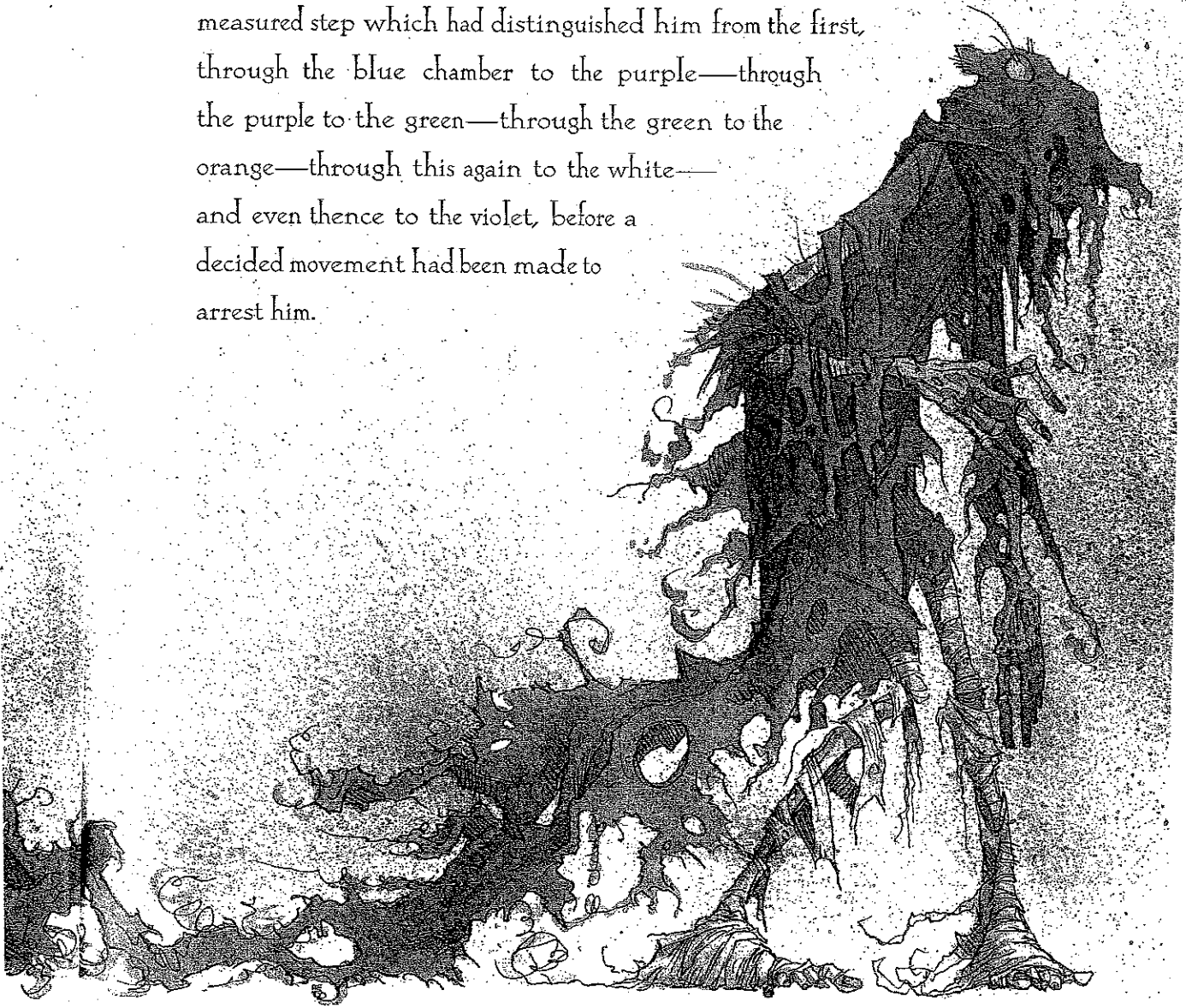
It was in the eastern or blue chamber in which stood the Prince Prospero as he uttered these words. They rang throughout the seven rooms loudly and clearly—for the prince was a bold and robust man, and the music had become hushed at the waving of his hand.

It was in the blue room where stood the prince, with a group of pale courtiers by his side. At first, as he spoke, there was a slight rushing movement of this group in the direction of the intruder, who at the moment was also near at hand, and now, with deliberate and stately step, made closer approach to the speaker.

But from a certain nameless awe with which the mad assumptions of the mummer had inspired the whole party, there were



found none who put forth hand to seize him; so that, unimpeded, he passed within a yard of the prince's person; and, while the vast assembly, as if with one impulse, shrank from the centers of the rooms to the walls, he made his way uninterruptedly, but with the same solemn and measured step which had distinguished him from the first, through the blue chamber to the purple—through the purple to the green—through the green to the orange—through this again to the white—and even thence to the violet, before a decided movement had been made to arrest him.



It was then, however, that the Prince Prospero, maddening with rage and the shame of his own momentary cowardice, rushed hurriedly through the six chambers, while none followed him on account of a deadly terror that had seized upon all.



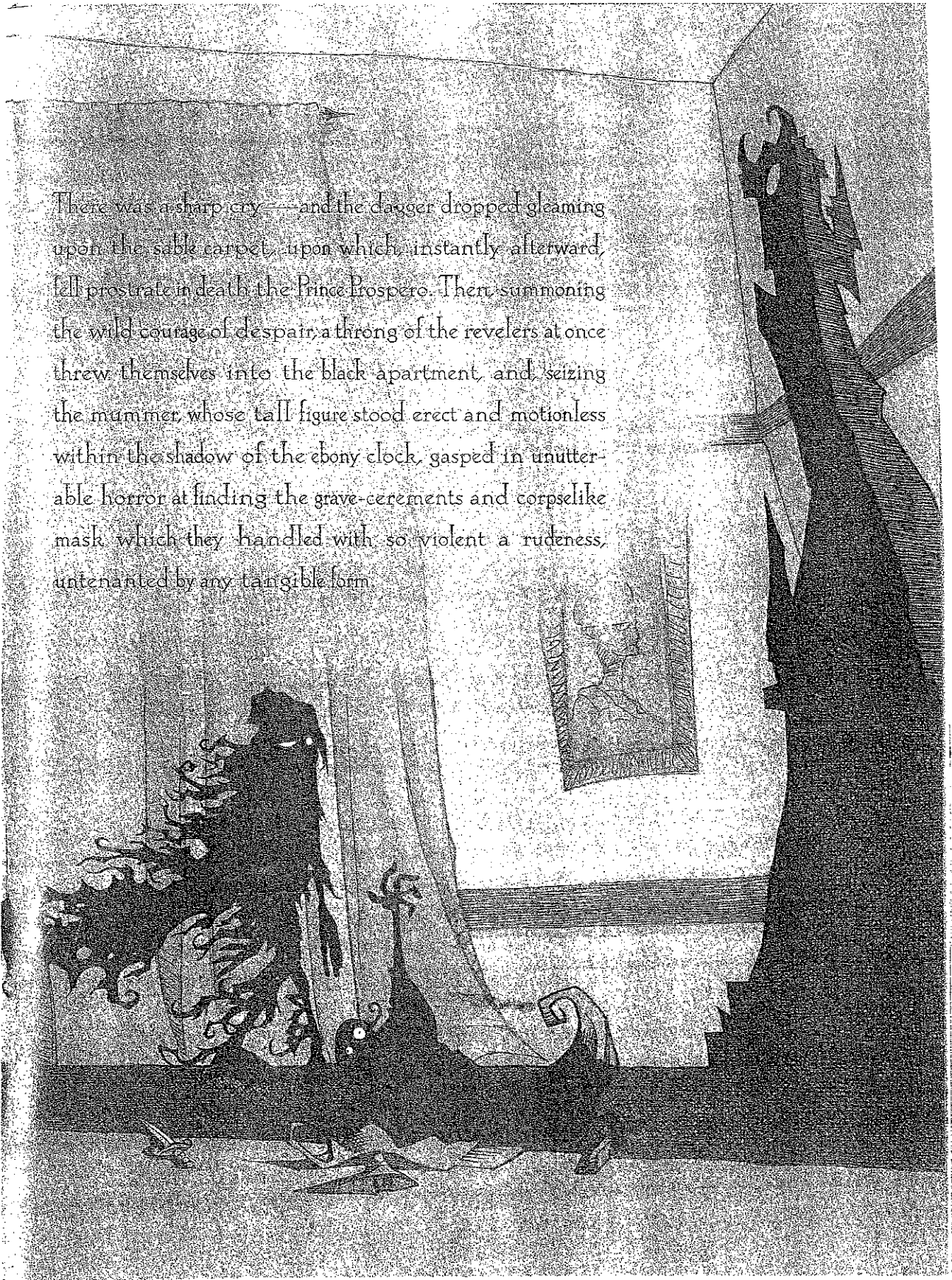
He bore aloft a drawn dagger, and had approached, in rapid impetuosity, to within three or four feet of the retreating figure,



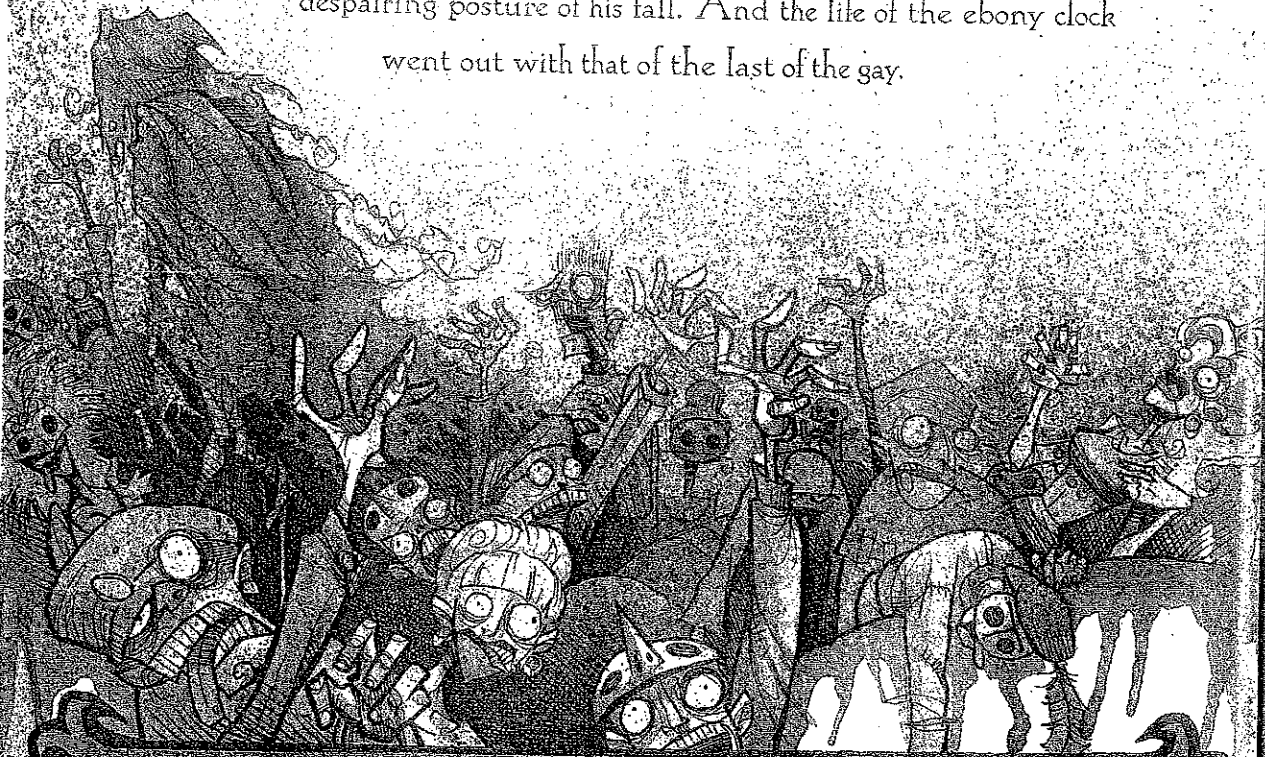
when the latter, having attained the extremity of the velvet apartment, turned suddenly and confronted his pursuer.



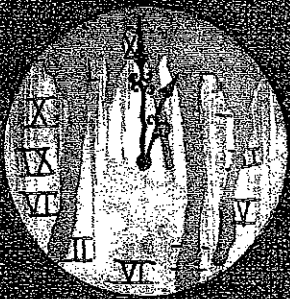
There was a sharp cry—and the dagger dropped gleaming upon the sable carpet, upon which instantly afterward fell prostrate in death the Prince Prospero. Then, summoning the wild courage of despair, a throng of the revelers at once threw themselves into the black apartment, and, seizing the mummy, whose tall figure stood erect and motionless within the shadow of the ebony clock, gasped in unutterable horror at finding the grave-cerements and corpselike mask which they handled with so violent a rudeness, untenanted by any tangible form.



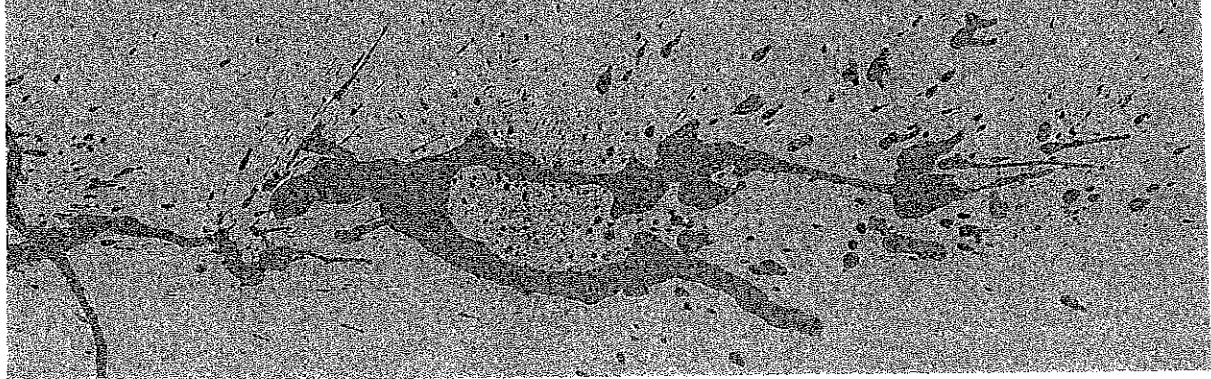
And now was acknowledged the presence of the Red Death. He had come like a thief in the night. And one by one dropped the revelers in the blood-bedewed halls of their revel and died each in the despairing posture of his fall. And the life of the ebony clock went out with that of the last of the gay.



And the flames of the tripods expired. And Darkness and Decay and the Red Death held illimitable dominion over all.



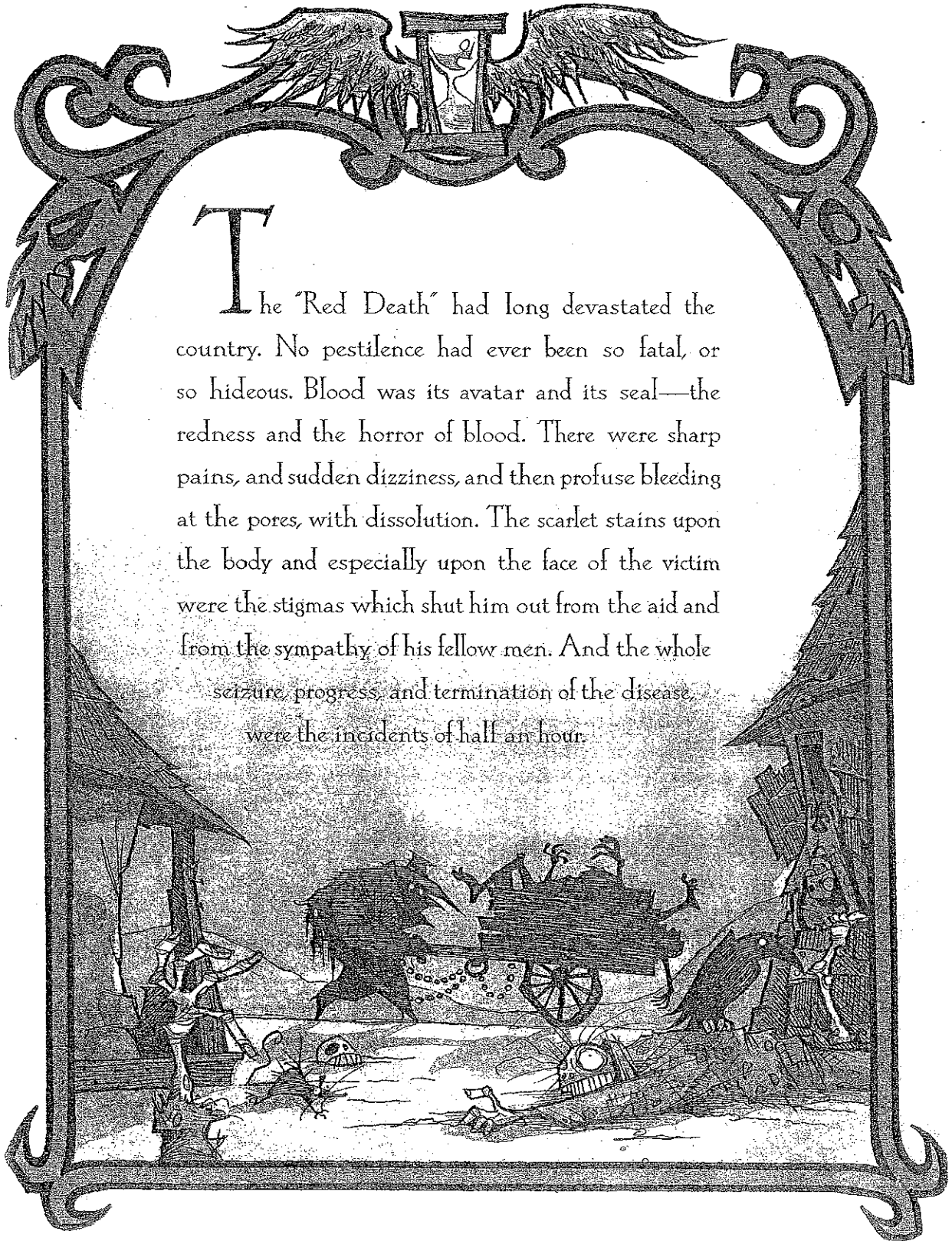
The Masque of the Red Death



III

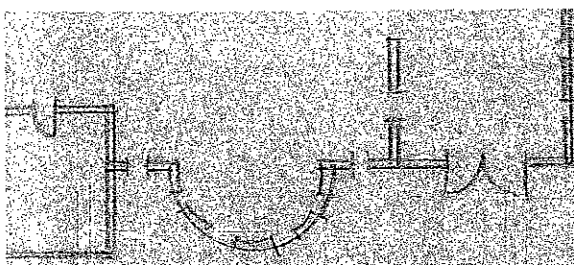
T

he "Red Death" had long devastated the country. No pestilence had ever been so fatal, or so hideous. Blood was its avatar and its seal—the redness and the horror of blood. There were sharp pains, and sudden dizziness, and then profuse bleeding at the pores, with dissolution. The scarlet stains upon the body and especially upon the face of the victim were the stigmas which shut him out from the aid and from the sympathy of his fellow men. And the whole seizure, progress, and termination of the disease, were the incidents of half an hour.

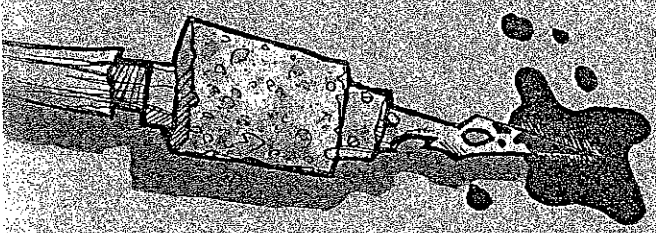
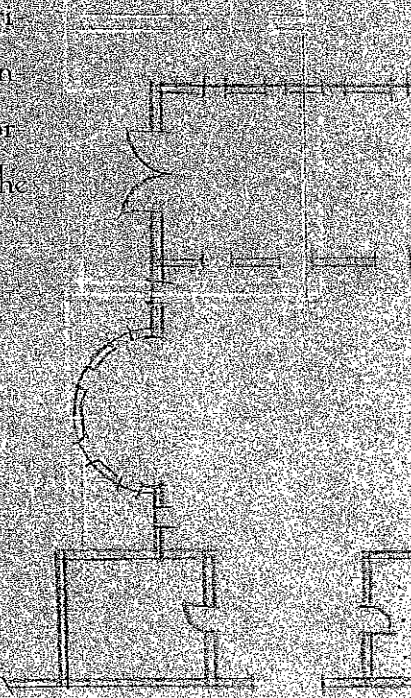


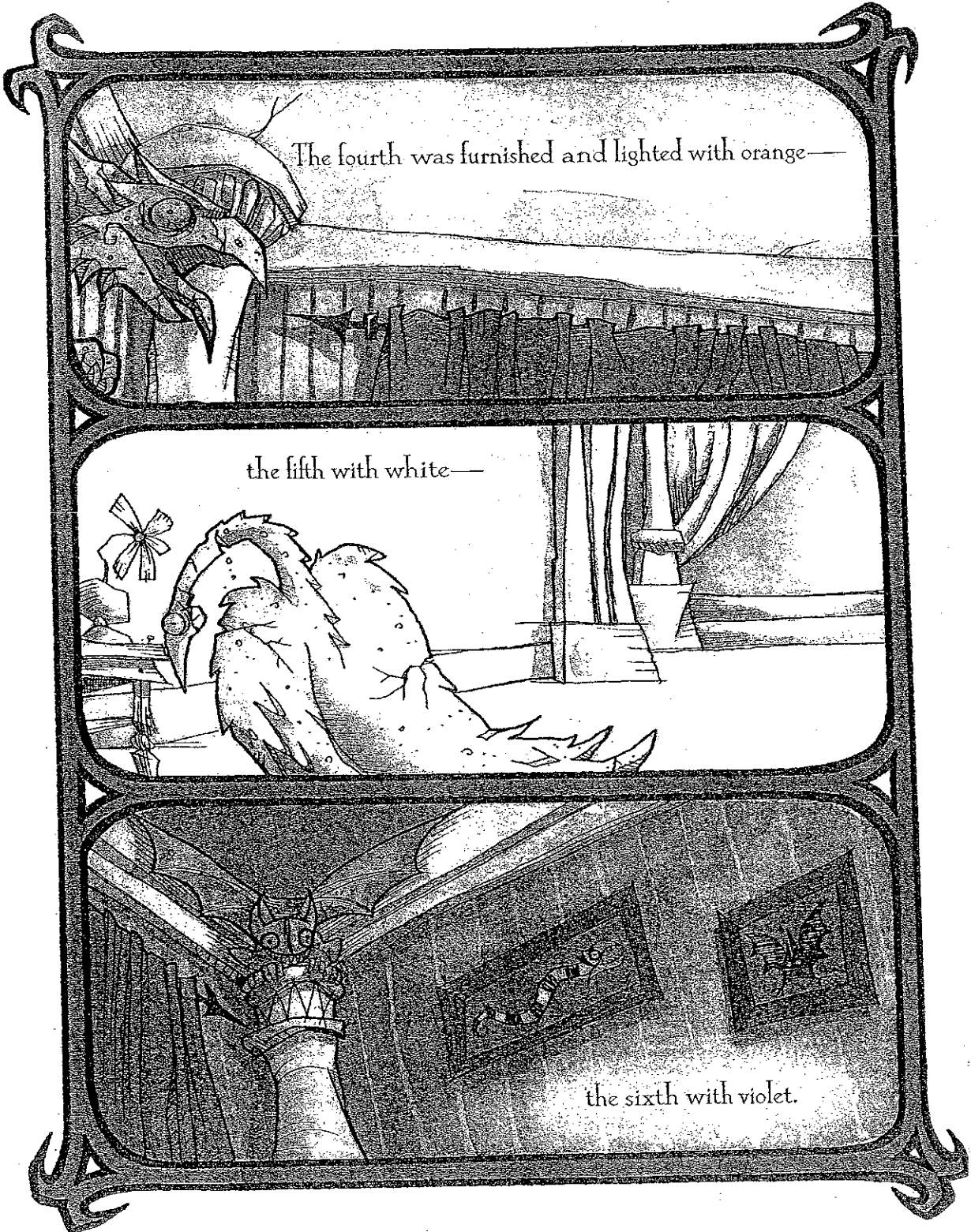
The abbey was amply provisioned. With such precautions the courtiers might bid defiance to contagion. The external world could take care of itself. In the meantime it was folly to grieve, or to think. The prince had provided all the appliances of pleasure. There were buffoons, there were ballet dancers, there were musicians, there was Beauty, there was wine. All these and security were within. Without was the "Red Death."





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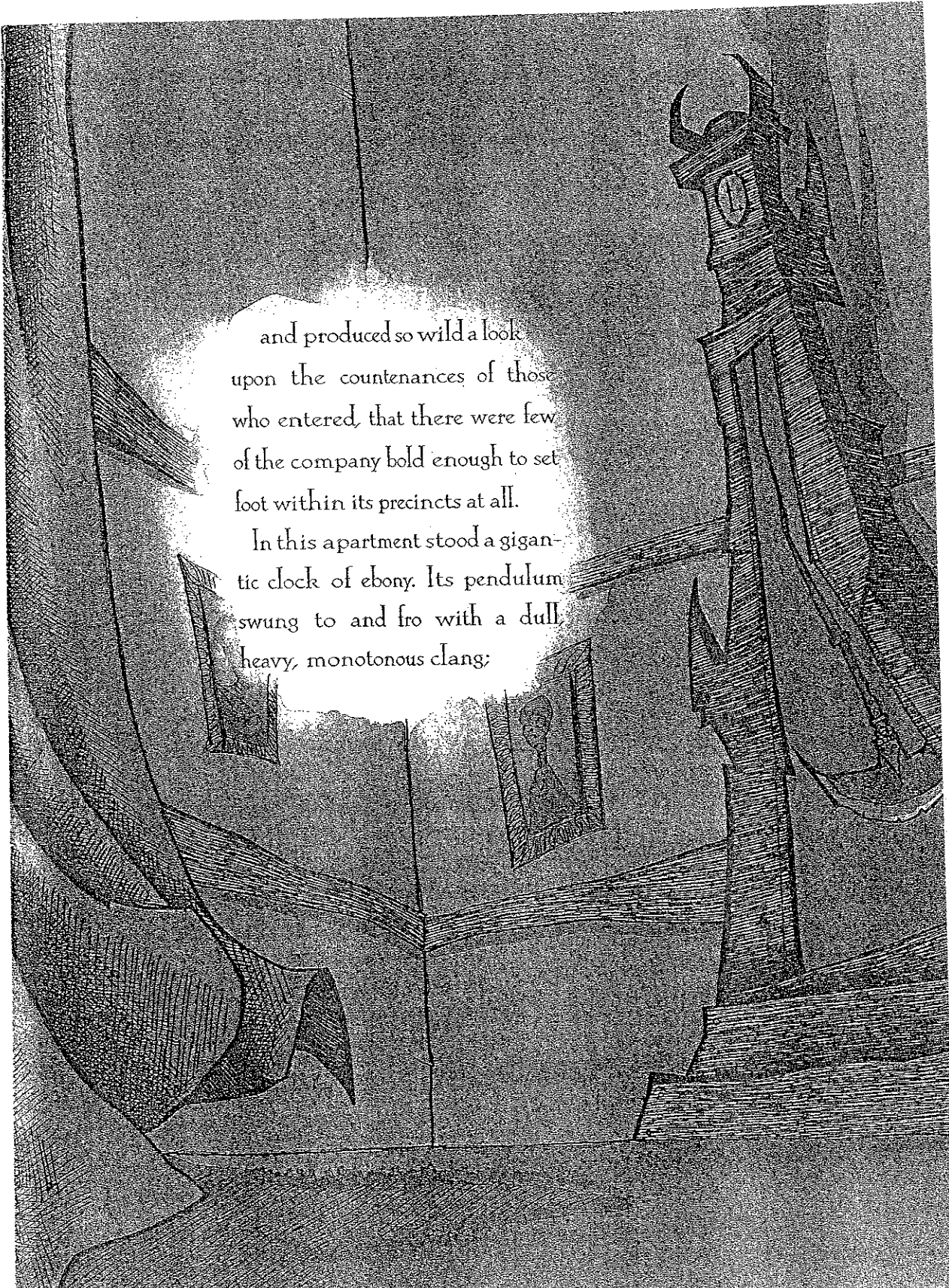




The fourth was furnished and lighted with orange—

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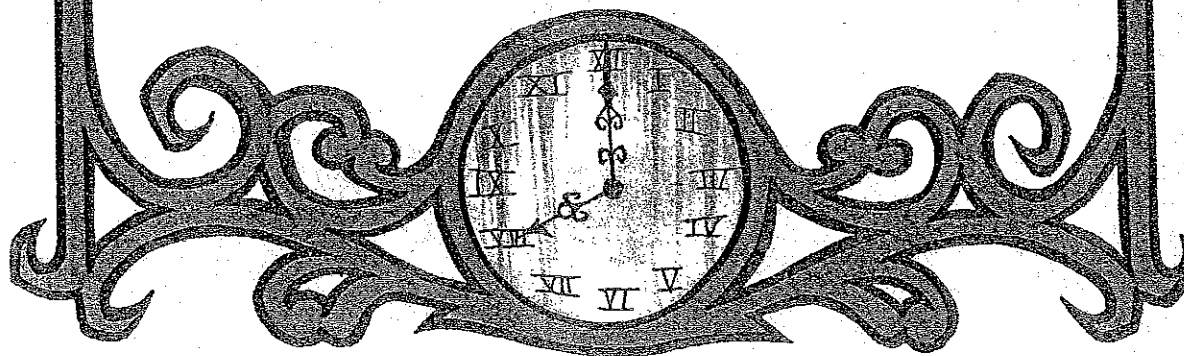


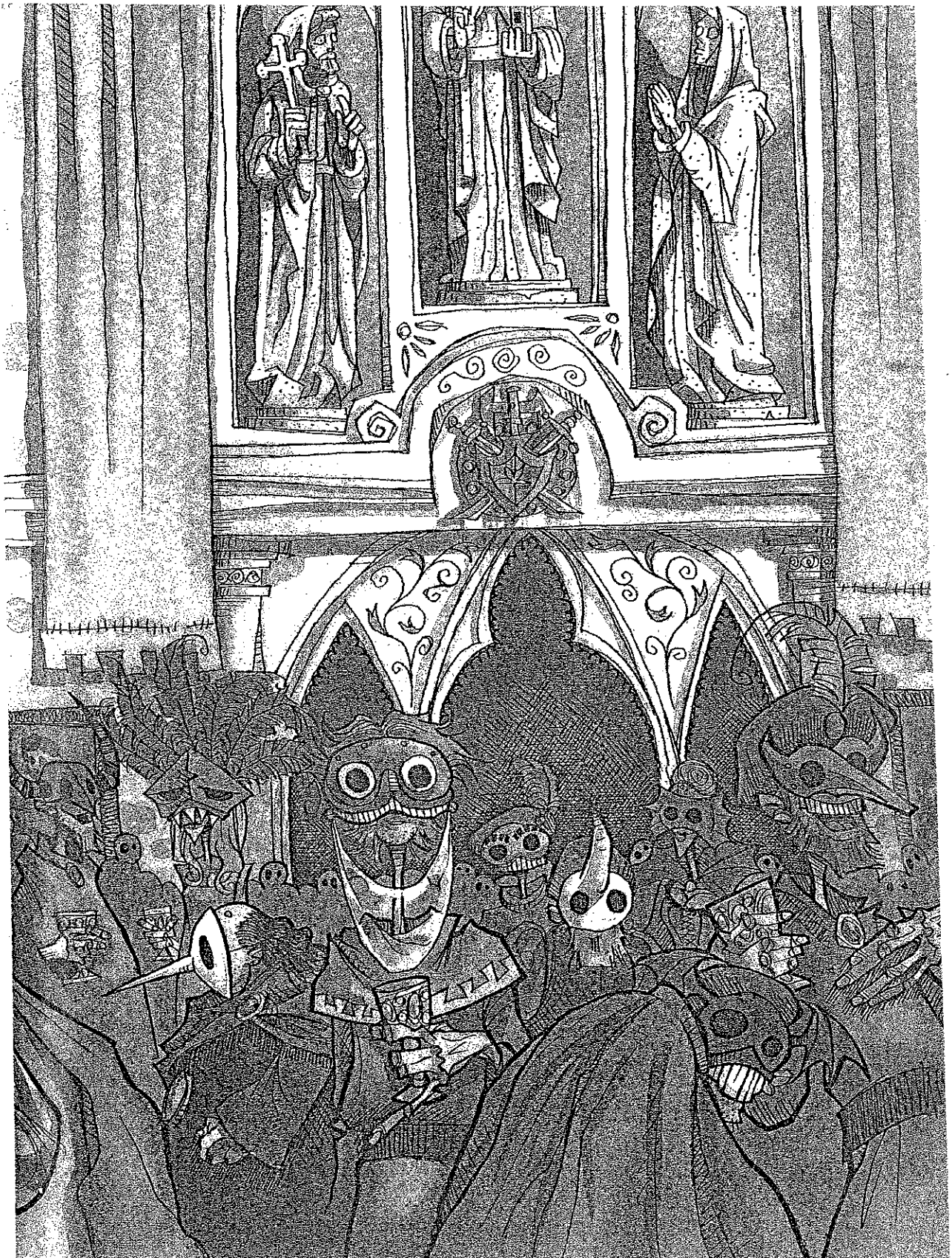
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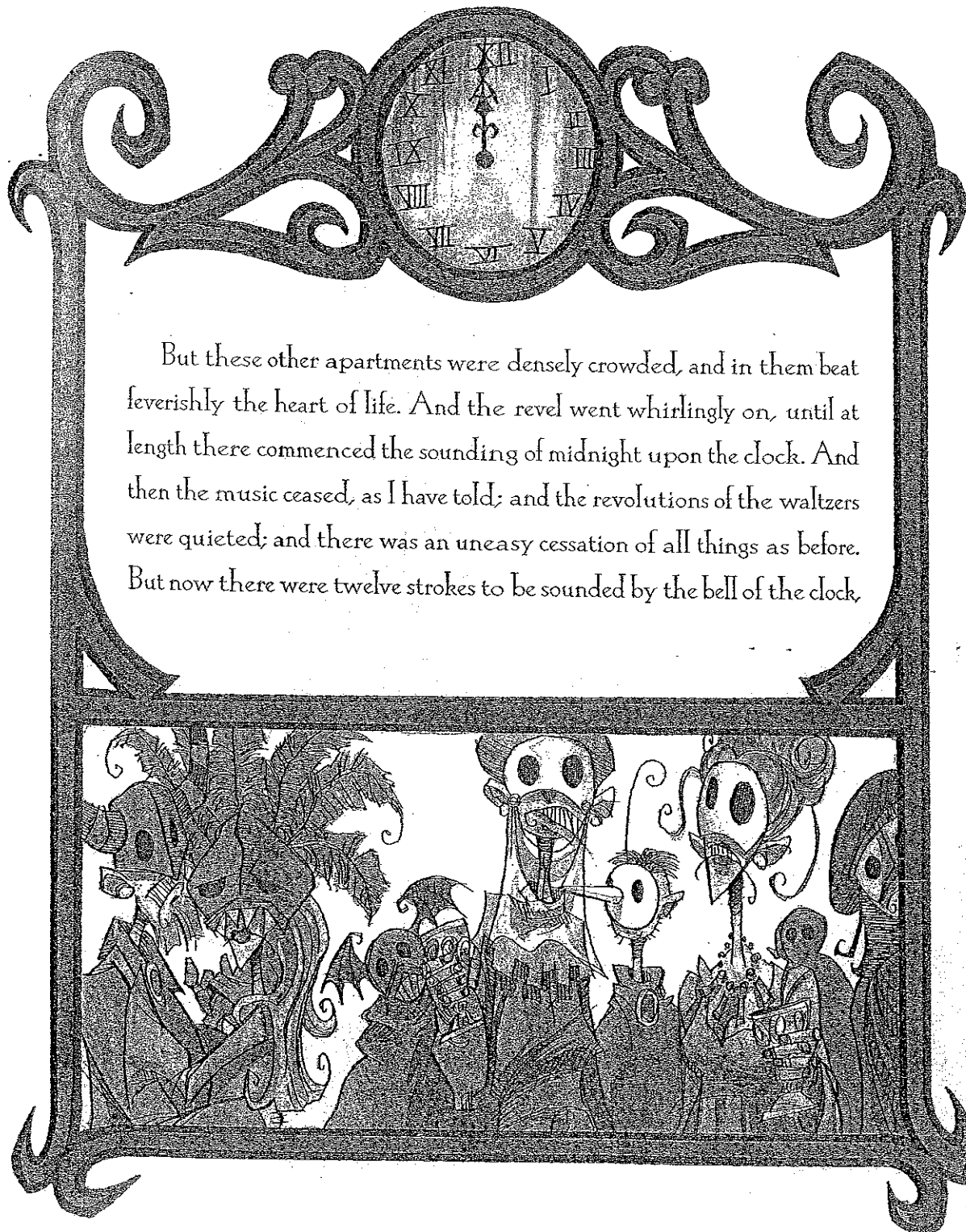
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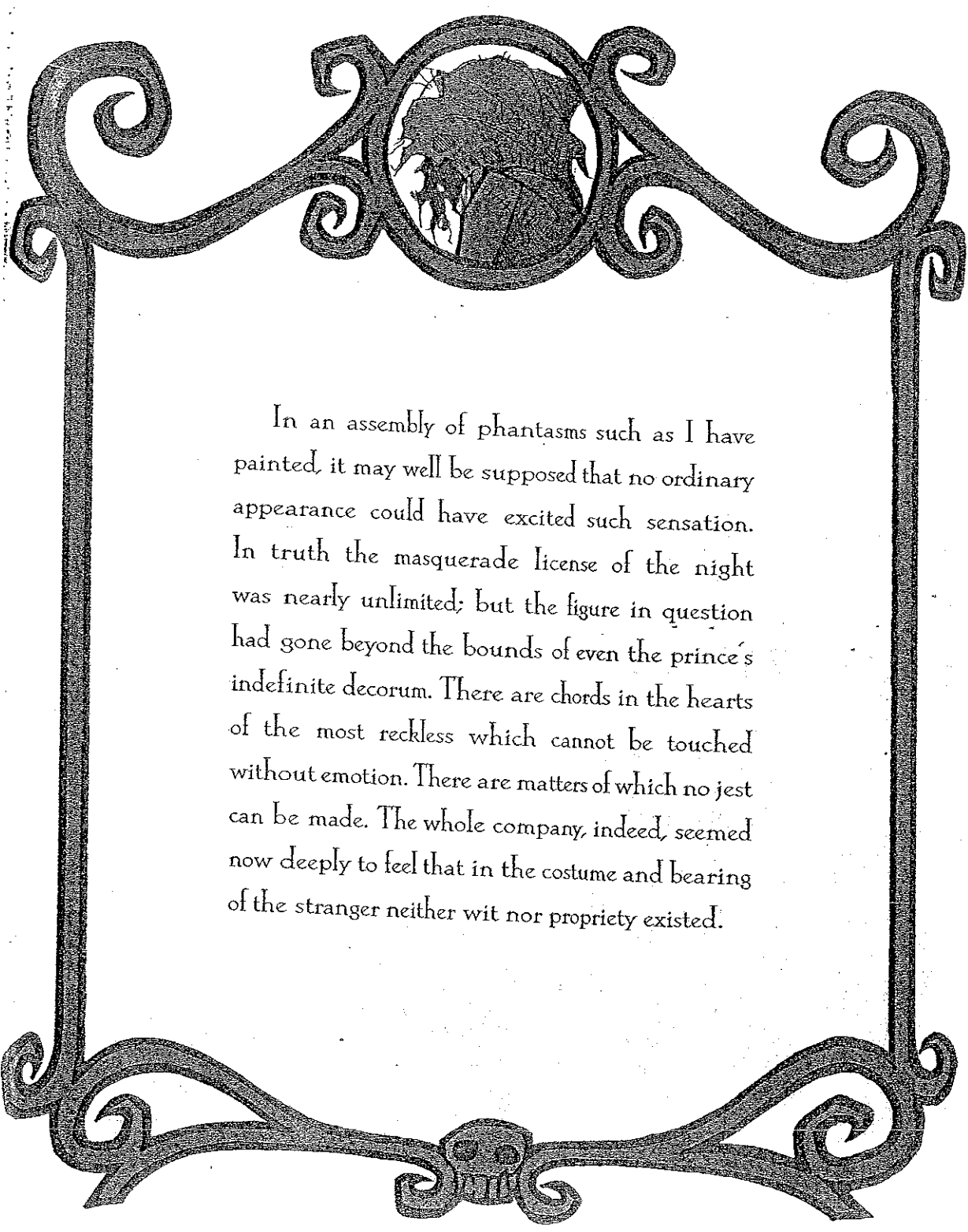
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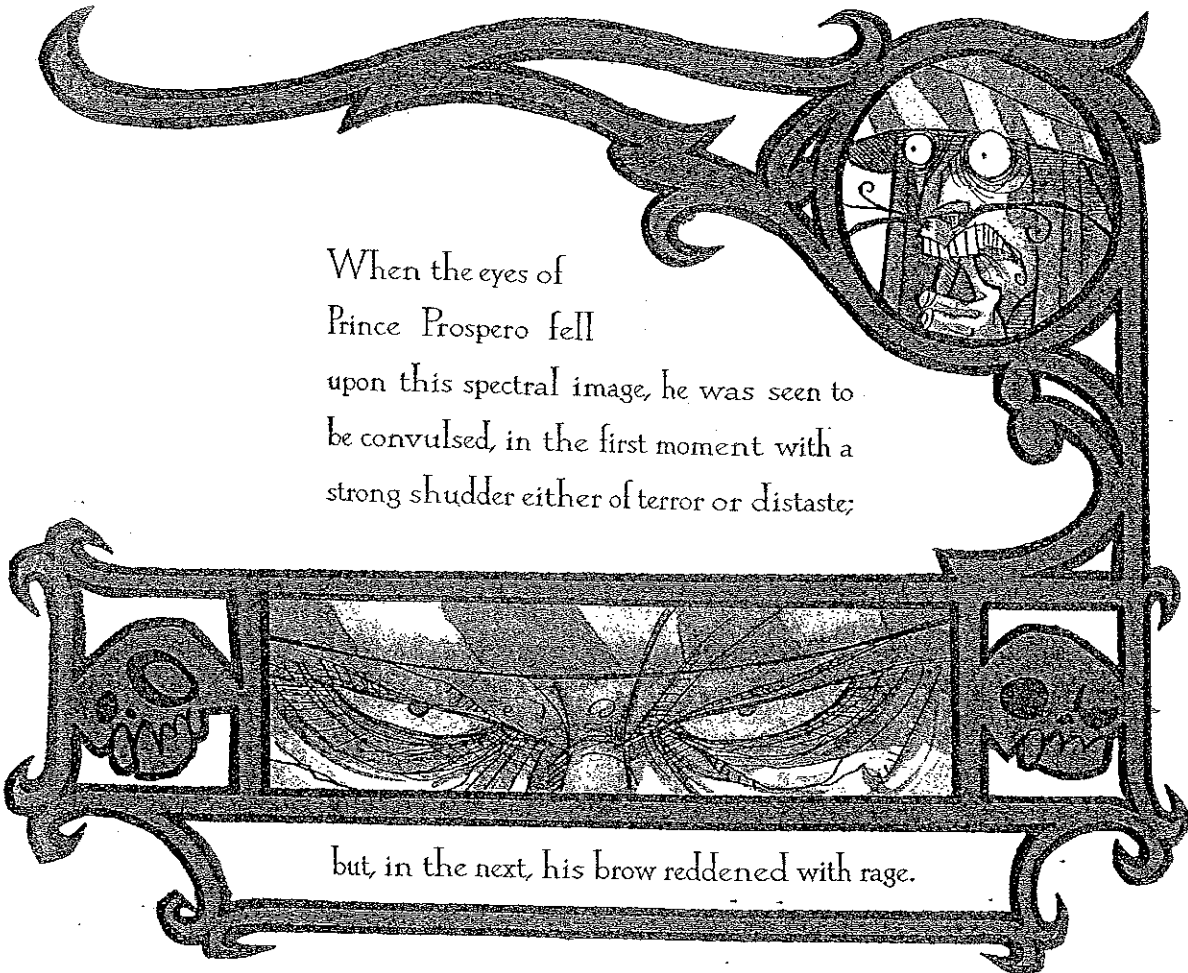




But these other apartments were densely crowded, and in them beat feverishly the heart of life. And the revel went whirlingly on, until at length there commenced the sounding of midnight upon the clock. And then the music ceased, as I have told; and the revolutions of the waltzers were quieted; and there was an uneasy cessation of all things as before. But now there were twelve strokes to be sounded by the bell of the clock,



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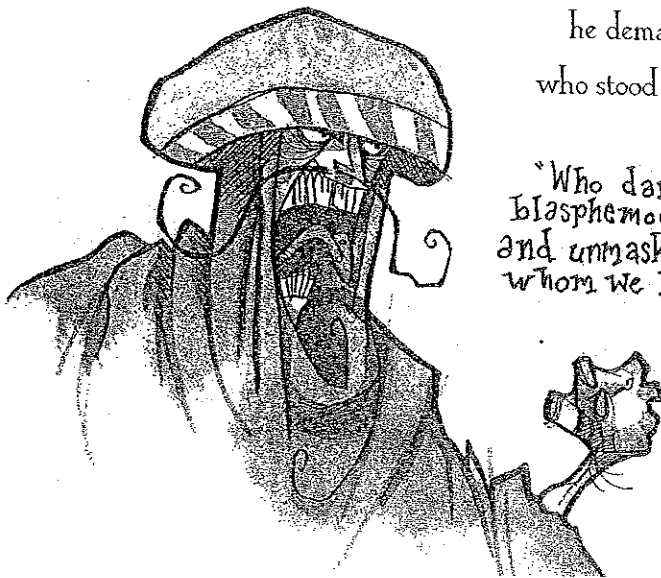
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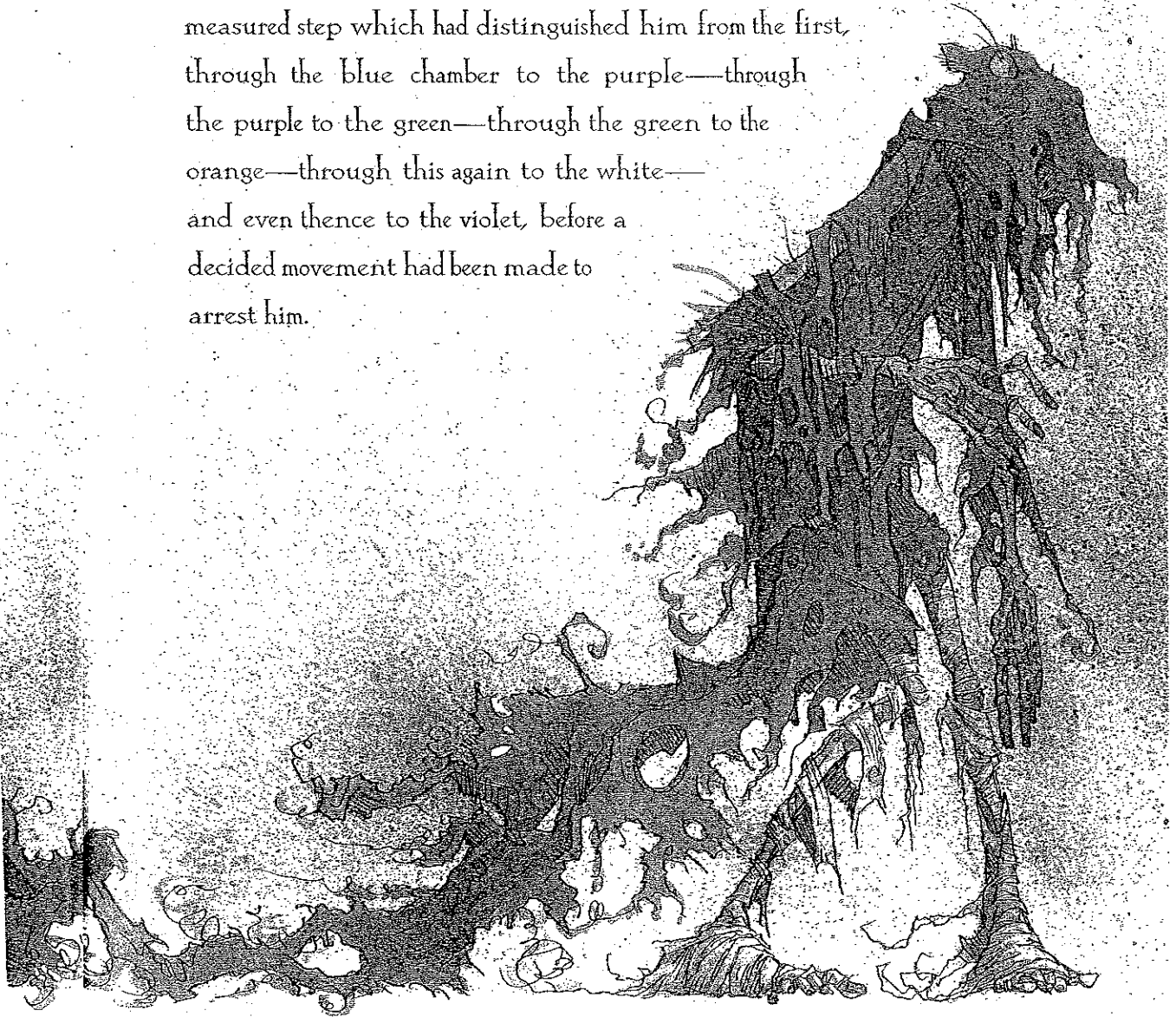
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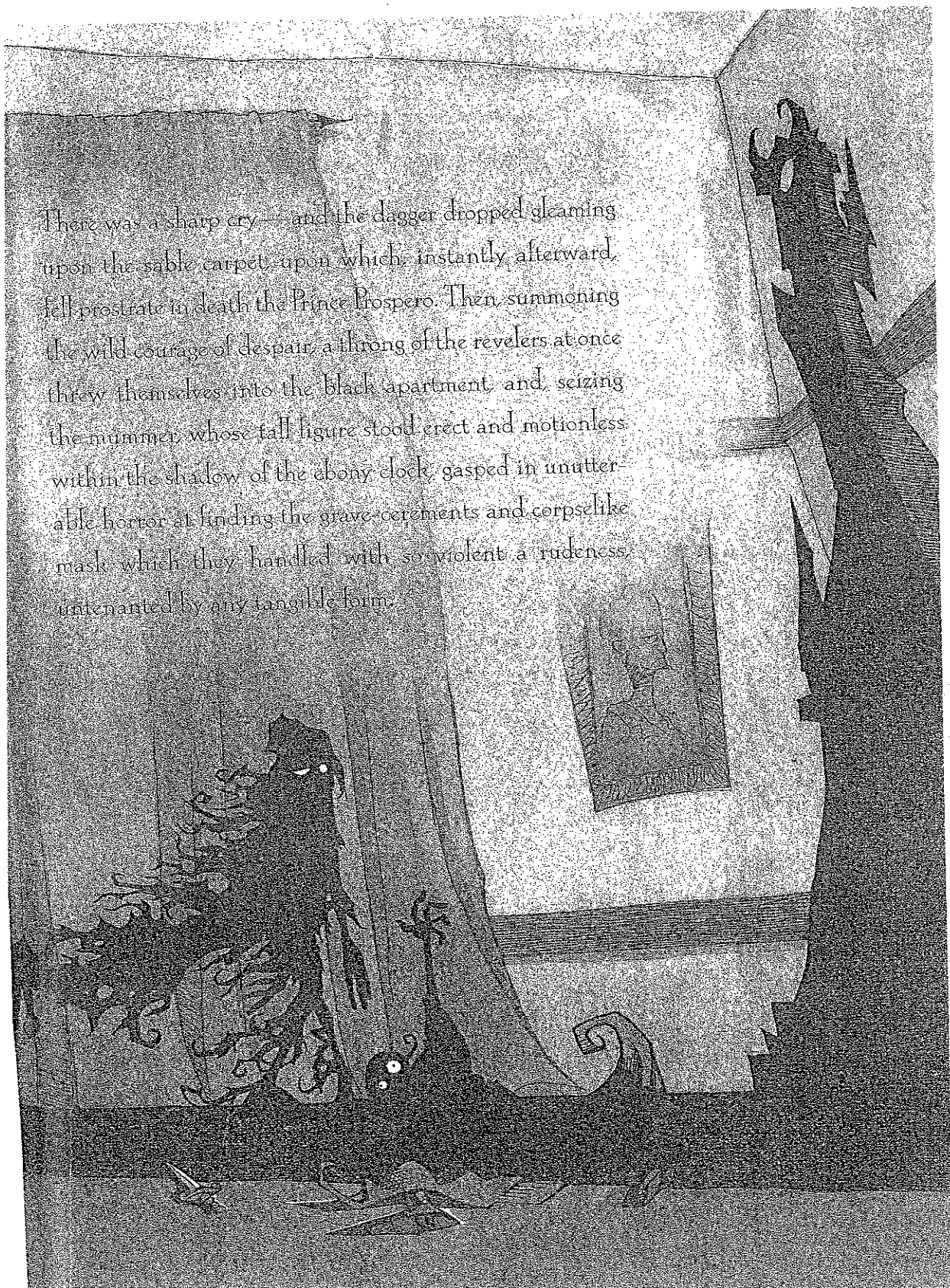
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and unmask him—that we may know
whom we have to hang, at sunrise
from the battlements!"



found none who put forth hand to seize him; so that, unimpeded, he passed within a yard of the prince's person; and, while the vast assembly, as if with one impulse, shrank from the centers of the rooms to the walls, he made his way uninterruptedly, but with the same solemn and measured step which had distinguished him from the first, through the blue chamber to the purple—through the purple to the green—through the green to the orange—through this again to the white—and even thence to the violet, before a decided movement had been made to arrest him.



There was a sharp cry — and the dagger dropped gleaming upon the sable carpet upon which instantly afterward fell prostrate in death the Prince Prospero. Then, summoning the wild courage of despair, a throng of the revelers at once threw themselves into the black apartment, and, seizing the mummy whose tall figure stood erect and motionless within the shadow of the ebony clock, gasped in unutterable horror at finding the grave-cerements and corpselike mask which they handled with so violent a rudeness untenanted by any tangible form.



The Masque of the Red Death

EDGAR ALLAN POE

The "Red Death" had long devastated the country. No pestilence had ever been so fatal, or so hideous. Blood was its avatar¹ and its seal—the redness and the horror of blood. There were sharp pains, and sudden dizziness, and then profuse bleeding at the pores, with dissolution. The scarlet stains upon the body, and especially upon the face, of the victim were the pest ban which shut him out from the aid and from the sympathy of his fellow men. And the whole seizure, progress, and termination of the disease were the incidents of half an hour.

But the Prince Prospero was happy and dauntless and sagacious.² When his dominions were half depopulated, he summoned to his presence a thousand hale and light-hearted friends from among the knights and dames of his court, and with these retired to the deep seclusion of one of his castellated³ abbeys. This was an extensive and magnificent structure, the creation of the prince's own eccentric yet august taste. A strong and lofty wall girdled it in. This wall

had gates of iron. The courtiers, having entered, brought furnaces and massy hammers, and welded the bolts. They resolved to leave means neither of ingress or egress to the sudden impulses of despair or of frenzy from within. The abbey was amply provisioned. With such precautions the courtiers might bid defiance to contagion. The external world could take care of itself. In the meantime it was folly to grieve, or to think. The prince had provided all the appliances of pleasure. There were buffoons,⁴ there were improvisatori,⁴ there were ballet-dancers, there were musicians, there was Beauty, there was wine. All these and security were within. Without was the Red Death.

It was toward the close of the fifth or sixth month of his seclusion, and while the pestilence raged most furiously abroad, that the Prince Prospero entertained his thousand friends at a masked ball of the most unusual magnificence.

It was a voluptuous scene, that masquerade. But first let me tell of the rooms in which it was held. There were seven—an imperial suite. In many palaces, however, such suites form a long and straight vista, while the folding doors slide back nearly to the walls on either hand, so that the view of the whole extent is scarcely impeded. Here the case was very different, as might have been expected from the prince's love of the bizarre. The apartments were so irregularly disposed that the vision embraced but little more than one at a time. There was a sharp turn at every twenty or thirty yards, and at each turn a novel effect. To the right and left, in the middle of each wall, a tall and narrow Gothic window looked out upon a closed corridor which pursued the windings of the suite. These windows were of stained glass, whose color varied in accordance with the prevailing hue of the decorations of the chamber into which it opened. That at the eastern extremity was hung, for example, in blue—and vividly blue were its windows. The second chamber was purple in its ornaments and tapestries, and here the panes were purple. The third was green throughout, and so were the case-

¹Embodiment.

²Built like a castle.

³Clowns.

⁴Composers of extemporaneous songs, poems, or poetic drama.

ments. The fourth was furnished and lighted with orange, the fifth with white, the sixth with violet. The seventh apartment was closely shrouded in black velvet tapestries that hung all over the ceiling and down the walls, falling in heavy folds upon a carpet of the same material and hue. But, in this chamber only, the color of the windows failed to correspond with the decorations. The panes here were scarlet—a deep blood-color. Now in no one of the seven apartments was there any lamp or candelabrum, amid the profusion of golden ornaments that lay scattered to and fro or depended from the roof. There was no light of any kind emanating from lamp or candle within the suite of chambers. But in the corridors that followed the suite there stood, opposite to each window, a heavy tripod, bearing a brazier of fire, that projected its rays through the tinted glass and so glaringly illumined the room. And thus were produced a multitude of gaudy and fantastic appearances. But in the western or black chamber the effect of the firelight that streamed upon the dark hangings through the blood-tinted panes was ghastly in the extreme, and produced so wild a look upon the countenances of those who entered that there were few of the company bold enough to set foot within its precincts at all.

It was in this apartment, also, that there stood against the western wall a gigantic clock of ebony. Its pendulum swung to and fro with a dull, heavy, monotonous clang; and when the minute hand made the circuit of the face, and the hour was to be stricken, there came from the brazen lungs of the clock a sound which was clear and loud and deep and exceedingly musical, but of so peculiar a note and emphasis that, at each lapse of an hour, the musicians of the orchestra were constrained to pause, momentarily, in their performance, to hearken to the sound; and thus the waltzers perforce ceased their evolutions; and there was a brief disconcert of the whole gay company; and, while the chimes of the clock yet rang, it was observed that the giddiest grew pale, and the more aged and sedate passed their hands over their brows as if in confused reverie or meditation. But when the echoes had fully ceased, a light

laughter at once pervaded the assembly; the musicians looked at each other and smiled as if at their own nervousness and folly, and made whispering vows, each to the other, that the next chiming of the clock should produce in them no similar emotion and then, after the lapse of sixty minutes (which embrace three thousand and six hundred seconds of the Time that flies) there came yet another chiming of the clock, and then were the same disconcert and tremulousness and meditation as before.

But, in spite of these things, it was a gay and magnificent revel. The tastes of the prince were peculiar. He had a fine eye for colors and effects. He disregarded the *decora*⁵ of mere fashion. His plans were bold and fiery, and his conceptions glowed with barbaric luster. There are some who would have thought him mad. His followers felt that he was not. It was necessary to hear and see and touch him to be *sure* that he was not.

He had directed, in great part, the movable embellishments of the seven chambers, upon occasion of this great fête; and it was his own guiding taste which had given character to the masqueraders. Be sure they were grotesque. There were much glare and glitter and piquancy and phantasm⁶—much of what has been since seen in *Hernani*.⁷ There were arabesque⁸ figures with unsuited limbs and appointments. There were delirious fancies such as the madman fashions. There was much of the beautiful, much of the wanton, much of the bizarre, something of the terrible, and not a little of that which might have excited disgust. To and fro in the seven chambers there stalked, in fact, a multitude of dreams. And these—the dreams—writhed in and about, taking hue from the rooms, and causing the wild music of the orchestra to seem as the echo of their steps. And, anon, there strikes the ebony clock which stands in the hall of the velvet. And then, for a moment, all is still, and all is silent save the voice of the clock. The dreams are stiff frozen as they stand. But the

⁵Fitness; propriety.

⁶PIQUANCY AND PHANTASM—Zest and fantasy.

⁷A famous tragic melodrama by Victor Hugo (1802-1885).

echoes of the chime die away—they have endured but an instant—and a light, half-subdued laughter floats after them as they depart. And now again the music swells, and the dreams live, and writhe to and fro more merrily than ever, taking hue from the many-tinted windows through which stream the rays from the tripods. But to the chamber which lies most westwardly of the seven, there are now none of the maskers who venture; for the night is waning away, and there flows a ruddier light through the blood-colored panes; and the blackness of the sable drapery appalls; and to him whose foot falls upon the sable carpet, there comes from the near clock of ebony a muffled peal more solemnly emphatic than any which reaches their ears who indulge in the more remote gaieties of the other apartments.

But these other apartments were densely crowded, and in them beat feverishly the heart of life. And the revel went whirlingly on, until at length there commenced the sounding of midnight upon the clock. And then the music ceased, as I have told; and the evolutions of the waltzers were quieted; and there was an uneasy cessation of all things as before. But now there were twelve strokes to be sounded by the bell of the clock; and thus it happened, perhaps, that more of thought crept, with more of time, into the meditations of the thoughtful among those who reveled. And thus too it happened, perhaps, that before the last echoes of the last chime had utterly sunk into silence, there were many individuals in the crowd who had found leisure to become aware of the presence of a masked figure which had arrested the attention of no single individual before. And the rumor of this new presence having spread itself whisperingly around, there arose at length from the whole company a buzz, or murmur, expressive of disapprobation and surprise—then, finally, of terror, of horror, and of disgust.

In an assembly of phantasms such as I have painted, it may well be supposed that no ordinary appearance could have excited such sensation. In truth the masquerade license of the night was nearly unlimited; but the figure in question had out-Heroded Herod, and gone beyond the bound of even the prince's indefinite decorum. There are

chords in the hearts of the most reckless which cannot be touched without emotion. *Even with the utterly lost, to whom life and death are equally jests, there are matters of which no jest can be made. The whole company, indeed, seemed now deeply to feel that in the costume and bearing of the stranger neither wit nor propriety existed. The figure was tall and gaunt, and shrouded from head to foot in the habiliments^o of the grave. The mask which concealed the visage was made so nearly to resemble the countenance of a stiffened corpse that the closest scrutiny must have had difficulty in detecting the cheat. And yet all this might have been endured, if not approved, by the mad revelers around. But the mummer^a had gone so far as to assume the type of the Red Death. His vesture was dabbled in *blood*—and his broad brow, with all the features of the face, was besprinkled with the scarlet horror.

When the eyes of Prince Prospero fell upon this spectral image (which with a slow and solemn movement, as if more fully to sustain its rôle, stalked to and fro among the waltzers) he was seen to be convulsed, in the first moment, with a strong shudder either of terror or distaste; but, in the next, his brow reddened with rage.

"Who dares?" he demanded hoarsely of the courtiers who stood near him—"who dares insult us with this blasphemous mockery? Seize him and unmask him—that we may know whom we have to hang at sunrise, from the battlements!"

It was in the eastern or blue chamber in which stood the Prince Prospero as he uttered these words. They rang throughout the seven rooms loudly and clearly—for the prince was a bold and robust man, and the music had become hushed at the waving of his hand.

It was in the blue room where stood the prince, with a group of pale courtiers by his side. At first, as he spoke, there was a slight rushing movement of this group in the direction of the intruder, who at the moment was also near at hand, and now, with deliberate and stately step, made

*Masquerader.

closer approach to the speaker. But from a certain nameless awe with which the mad assumptions of the mummer had inspired the whole party, there were found none who put forth hand to seize him; so that, unimpeded, he passed within a yard of the prince's person; and while the vast assembly, as if with one impulse, shrank from the centers of the rooms to the walls, he made his way uninterrupted, but with the same solemn and measured step which had distinguished him from the first, through the blue chamber to the purple—through the purple to the green—through the green to the orange—through this again to the white—and even thence to the violet, ere a decided movement had been made to arrest him. It was then, however, that the Prince Prospero, maddening with rage and the shame of his own momentary cowardice, rushed hurriedly through the six chambers, while none followed him on account of a deadly terror that had seized upon all. He bore aloft a drawn dagger, and had approached, in rapid impetuosity, to within three or four feet of the retreating figure, when the latter, having attained the extremity of the velvet apartment, turned suddenly and confronted his pursuer. There was a sharp cry—and the dagger dropped gleaming upon the sable carpet, upon which, instantly afterwards, fell prostrate in death the Prince Prospero. Then, summoning the wild courage of despair, a throng of the revelers at once threw themselves into the black apartment, and, seizing the mummer, whose tall figure stood erect and motionless within the shade of the ebony clock, gasped in unutterable horror at finding the grave-cerements and corpselike mask, which they handled with so violent a rudeness, untenanted by any tangible form.

And now was acknowledged the presence of the Red Death. He had come like a thief in the night. And one by one dropped the revelers in the blood-bedewed halls of their revel, and died each in the despairing posture of his fall. And the life of the ebony clock went out with that of the last of the gay. And the flames of the tripods expired. And Darkness and Decay and the Red Death held illimitable dominion over all.

"The Masque of the Red Death" by Edgar Allan Poe
DO NOT ANSWER ON THIS SHEET. OUT OF A POSSIBLE FIFTEEN MARKS

Choose the best answer to each of the following five questions.

1. A covering with cloth for the dead is called a(n)
 - a. tunic.
 - b. abbey.
 - c. yarmulke.
 - d. shroud.
2. A building, like one belonging to a church, is a(n)
 - a. galley.
 - b. abbey.
 - c. hallmark.
 - d. shroud.
3. A word meaning "deadly disease" is
 - a. calypso.
 - b. plethora.
 - c. adoration.
 - d. pestilence.
4. A party at which people wear masks and other disguises is a
 - a. masquerade.
 - b. confirmation.
 - c. promenade.
 - d. debutante.
5. Members of a ruler's court are known as
 - a. corsages.
 - b. exchequers.
 - c. courtiers.
 - d. harlequins.

Examine the following questions and answer each in detail and complete sentences. Responses are to be no longer than a single paragraph.

6. Consider the events that occur in Poe's "The Masque of the Red Death". Explain the irony of the prince's name. (2 marks)
7. Write a statement of theme for "The Masque of the Red Death". Give a reason for your answer. (3 marks)
8. What effect does the clock have on people? Why? (2 marks)
9. Consider the tales that we have read by Edgar A. Poe – "The Telltale Heart", "The Cask of Amontillado", and now "The Masque of the Red Death". Generally speaking, does justice prevail in Poe's stories? Support your response using examples from each of the three tales that we have read thus far. (3 marks)

QUIZ: Edgar A. Poe's "The Masque of the Red Death"
DO NOT ANSWER ON THIS SHEET. OUT OF A POSSIBLE FIFTEEN MARKS.

Choose the best answer to each of the following questions.

1. A covering with cloth for the dead is called a(n)
 - a. tunic
 - b. abbey
 - c. shroud
 - d. yarmulke
2. A building, like one belonging to a church, is a(n)
 - a. abbey
 - b. galley
 - c. shroud
 - d. hallmark
3. A word meaning "deadly disease" is
 - a. calypso
 - b. plethora
 - c. adoration
 - d. pestilence
4. A party at which people wear masks and other disguises is a
 - a. debutante
 - b. promenade
 - c. masquerade
 - d. confirmation
5. Members of a ruler's court are known as
 - a. corsages
 - b. courtiers
 - c. harlequins
 - d. exchequers

Examine the following questions and answer each in detail. Responses are to be no longer than a single paragraph, and should be proofread for clarity.

6. What effect does the clock have on Prospero's people? Why? (2 MARKS)
7. Explain the irony of the prince's name. (2 MARKS)
8. Write a statement of theme for this story. Explain your answer. (3 MARKS)
9. Consider three of the tales you have read thus far by Edgar A. Poe—"The Telltale Heart," "The Black Cat" and "The Masque of the Red Death." Generally speaking, does justice prevail in Poe's stories? Support your response using examples from each of the three stories mentioned. (3 MARKS)

I DESERVE TO LIVE!

A Proposal to Prince Prospero

Language Arts 9.

The Situation: It is 1351 and you live in Verona, Italy. The Plague is running rampant, and everywhere you look people are dropping like flies. The Prince has given up his partying ways, and being the responsible and altruistic leader he is, has decreed that he will save twenty citizens by enclosing them within his impenetrable fortress. He realizes that once the Red Death has held dominion, he will need to start again with the best Verona has to offer.

The Assignment: You are to write a proposal to Prince Prospero asking to be one of the chosen few. You must articulate why it is important to the future of Verona that you live.

- *What qualities do you possess which are fundamental to the rebuilding of the society?*
- *What can you offer that no one else can?*

You must be prepared to **orally** present your argument to the Prince's right hand (wo)man (that's me!) concisely in **two minutes**.

The Evaluation: You will be marked on your oral presentation, not the written proposal. Of course your diction, syntax, and organization will determine how persuasive, and ultimately successful, you will be.

Prince Prospero Rubric: _____

Teacher: _____

Student Name and Class: _____

CATEGORY	4 Excellent	3 Proficient	2 Satisfactory	1 Limited
Vocal Expression (Inflection, fluency, volume) x1	An engaging vocal performance.	A confident vocal performance.	An inconsistent vocal performance.	An ineffective vocal performance.
Preparedness X1	Student is completely prepared and has obviously rehearsed. Between 1:45 to 2:00 minutes in length.	Student is significantly prepared and adequate rehearsal is evident. Between 1:30 and 1:44 minutes	The student is adequately prepared with some rehearsal evident. Between 1 and 1:29 minutes in length.	Student is minimally prepared with no evidence of rehearsal. Less than one minute or more than 2 minutes.
Persuasiveness X2	Convincingly answered all questions of the assignment. Very persuasive.	Thoroughly answered all questions of the assignment. Reasonably persuasive.	Adequately answered most questions of the assignment. Partially persuasive.	Superficially answered some of the questions in the assignment. Not persuasive.

NAME _____

/ 20 MARKS

ASSIGNMENT: "The Masque of the Red Death" by Edgar Allan Poe

Create a biographic poem of Prince Prospero. Follow the guidelines listed below...

TITLE	<u>Name of character</u>	1 mark
LINE 1	If available, both first and last name,	1 mark
LINE 2	Three traits that describe the character (incl. supporting quotations),	6 marks
LINE 3	Lover of <three items, objects, ideas, or people>,	2 marks
LINE 4	Who believes <one concept or idea>,	1 mark
LINE 5	Who feels <three things>,	2 marks
LINE 6	Who wants <three things>,	2 marks
LINE 7	Who gives <three things>,	2 marks
LINE 8	Who said <a direct quotation from the story>,	1 mark
LINE 9	If available, both first and last name and a description.	2 marks
MISC	Spelling, punctuation, grammar	5 marks

All of the information necessary to complete this assignment can be found within Poe's short story "The Masque of the Red Death". Read it carefully and re-read it if needed.

EVALUATION: You will be awarded grades based upon the criteria listed above. Each line must be completed to an acceptable standard. Be certain that everything you state about Prince Prospero can be adequately supported with evidence from the story – bold assumptions and statements are without merit without textual support from the story.

WHAT QUALITIES DOES EFFECTIVE LEADERSHIP POSSESS?

This is an open book “test.”

Feel free to refer to *any* of the stories you’ve studied thus far in English Language Arts 9.

You are likely to find the greatest value in the following texts, however...

- “*The Flying Machine*” by Ray Bradbury
- “*Leiningen versus the Ants*” by Carl Stephenson
- “*The Masque of the Red Death*” by Edgar A. Poe

Your response may take the form of a short story, wherein you demonstrate the qualities of effective leadership through the actions of a character, or a multi-paragraph expository essay, wherein you detail and explain the qualities an effective leader possesses.

YOU HAVE TWO (2) CLASSES TO COMPLETE THIS WRITING ASSIGNMENT.

Grade 9 English Language Arts – Narrative / Essay Writing Assignment – 2007 Scoring Guide

FOCUS	CONTENT	ORGANIZATION	SENTENCE STRUCTURE	VOCABULARY	CONVENTIONS
	When marking CONTENT appropriate for the Grade 9 Narrative / Essay Writing Assignment, the marker should consider how effectively the student: - explores the topic - establishes a purpose - processes ideas - supports the response - considers the reader	When marking ORGANIZATION appropriate for the Grade 9 Narrative / Essay Writing Assignment, the marker should consider how effectively the student: - focus - coherent order - connections between events and/or details - closure	When marking SENTENCE STRUCTURE appropriate for the Grade 9 Narrative / Essay Writing Assignment, the marker should consider the extent to which: - sentence structure is controlled - sentence type and sentence length are effective and varied - sentence beginnings are varied	When marking VOCABULARY appropriate for the Grade 9 Narrative / Essay Writing Assignment, the marker should consider the: - accuracy of the words and expressions - effectiveness of the words and expressions - appropriateness and effectiveness of the voice/tone created by the student	When marking CONVENTIONS appropriate for the Grade 9 Narrative / Essay Writing Assignment, the marker should consider the extent to which the student has control of: - mechanics (spelling, punctuation, capitalization) - formatting for new speakers, sets, and stage (subject, object, agreement, pronoun, antecedent, agreement, etc.) - clarity and flow of the response
Meets the Standard of Excellence 5	- The student's exploration of the topic is insightful and/or imaginative. - The student's purpose, whether stated or implied, is deliberate. - The ideas presented by the student are carefully chosen and/or perceptive. - Supporting details are precise and original. - The writing is confident and/or creative and holds the reader's interest.	- The introduction is purposeful and interesting, and effectively establishes a focus that is consistently sustained. - Events and/or details are developed in paragraphs in an effective order, and coherence is maintained. - Transitions, either explicit or implicit, fluently connect events and/or details within sentences and between paragraphs. - Closure is effective and purposeful.	- Sentence structure is effectively and consistently controlled. - Sentence type and sentence length are consistently effective and varied. - Sentence beginnings are consistently varied.	- Words and expressions are used accurately and deliberately. - Precise words and expressions are used to create vivid images and/or to enrich details. - The voice/tone created by the student is convincing.	- The quality of the writing is enhanced because it is essentially error-free. - Any errors that are present do not reduce clarity and do not interrupt the flow of the response.
Approaches the Standard of Excellence 4	- The student's exploration of the topic is adept and/or plausible. - The student's purpose, whether stated or implied, is intentional. - The ideas presented by the student are thoughtful and/or sound. - Supporting details are relevant and specific. - The writing is considered and/or elaborated and draws the reader's interest.	- The introduction is purposeful and clearly establishes a focus that is capably sustained. - Events and/or details are developed in paragraphs in a purposeful order, and coherence is generally maintained. - Transitions, either explicit or implicit, clearly connect events and/or details within sentences and between paragraphs. - Closure is appropriate and related to the focus.	- Sentence structure is consistently controlled. - Sentence type and sentence length are usually effective and varied. - Sentence beginnings are often varied.	- Words and expressions are often used accurately. - Specific words and expressions show some evidence of careful selection and some awareness of connotative effect. - The voice/tone created by the student is distinct.	- The quality of the writing is sustained because it contains only minor convention errors. - Any errors that are present rarely reduce clarity and seldom interrupt the flow of the response.
Clearly Meets the Acceptable Standard 3	- The student's exploration of the topic is clear and/or logical. - The student's purpose, whether stated or implied, is evident. - The ideas presented by the student are appropriate and/or predictable. - Supporting details are relevant but general. - The writing is straightforward and/or generalized and occasionally arouses the reader's interest.	- The introduction is functional and establishes a focus that is generally sustained. - Events and/or details are developed in a discernible order, although coherence may falter occasionally. - Transitions, either explicit or implicit, tend to be mechanical and are generally used to connect events and/or details within sentences and between paragraphs. - Closure is related to the focus and is mechanical and/or artificial.	- Sentence structure is generally controlled, but it may occasionally impede meaning. - Sentence type and sentence length are sometimes effective and/or varied. - Some variety of sentence beginnings is evident.	- Words and expressions are generally used appropriately. - General words and expressions are used adequately to clarify meaning. - The voice/tone created by the student is discernible but may be inconsistent or uneven.	- The quality of the writing is sustained through generally correct use of conventions. - Errors that are present occasionally reduce clarity and sometimes interrupt the flow of the response.
Does Not Clearly Meet the Acceptable Standard 2	- The student's exploration of the topic is tenuous and/or simplistic. - The student's purpose, whether stated or implied, is vague. - The ideas presented by the student are superficial and/or ambiguous. - Supporting details are imprecise and/or vague. - The writing is uncertain and/or incomplete and does not appeal to the reader's interest.	- The introduction lacks purpose and/or is not functional; any focus established is not sustained. - The development of events and/or details is not clearly discernible, and coherence falters frequently. - Transitions, either explicit or implicit, are lacking and/or used inconsistently to connect events and/or details within sentences and between paragraphs. - Closure is abrupt and/or unrelated to the focus.	- Sentence structure often lacks control, and this may impede meaning. - Sentence type and sentence length are rarely effective or varied; run-on sentences and/or sentence fragments, if present, often impede meaning. - There is little variety of sentence beginnings.	- Words and expressions generally convey only vague meanings. - Imprecise words and expressions predominate; specific words, if present, may be awkwardly used. - The voice/tone created by the student is not clearly established or is indistinct.	- The quality of the writing is weakened by the frequently incorrect use of conventions. - Errors blur clarity and interrupt the flow of the response.
Clearly Below the Acceptable Standard 1	- The student's exploration of the topic is minimal and/or tangential. - The student's purpose, whether stated or implied, is incomprehensible. - The ideas presented by the student are overgeneralized and/or underdeveloped. - Supporting details are irrelevant and/or lacking. - The writing is confusing and/or undeveloped and does not interest the reader.	- The introduction, if present, is obscure or ineffective; no focus is established. - The development of events and/or details is haphazard and incoherent. - Transitions, either explicit or implicit, are absent and/or inappropriately used to connect events and/or details within sentences and between paragraphs. - Closure is ineffectual or missing.	- Sentence structure generally lacks control, and this often impedes meaning. - There is no variation of sentence type or sentence length; run-on sentences and/or sentence fragments, if present, severely impede meaning. - There is no variety of sentence beginnings.	- Words and expressions convey only vague meanings. - Overgeneralized words and expressions predominate; specific words, if present, are frequently misused. - The voice/tone created by the student is not evident or is inappropriate.	- The quality of the writing is impaired by the consistently incorrect use of conventions. - Errors severely reduce clarity and impede the flow of the response.
Insufficient INS	The marker can discern no evidence of an attempt to address the task presented in the assignment, or the student has written so little that it is not possible to assess Content.	The writing has been awarded an INS for Content.	The writing has been awarded an INS for Content.	The writing has been awarded an INS for Content.	The writing has been awarded an INS for Content.

Note: Content and Organization are weighted to be worth twice as much as the other categories.

September 1, 2007

Students who are awarded an INS for Content are not eligible for a score of 5, 4, 3, 2, or 1.

EVOLUTION

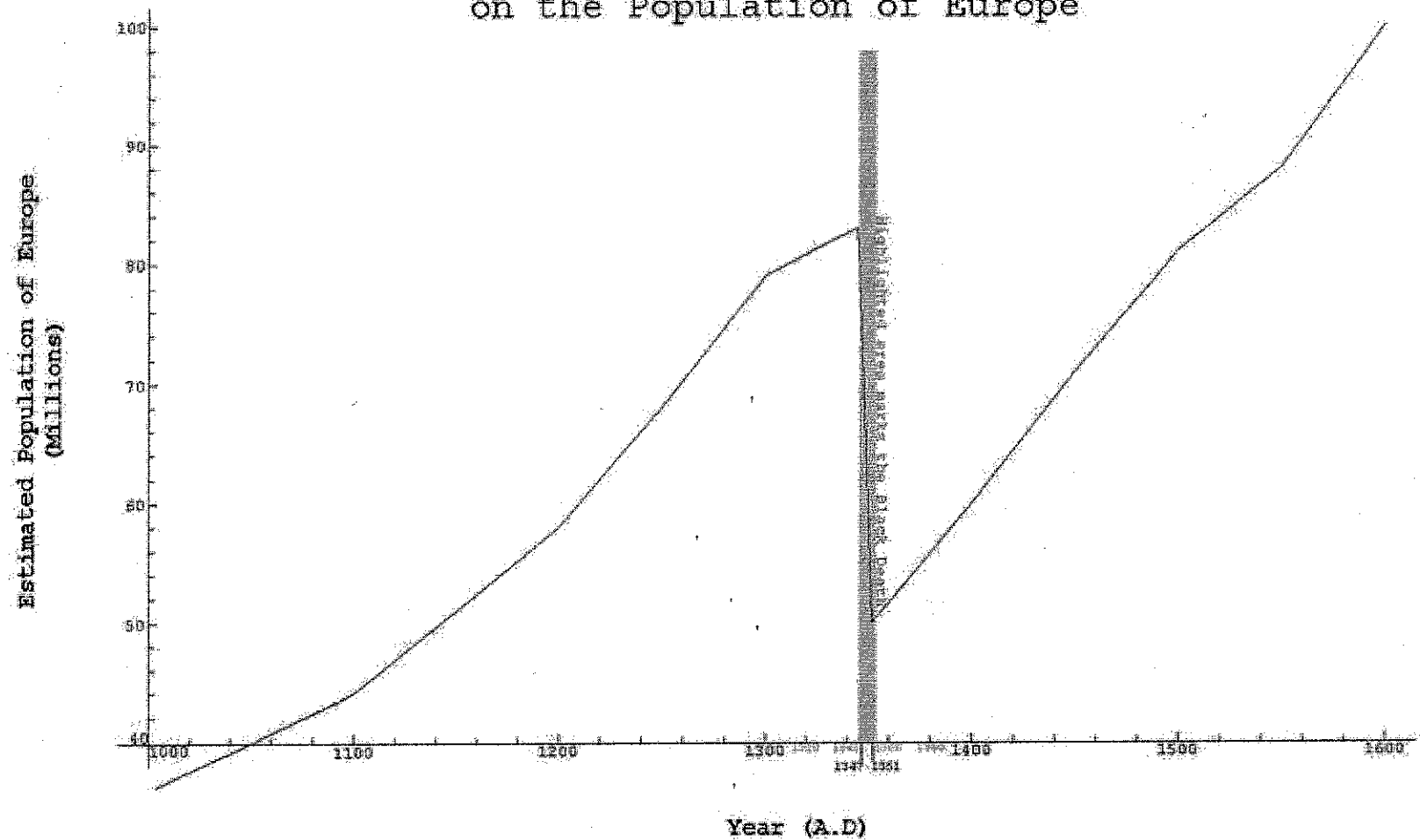
In October 1347, a fleet of Genoese trading ships reached the port of Messina. By the time the fleet reached Messina, all the crew members were dead or dying; it is also presumed that the ships carried infected rats. From there, the disease spread northwest across Europe, striking France, Spain, and Great Britain by June 1348, then turned and spread east through Germany and Scandinavia from 1348 to 1350, and finally to northwestern Russia in 1351. Some parts of Europe were largely spared by the plague, including the Kingdom of Poland and parts of Belgium and the Netherlands.

Whether or not this theory is accurate, what is clear is that there were several preexisting conditions that contributed to the severity of the Black Death. Disastrous weather reached a peak in the first half of the fourteenth century with devastating results. In the years 1315 to 1322 a catastrophic famine struck all of Northern Europe. Food shortages and skyrocketing prices were a fact of life for as much as a century before the plague. Wheat, oat, hay and livestock were all in short supply and their scarcity resulted in hunger and malnutrition. The consequence was a mounting vulnerability to disease due to weakened immunity. The economy entered a vicious cycle in which hunger and small scale disease reduced the productivity of laborers, and so the grain output suffered, causing the grain prices to increase. The famine was self-perpetuating, and allowed the plague to be especially devastating.

FORMS OF THE PLAGUE

The plague consisted of three forms: bubonic, pneumonic, and septicemic. The septicemic and bubonic plague were transmitted with direct contact with fleas, while the pneumonic plague was transmitted through airborne droplets of saliva coughed up by bubonic or septicemic infected humans. The bacteria multiplied inside a flea, blocking its stomachs and causing it to become very hungry. The flea would then start voraciously biting a host and continue to feed because it was unable to satisfy its hunger. During the feeding process infected blood carrying the plague bacteria flows into the wound. The plague bacteria then has a new host and the fleas eventually die from starvation. The pneumonic plague has a different form of transmission. It is transmitted through infected droplets sprayed from the lungs and mouths of infected people. The bacteria then enters the lungs through the windpipe and starts attacking the lungs and throat.

The Effect of the Black Death on the Population of Europe



I. THE MASQUE

- Is a form of dramatic poetry, closely akin to the pageants of modern times.
- Main interest is in the splendid setting and elaborate costumes.

~~Given this, what can we expect of Poe's "The Masque of the Red Death"? Consider the title, for instance.~~

- ~~• The masque has disguise or hidden identity as its chief feature and the characters are allegorical. The supernatural also plays an important part.~~

 The masques were private, social entertainments.

II. THE BLACK DEATH – BUBONIC PLAGUE

- One of the worst epidemic diseases.
- 1300s – Black Death killed $\frac{1}{4}$ of Europe's population (esp. 1347).
- Spots of blood turn black under the skin.
- Transmitted to humans by fleas from infected rats.
- Epidemic in a seaport is especially dangerous because rats may spread the plague to other countries.
- Attack begins suddenly – chills, fever, headache, pain.

- Swelling lymph glands, called buboes, from which the plague is named – neck, groin, armpits → open sores.
- Plague victim must be kept strictly isolated.
 - ◆ 430 BC – Athens
 - ◆ 262 BC – Rome (killed 5,000 per day)
 - ◆ 1349 – England (killed 33% of the population)
 - ◆ 1347-1351 – approx. 75,000,000 died.
 - ◆ 1894-1914 – more than 10,000,000 died in India.
 - ◆ 1899 – New York City, New Orleans, San Francisco, and Seattle → seaports, infected by Hong Kong.
- Quarantine, antibiotics, sanitation measures and rat control are enough to stamp out the disease.

EVOLUTION

In October 1347, a fleet of Genoese trading ships reached the port of Messina. By the time the fleet reached Messina, all the crew members were dead or dying; it is also presumed that the ships carried infected rats. From there, the disease spread northwest across Europe, striking France, Spain, and Great Britain by June 1348, then turned and spread east through Germany and Scandinavia from 1348 to 1350, and finally to northwestern Russia in 1351. Some parts of Europe were largely spared by the plague, including the Kingdom of Poland and parts of Belgium and the Netherlands.

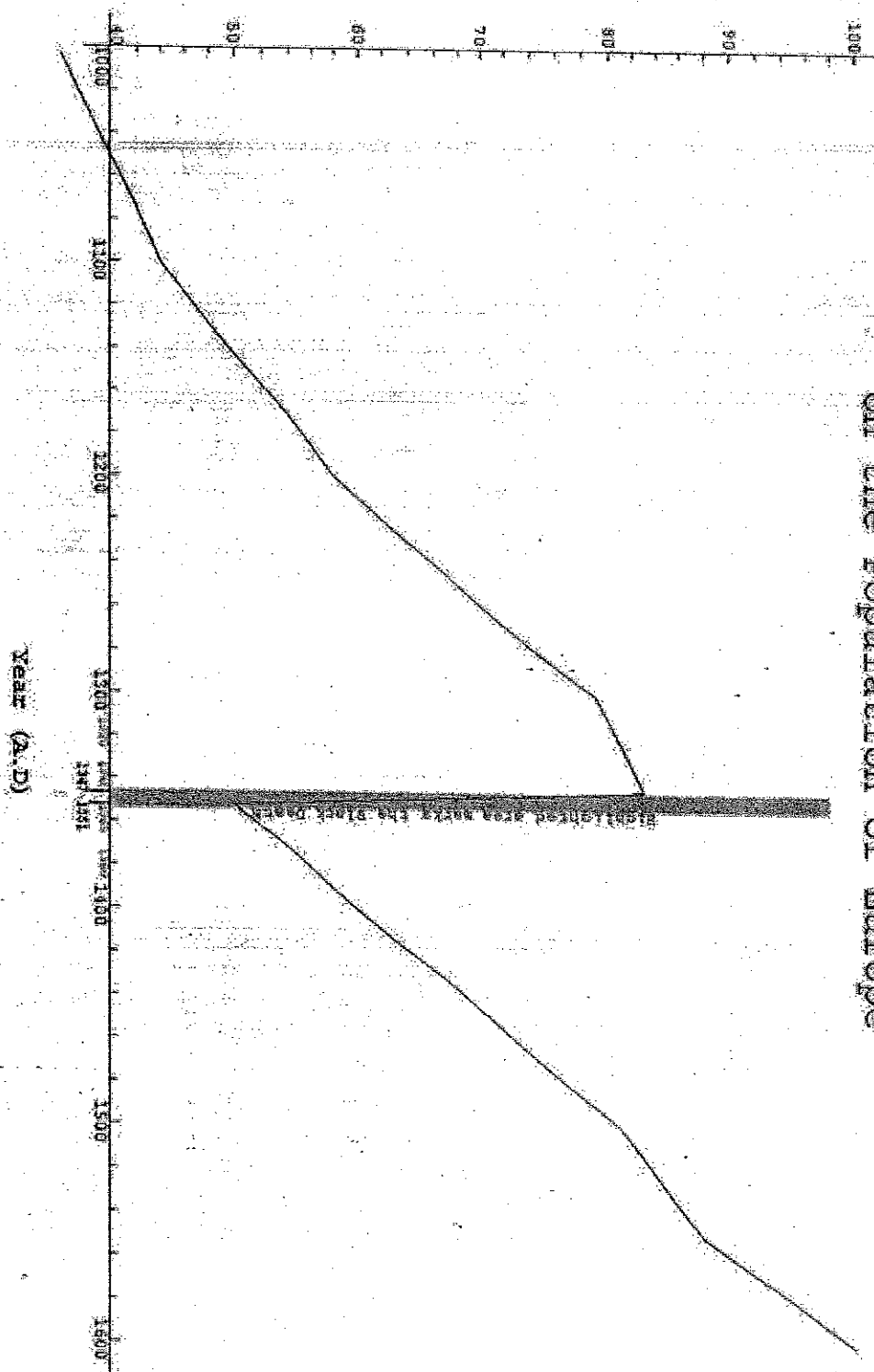
Whether or not this theory is accurate, what is clear is that there were several preexisting conditions that contributed to the severity of the Black Death. Disastrous weather reached a peak in the first half of the fourteenth century with devastating results. In the years 1315 to 1322 a catastrophic famine struck all of Northern Europe. Food shortages and skyrocketing prices were a fact of life for as much as a century before the plague. Wheat, oat, hay and livestock were all in short supply and their scarcity resulted in hunger and malnutrition. The consequence was a mounting vulnerability to disease due to weakened immunity. The economy entered a vicious cycle in which hunger and small scale disease reduced the productivity of laborers, and so the grain output suffered, causing the grain prices to increase. The famine was self-perpetuating, and allowed the plague to be especially devastating.

FORMS OF THE PLAGUE

The plague consisted of three forms: bubonic, pneumonic, and septicemic. The septicemic and bubonic plague were transmitted with direct contact with fleas, while the pneumonic plague was transmitted through airborne droplets of saliva coughed up by bubonic or septicemic infected humans. The bacteria multiplied inside a flea, blocking its stomachs and causing it to become very hungry. The flea would then start voraciously biting a host and continue to feed because it was unable to satisfy its hunger. During the feeding process infected blood carrying the plague bacteria flows into the wound. The plague bacteria then has a new host and the fleas eventually die from starvation. The pneumonic plague has a different form of transmission. It is transmitted through infected droplets sprayed from the lungs and mouths of infected people. The bacteria then enters the lungs through the windpipe and starts attacking the lungs and throat.

Estimated Population of Europe (Millions)

The Effect of the Black Death
on the Population of Europe



HEROD

family name of many rulers associated with the persecution and deaths of many New Testament characters. Because the family tree is so confusing, many people wrongly believe that one raging tyrant was responsible for all the evil deeds. This idea was reinforced by medieval religious dramas.

Herod ordered the massacre of the "holy innocents", the children of Bethlehem from birth to two years old who were slaughtered in an attempt to get rid of the infant, Jesus, whom Herod regarded as a rival to his throne.

Peterborough's Petroglyphs

The hollow echo of water gurgling beneath the rocks at their feet made the two young geologists uneasy. There, in the stillness of the forest north of Stony Lake, they felt as if they had entered a hallowed place. As they swept the moss away in their search for white crystalline limestone, something caught their eye, something odd. The surface of the rock was not smooth, as it should have been. Rather it contained strange etchings, thousands of them. Although they did not know it on that day in May 1954, the two men had uncovered one of North America's largest and most mysterious Indian petroglyphs, the Teaching Rocks.

Like the Bible of Jewish and Christian cultures, the Teaching Rocks recount the aboriginal story of life. As each young male entered adolescence, the elders of the tribe would lead him to this site, guided by the sound of the waterfalls and special guide rocks. One lesson at a time, the elders taught the youngsters

the meaning of life, as the Ojibway understood it and as the Teaching Rocks revealed it. The medicine wheel told them that life began as the sunrise in the east. Midday represented mid-life. The west meant old age, while the north referred to the afterlife. The spirits portrayed in the carvings taught that man must co-exist with nature.

After each lesson finished, the elders would cover the stones with moss to preserve the carvings from erosion. Today they are

protected by a shelter in Petroglyph Provincial Park, 40 kilometers northeast of Peterborough near Highway 28. Here you may wonder at the strange shapes and possibly apply your own interpretations. . . . As you walk back through the woods, you may look around you and see nature through different eyes and wonder why North America's European "conquerors" have run roughshod over the nature that the natives coexisted with so easily.



The Black Cat

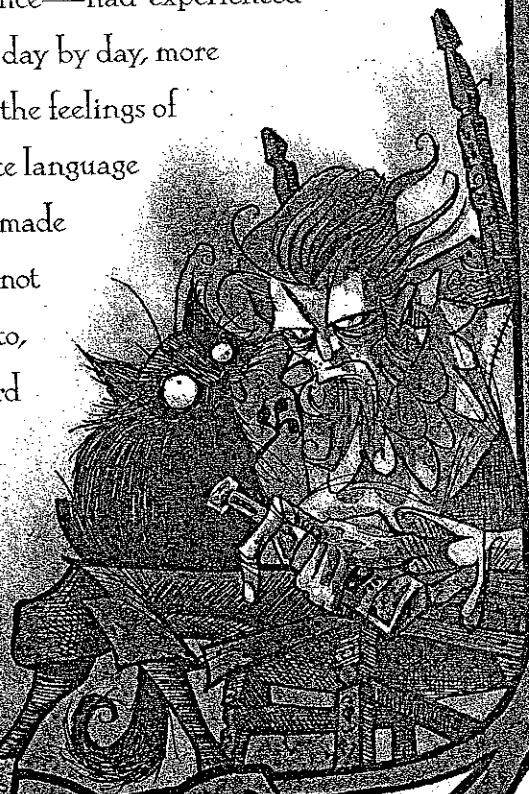


For the most wild yet most homely narrative I am about to pen, I neither expect nor solicit belief. Mad indeed would I be to expect it, in a case where my very senses reject their own evidence. Yet, mad am I not—and very surely do I not dream. But tomorrow I die, and today I would unburden my soul.



This latter was a remarkably large and beautiful animal, entirely black, and sagacious to an astonishing degree. Pluto—this was the cat's name—was my favorite pet and playmate. I alone fed him, and he attended me wherever I went about the house.

Our friendship lasted in this manner for several years, during which my general temperament and character—through the instrumentality of the Fiend Intemperance—had experienced a radical alteration for the worse. I grew, day by day, more moody, more irritable, more regardless of the feelings of others. I suffered myself to use intemperate language to my wife. My pets, of course, were made to feel the change in my disposition. I not only neglected, but ill-used them. For Pluto, however, I still retained sufficient regard to restrain me from maltreating him. But my disease grew upon me—for what disease is like Alcohol!—and at length even Pluto began to experience the effects of my ill temper.



750 ml

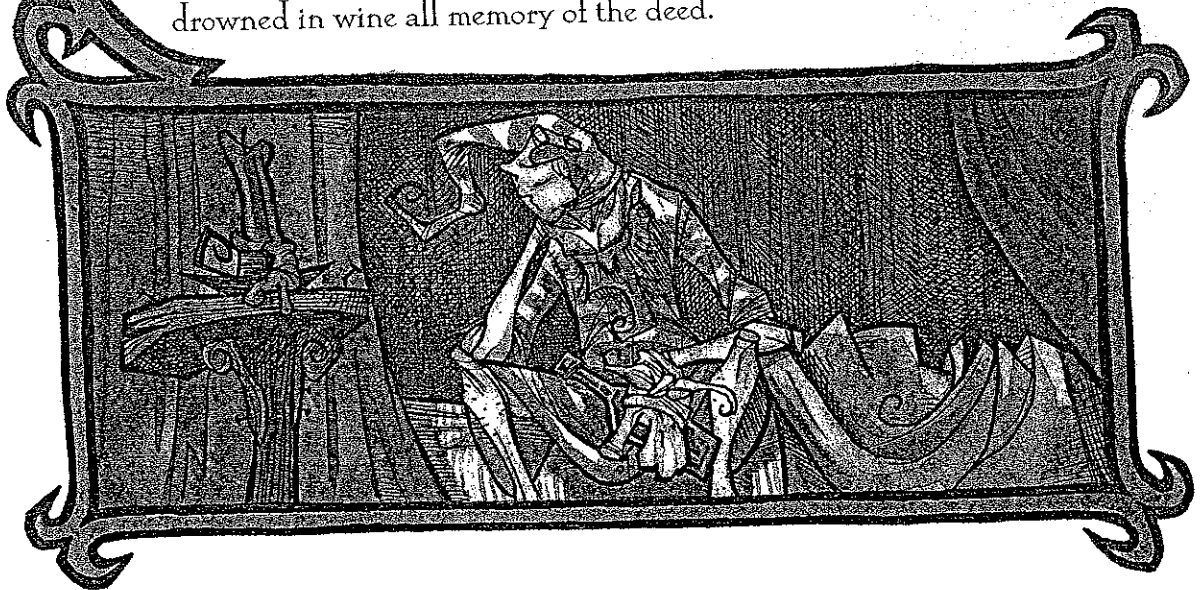


Est. 1832

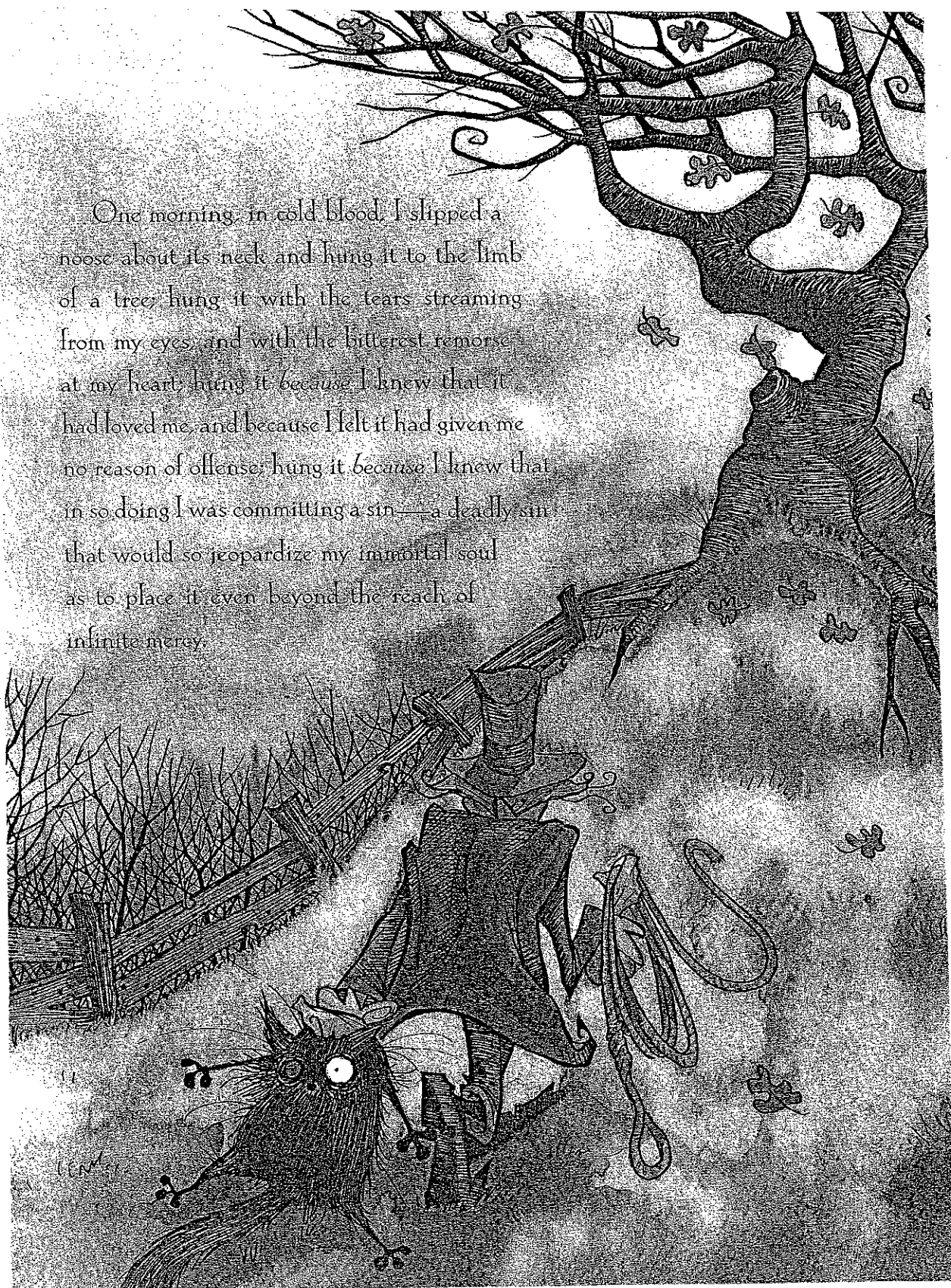


I took from my waistcoat a penknife, grasped the poor beast by the throat, and deliberately cut one of its eyes from the socket!

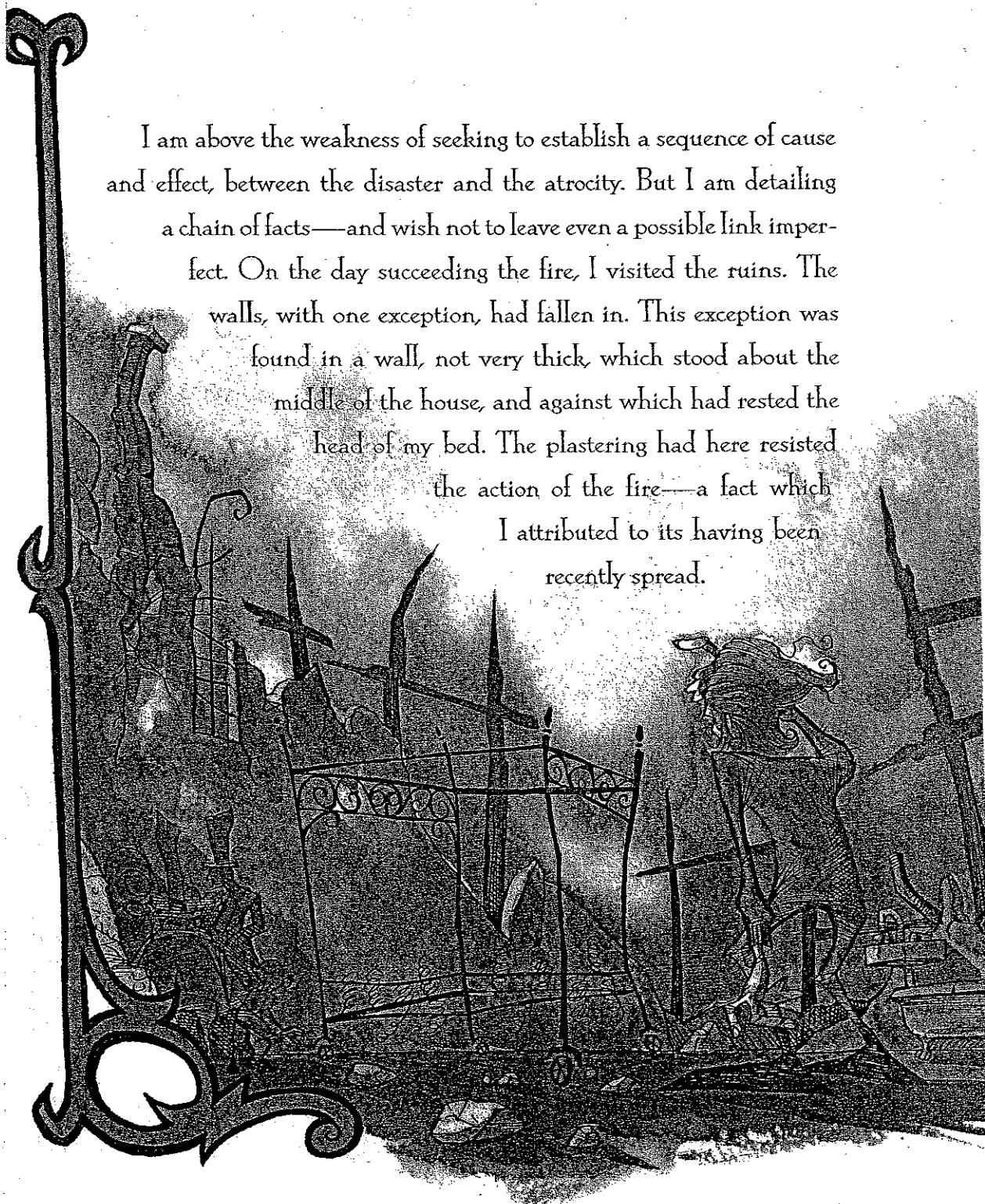
When reason returned with the morning, I experienced a sentiment half of horror, half of remorse, for the crime of which I had been guilty; but it was, at best, a feeble and equivocal feeling, and the soul remained untouched. I soon drowned in wine all memory of the deed.

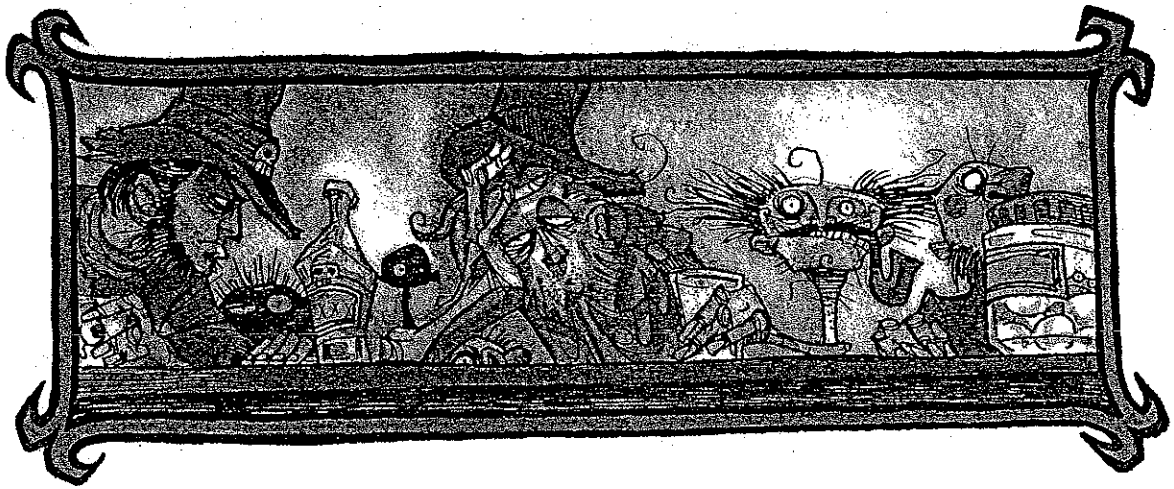


One morning, in cold blood, I slipped a noose about its neck and hung it to the limb of a tree; hung it with the tears streaming from my eyes, and with the bitterest remorse at my heart; hung it *because* I knew that it had loved me, and because I felt it had given me no reason of offense; hung it *because* I knew that in so doing I was committing a sin—a deadly sin that would so jeopardize my immortal soul as to place it even beyond the reach of infinite mercy.



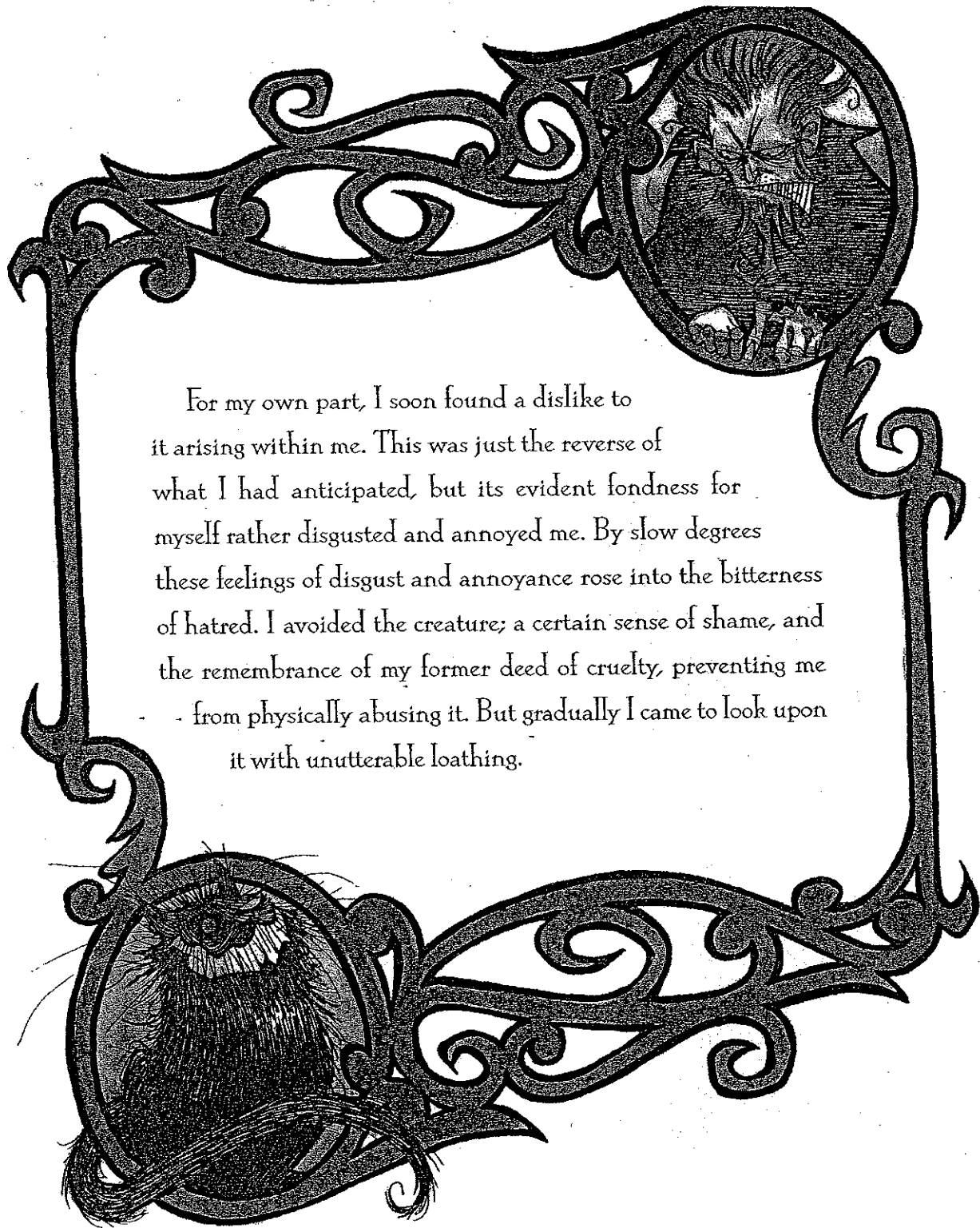
I am above the weakness of seeking to establish a sequence of cause and effect, between the disaster and the atrocity. But I am detailing a chain of facts—and wish not to leave even a possible link imperfect. On the day succeeding the fire, I visited the ruins. The walls, with one exception, had fallen in. This exception was found in a wall, not very thick, which stood about the middle of the house, and against which had rested the head of my bed. The plastering had here resisted the action of the fire—a fact which I attributed to its having been recently spread.





One night as I sat, half stupefied, in a den of more than infamy, my attention was suddenly drawn to some black object, reposing upon the head of one of the immense hogsheads of gin, or rum, which constituted the chief furniture of the apartment. It was a cat—a very large one—fully as large as Pluto, and closely resembling him in every respect but one. Pluto had not a white hair upon any portion of his body; but this cat had a large, although indefinite, splotch of white covering nearly the whole region of the breast.





For my own part, I soon found a dislike to it arising within me. This was just the reverse of what I had anticipated, but its evident fondness for myself rather disgusted and annoyed me. By slow degrees these feelings of disgust and annoyance rose into the bitterness of hatred. I avoided the creature; a certain sense of shame, and the remembrance of my former deed of cruelty, preventing me from physically abusing it. But gradually I came to look upon it with unutterable loathing.

This dread was not exactly a dread of physical evil—and yet I should be at loss how otherwise to define it. I am almost ashamed to own—yes, even in this felon's cell, I am almost ashamed to own—that the terror and the horror with which the animal inspired me, had been heightened by one of the merest chimeras it would be possible to conceive. My wife had called my attention, more than once, to the character of the mark of white hair, of which I have spoken, and which constituted the sole visible difference between the strange beast and the one I had destroyed. The reader will remember that this mark, although large, had been originally very indefinite; but, by slow degrees—which for a long time my reason struggled to reject as fanciful—it had assumed a rigorous distinctness of outline of a hideous—of a ghastly thing—of the GALLOWSI

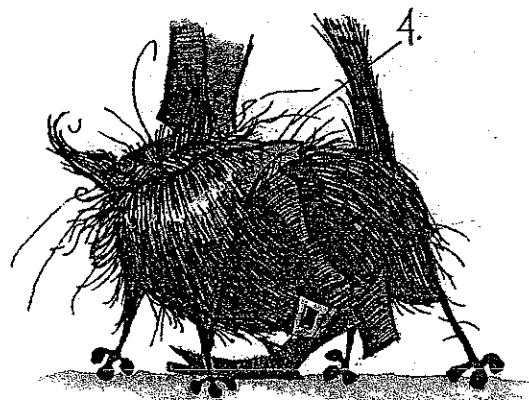


EXHIBIT D

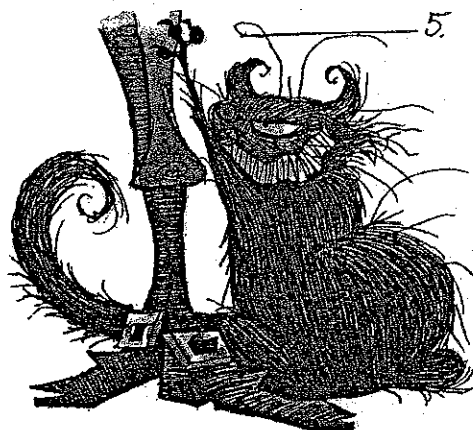
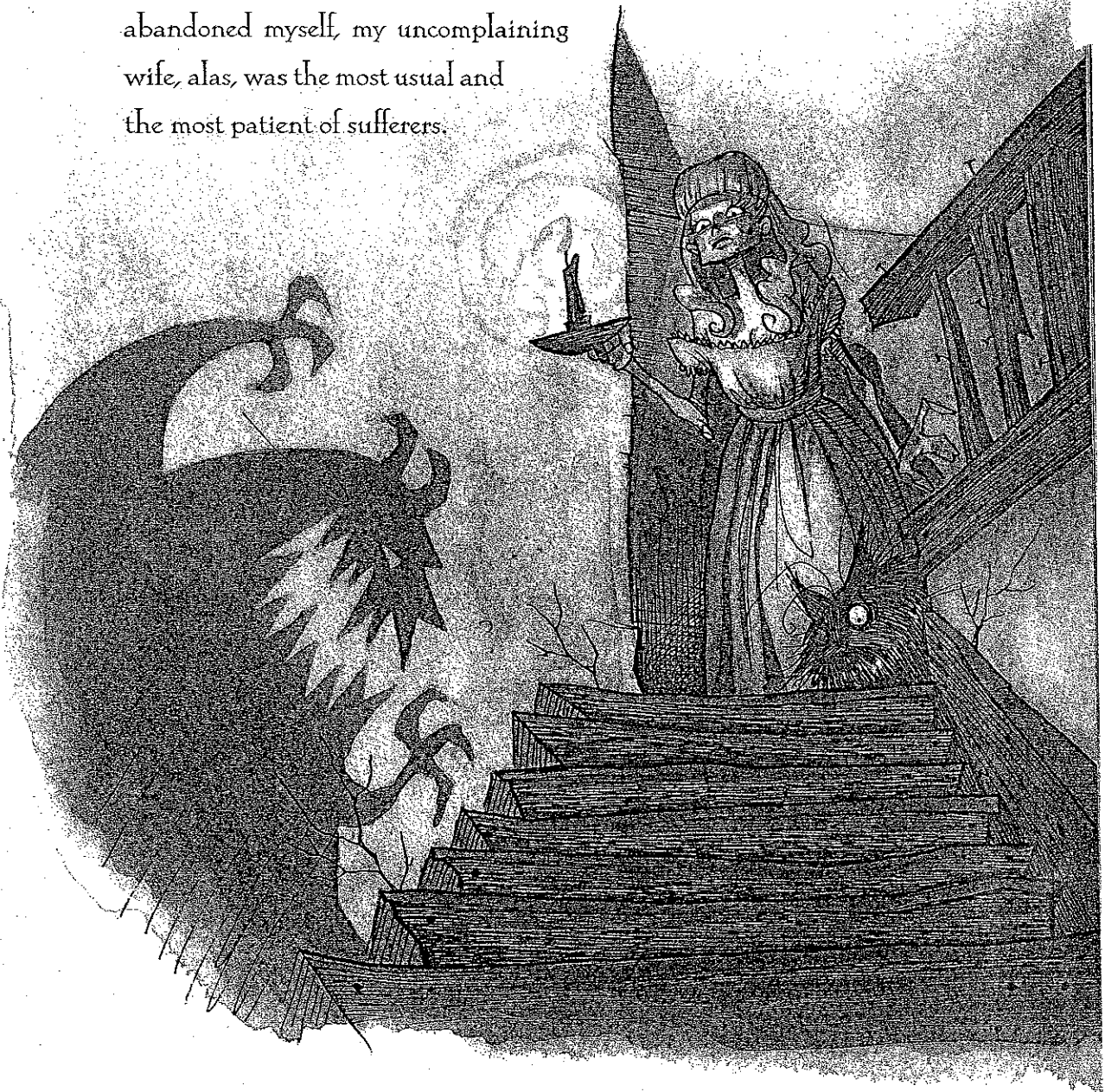


EXHIBIT E



EXHIBIT F

Beneath the pressure of torments such as these, the feeble remnant of the good within me succumbed. Evil thoughts became my sole intimates—the darkest and most evil of thoughts. To sudden, frequent, and ungovernable outbursts of fury to which I now blindly abandoned myself, my uncomplaining wife, alas, was the most usual and the most patient of sufferers.



Uplifting an axe, and forgetting in my wrath the childish dread which had hitherto stayed my hand, I aimed a blow at the animal which, of course, would have proved instantly fatal had it descended as I wished. But this blow was arrested by the hand of my wife.



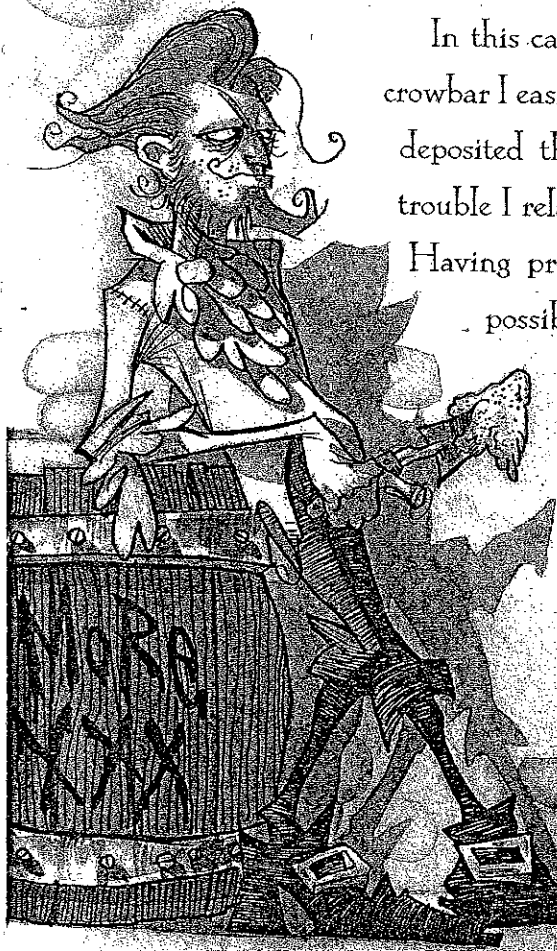
Goaded by the interference into a rage more than demoniacal, I withdrew my arm from her grasp and buried the axe in her brain. She fell dead upon the spot.

Finally I hit upon what I considered a far better expedient than any of those. I determined to wall it up in the cellar, as the monks of the Middle Ages are recorded to have walled up their victims.

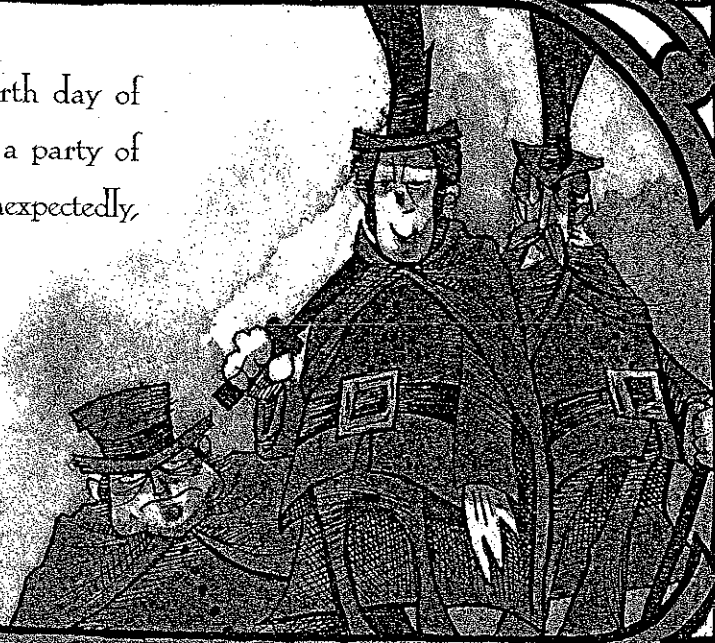
For a purpose such as this the cellar was well adapted. Its walls were loosely constructed and had lately been plastered throughout with a rough plaster, which the dampness of the atmosphere had prevented from hardening. Moreover, in one of the walls was a projection, caused by a false chimney, or fireplace, that had been filled up and made to resemble the rest of the cellar. I made no doubt that I could readily displace the bricks at this point, insert the corpse, and wall the thing up as before, so that no eye could detect anything suspicious.

In this calculation I was not deceived. By means of a crowbar I easily dislodged the bricks, and, having carefully deposited the body against the inner wall, with little trouble I relaid the whole structure as it originally stood.

Having procured mortar, sand, and hair, with every possible precaution, I prepared a plaster, which could not be distinguished from the old, and with this I very carefully went over the new brickwork. When I had finished, I felt satisfied that all was right. The wall did not present the slightest appearance of having been disturbed. The rubbish on the floor was picked up with the minutest care.

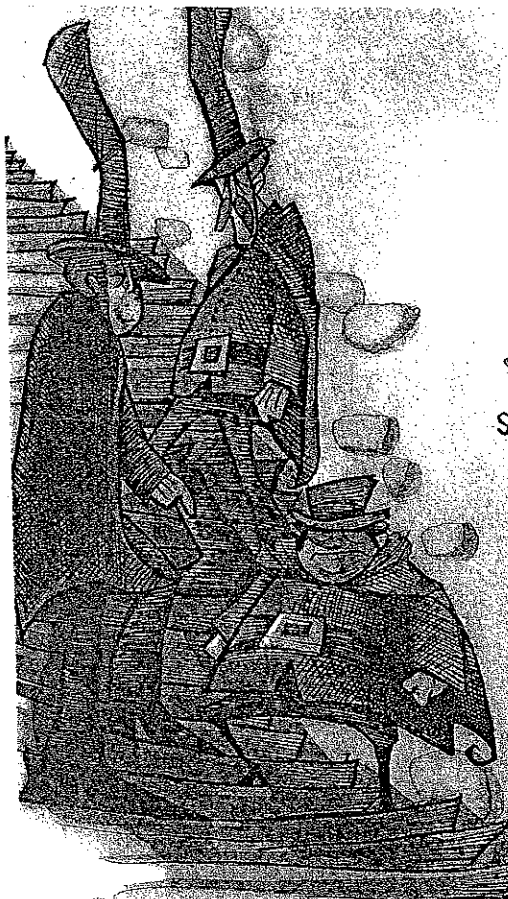


Upon the fourth day of the assassination, a party of police came, very unexpectedly, into the house.



Secure, however, in the inscrutability of my place of concealment, I felt no embarrassment whatever. The officers bade me accompany them in their search. They left no nook or corner unexplored.





"Gentlemen,"

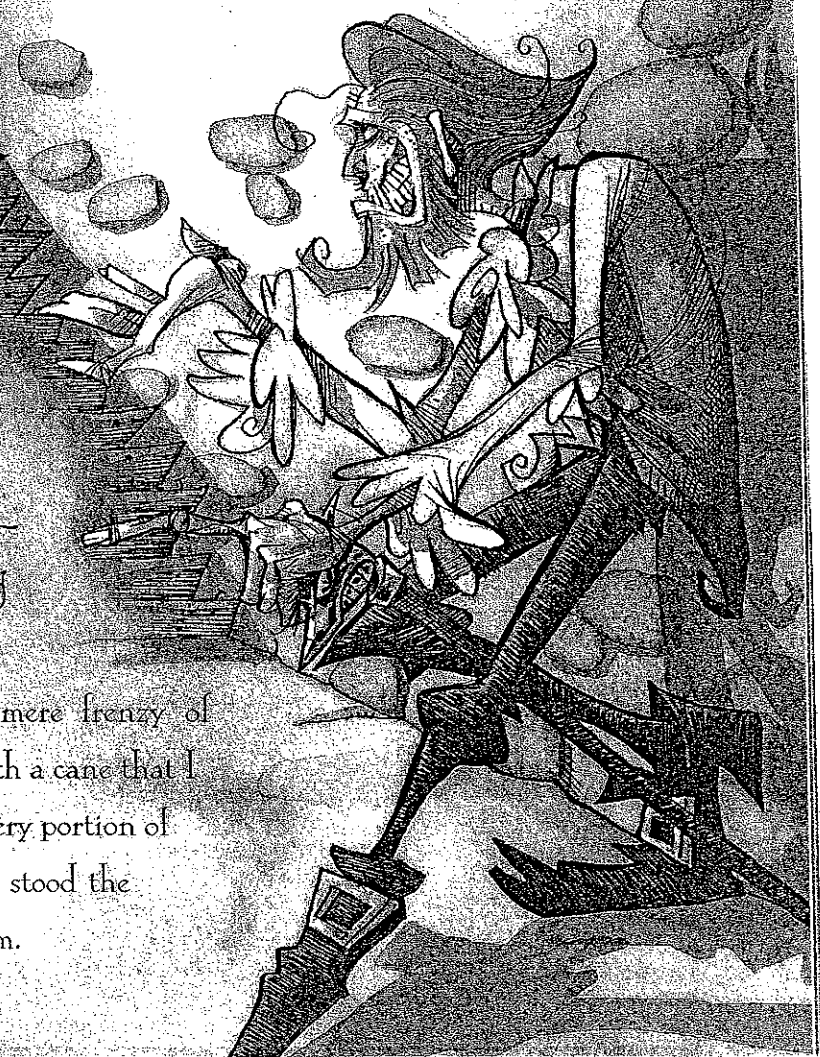
I said at last, as
the party ascended
the steps,

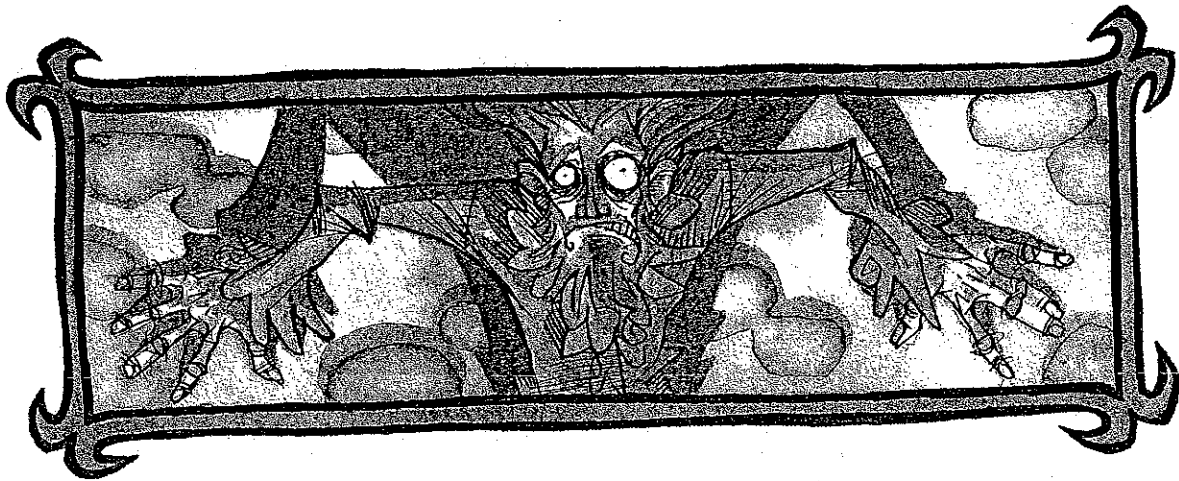
"I delight to have allayed your
suspicions. I wish you all health
and a little more courtesy.
By the bye, gentlemen,
this—this is a very well-
constructed house."

(In the rapid desire to say
something easily, I scarcely
knew what I uttered at all.)

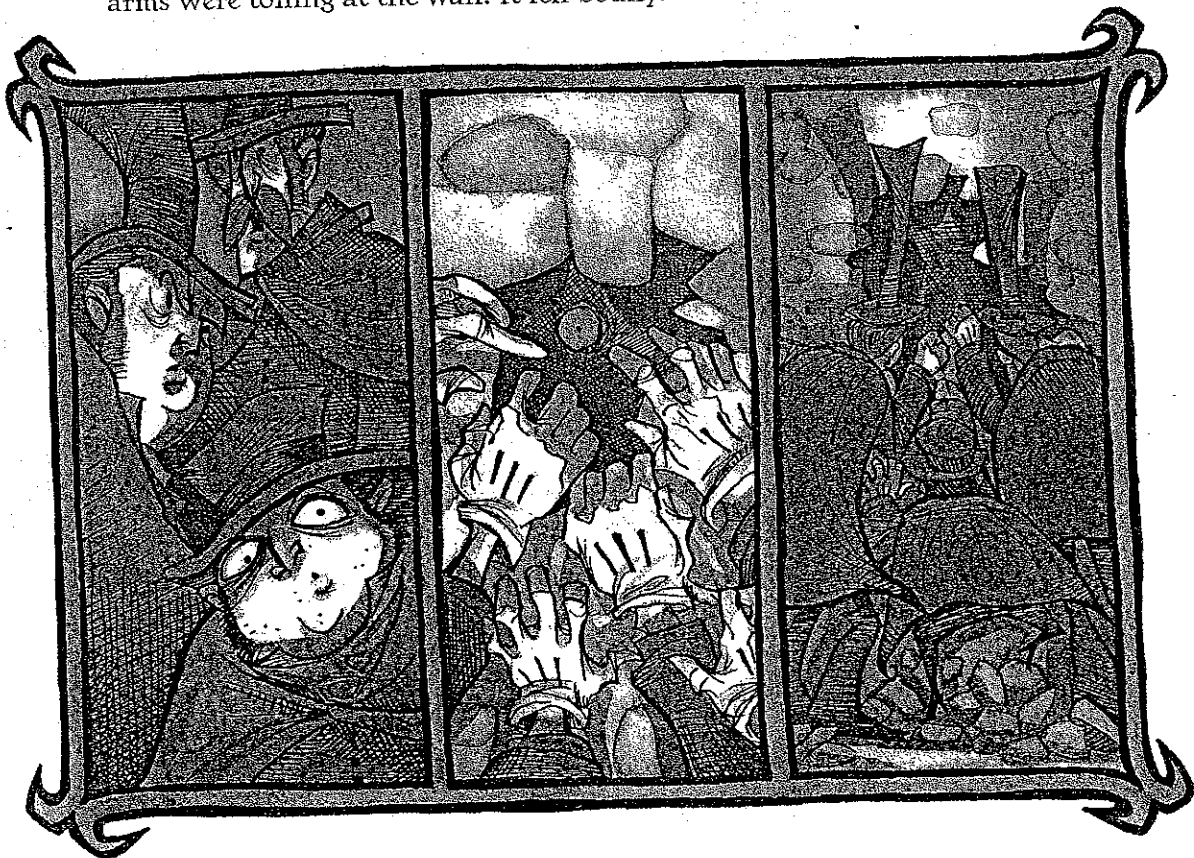
"These walls—are
you going, gentlemen?—
these walls are solidly
put together"

—and here, through the mere frenzy of
bravado, I rapped heavily with a cane that I
held in my hand upon that very portion of
the brickwork behind which stood the
corpse of the wife of my bosom.





Of my own thoughts it is folly to speak. Swooning, I staggered to the opposite wall. For one instant the party on the stairs remained motionless, through extremity of terror and of awe. In the next, half a dozen stout arms were toiling at the wall. It fell bodily.

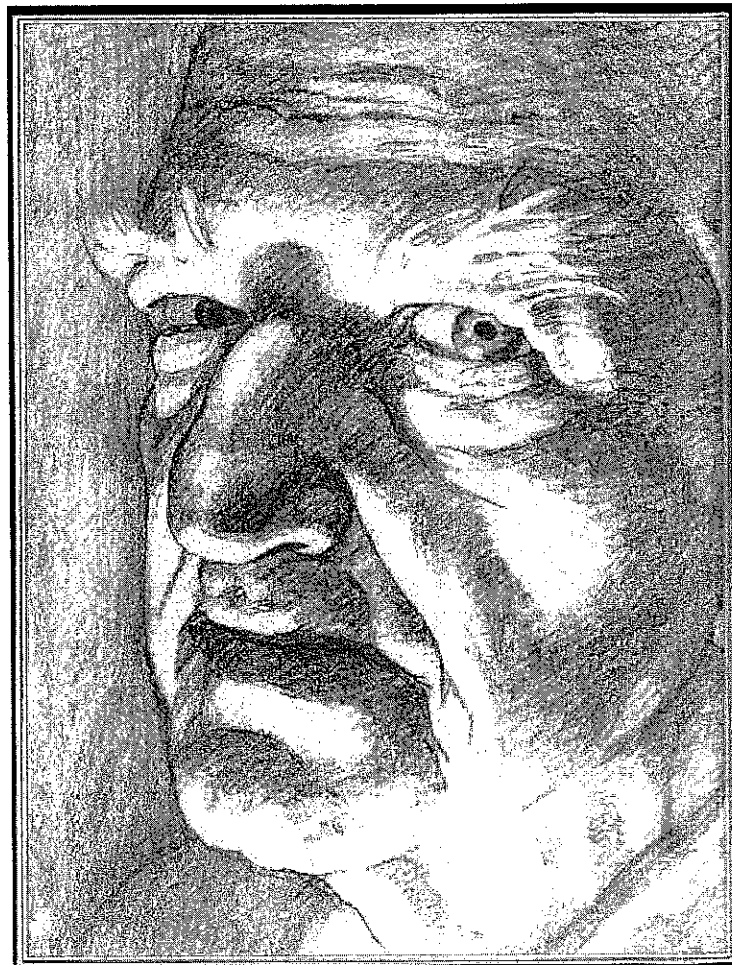


THE TELLTALE HEART VERSUS THE BLACK CAT
A BATTLE ROYALE BROUGHT TO YOU BY THE DIXON / POE PARTNERSHIP
MADE POSSIBLE BY PEOPLE LIKE YOU!

Both “The Telltale Heart” and “The Black Cat” speak of the capacity for violence and madness that lies within each of us, no matter how docile and humane we may seem. Penned by Poe and published in 1843, the two stories are very similar, yet very different.

In two paragraphs, compare and contrast the plot and protagonists of Edgar Allan Poe’s two tales. Take care to make mention of specific events and explain how, though similar to one another, they differ in important ways. Furthermore, detail the similarities between the respective main characters of each, and then offer keen insight on their differences.

Make certain that your paragraphs are well-structured and detailed. Begin each paragraph with a specific topic sentence, offer strong supporting evidence gleaned from the text and conclude with a worthwhile statement. Take care to proofread your work and good luck!



STUDENT NAME: _____

THOUGHT & DETAIL

- Consider whether writing shows evidence of close reading & independent thought and how clearly and precisely the thesis focuses on the assignment

x 2

- Excellent:** Insightful ideas are supported by carefully chosen evidence. Literary interpretations are perceptive. Internalized appreciation of literature is apparent. 5
- Proficient:** Thoughtful ideas are supported by appropriate evidence or conventional ideas are supported by carefully chosen evidence. Literary interpretations are sensible. 4
- Satisfactory:** Relevant ideas are supported by purposefully chosen evidence. Literary interpretations are straightforward and defensible, even though they may be predictable. 3
- Limited:** Superficial ideas are weakly supported. Literary interpretations are incomplete. The selection of literature to be discussed is questionable since it may not supply significant supporting details or the selection of literature is appropriate, but the selection of significant supporting details is not evident. 2
- Poor:** Unsupported generalities and details do not develop the topic. Literary interpretations may not be defensible. The selection of literature to be discussed is inappropriate or the selection of literature to be discussed is appropriate, but little understanding of the literature or of the topic is exhibited. The details from literature obscure the ideas or are irrelevant to the discussion. 1

TUTORIAL SUGGESTIONS (Thought and Detail)

Proofread to ensure that you have:

- Read and re-read the literature to gain an internalized appreciation and understanding which is reflected in the depth of complexity of ideas.
- Included a thorough range of illustration but not as a substitute for your own writing or analysis.
- Used clear, relevant contextual or background information to reinforce rather than obscure your thesis.
- Stayed on topic throughout the essay.
- Carefully selected quotations, details, and scenes to support your thesis.
- Ensured that quotations are short and clearly related to your focus/thesis.
- Avoided plot summary by limiting background information to essentials.
- Avoided inappropriate, personal, opinionated, judgmental comments.

ORGANIZATION:

- Consider how the writer's organizational choices result in a coherent, focused, shaped response to the assignment; establish and maintain a controlling idea; and lead to a developed conclusion to the discussion.

x 2

- Excellent:** An effective arrangement of ideas and/or details contributes to a fluent, controlled, and shaped discussion. The controlling idea is successfully sustained, integrated, and developed coherently. The discussion concludes skillfully/effectively. 5
- Proficient:** A considered arrangement of ideas and/or details contributes to a competent controlled discussion. The controlling idea is generally sustained and developed coherently. The discussion concludes logically. 4
- Satisfactory:** A straightforward arrangement of ideas and/or details provides direction for the discussion. The controlling idea is developed and maintained in a forthright manner; however, coherence may falter. The discussion concludes matter-of-factly. 3
- Limited:** A discernible but ineffectual arrangement of ideas and/or details provides some direction for the discussion. The controlling idea is not maintained and/or ideas are not clearly developed or concluded. 2
- Poor:** A haphazard arrangement of ideas and/or details provides little or no direction for the discussion. A controlling idea is absent. Development and conclusion are obscure and/or incoherent. 1

TUTORIAL SUGGESTIONS (Organization)

Proofread to ensure that you have:

- Referred to both the author and the selection(s) in the introduction and perhaps the conclusion.
- Attempted a clear, original thesis which focuses precisely on the assignment and the literature in your introduction.
- Used precise topic sentences/unifying ideas which provide smooth, logical transitions, making clear the relationship between one idea and the next in the body paragraphs.
- Not introduced new material in the conclusion.
- Reminded your reader of your thesis, possibly with a key word or re-emphasis of a main idea.
- Added a thoughtful concluding statement which expands on the theme – a global or philosophical statement.
- A clear organization which includes an introduction, body paragraphs, and a conclusion.

Smash 'n' grab stumps St. Albert RCMP

Thieves reached through window and stole painting of ocean panorama

TRISH AUDETTE
Journal Staff Writer
EDMONTON

A painting entitled *The Best Things in Life are Free* was stolen from a St. Albert gallery over the weekend in a smash-and-grab robbery unlike anything RCMP officers have seen before.

The painting, an ocean panorama by St. Albert artist Penny Hiebert, is valued at \$3,500.

"St. Albert and Edmonton aren't the big art theft capitals of the world," Cpl. Ted Soltys said Tuesday.

Sometime late Sunday night or early Monday morning, someone broke the front window of the newly opened Studio Gallery on Perron Street, then made off with an oil painting nearly two-

metres wide and almost a metre high.

"We haven't had any art thefts here in St. Albert that I can recall," Soltys said. "From looking at it, it looks like a very nice piece of art."

"Who knows, maybe somebody has it hanging on their wall."

The gallery, run by six artists, opened earlier this month and does not have any security cameras.

So far, Soltys said, there are no suspects or known witnesses to the break-in. The theft was reported to police Monday, after gallery owners saw the broken window at about 7:50 a.m.

Hiebert signs her pieces "Monk."

She said one way the painting could be identified is by a number of children's signatures on the back. While painting in British Columbia this summer, she let

children passing on the beach take brushes to her work, then sign their names on the back.

Nothing else was taken from the gallery, said fellow artist Susanne Lutas.

"It looks as if (the suspects) didn't actually enter the store, they reached for anything they could get through the hole" in the window, she said.

A second work — also painted by Hiebert — was nearly wrenched from where it hung but was left behind.

Lutas said the window appeared to have been broken with a rusty paint can.

This was "a real sense of trespass," she said. "I believe (security) will be lined up. We didn't feel that we'd be targeted."

taudette@thejournal.canwest.com

"The Cask of Amontillado" by Edgar Allan Poe

Class I:

- **Introduction:**

1. Students will assemble into groups of three or four.
2. Each group will be given a colored index card with one of four topics written on it: *Edgar Allan Poe, irony, Italy, and carnivals*.
NOTE: There may need to be more than one card with each topic written on it, but each card should be the same color as other cards with the same topic.
3. Students discuss their knowledge of and experiences with the topic they receive. Groups switch cards after two to three minutes and discuss a new topic.

- **Application of Introduction and Understanding:**

1. Students read the first section of the story.
NOTE: *...my smile NOW was at the thought of his immolation.*
2. Lead students in discussion by using open-ended questions as prompts to draw out key ideas and students' personal reactions, emotions, predictions, etc.
 - a. *How do you feel about the narrator?*
 - b. *Do his feelings seem justified?*
 - c. *What does Fortunato's name seem to imply about his character?*
3. Students read the second section of the story.
NOTE: *He had a weak point...stood stupidly bewildered.*
4. Lead students in discussion.
 - a. *Which character seems more likeable?*
 - b. *What does Fortunato's dress imply about his character?*
 - c. *How does Fortunato seem to feel about the narrator?*
5. Students read the rest of the story.
NOTE: *A moment more and I had fettered him... to the very end.*
6. Lead students in a final discussion.
 - a. *How was this story ironic?*
 - b. *How do you feel about the narrator?*
 - c. *How do you feel about Fortunato?*
 - d. *How would you change the ending?*
 - e. *Did you think that Montresor's actions were justified? Why or why not?*
 - f. *How is setting important in this story?*

- **Conclusion:**

1. Inform students of what is to come next class: a discussion of characterization, an examination of setting, and an exploration of the concept of revenge.

ENGLISH LANGUAGE ARTS 8: POINT OF VIEW

The **point of view** of a story is the way a story gets told and who tells it. Point of view is the method of narration that determines the position, or angle of vision, from which the story unfolds, and governs the reader's access to the story.

Many narratives appear in the **first person** (the narrator speaks as "I" and is a character in the story who may or may not influence events within it). It is worth noting that a first person narrator may be unreliable, making obvious mistakes or misinterpretations in describing events, or displaying bias that may be apparent to a careful reader. Unreliable narration can serve to characterize the narrator as foolish or unobservant or selfish.

Another common type of narrative is the **third person** (the narrator seems to be someone standing outside the story who refers to all the characters by name or as *he*, *she*, *they*, and so on). When the narrator reports speech and action, but never comments on the thoughts of other characters, it is the **objective** (or **dramatic third person**) **point of view**. The third-person narrator can be **omniscient**—a narrator who knows everything that needs to be known about the agents and events in the story, and is free to move at will in time and place, and who has privileged access to a character's thoughts, feelings, and motives. The narrator can also be **limited**—a narrator who is confined to what is experienced, thought, or felt by a single character or, at most, a limited number of characters.

When we read a story, there are three questions we should ask ourselves in order to determine the point of view being used:

1. Who is telling the story—one of the characters, or a third person?
2. If a third person is telling the story, how much does that person know? Can that person see into the minds and feelings of one or more characters, or can that person only report on the actions of the characters?
3. What has the author accomplished by selecting this particular point of view?

There are a number of points of view available for the author to choose from. The four most common types are described in the paragraph above, and are repeated below:

1. First Person
2. Third Person Objective
3. Third Person Omniscient
4. Third Person Limited Omniscient

These things in mind, answer the following true / false questions. If the answer is false, change what is necessary to make the statement true.

1. A third person narrator refers to all the characters in a story as "he" or "she".
2. A third person omniscient narrator is all-knowing and is not an agent in the text.
3. Third person limited focuses on the thoughts and feelings of one character.
4. A first person narrator uses a character speaking as "he" to tell the story.
5. A first-person narrator may slant or distort the presentation of events.

PREDICTION QUESTIONS

FOR *THE TELL-TALE HEART* BY EDGAR ALLAN POE

- Title:** Based on the title, predict what you think this story will be about.
- First paragraph:** Who do you think the narrator is speaking to?
- Third paragraph:** Write down what you think the author means by "the work."
- Third paragraph:** Why does the narrator treat the old man so well in the mornings?
- Fourth paragraph:** Why doesn't the narrator leave when he realizes the old man is awake?
- Fifth paragraph:** Would you like to change your original prediction of what this story is about?
- Sixth and seventh paragraphs:** Whose heart do you think the narrator is hearing?
- Seventh paragraph:** In one sentence, predict the ending of the story.
- Midway through eighth paragraph:** Who is at the door?
- Ninth paragraph:** What is the noise?
- Tenth paragraph:** What is the narrator feeling right now?
- End of story:** Were any of your original predictions about the story correct?

THE
Tell-Tale
HEART

Edgar Allan Poe

True!—Nervous—very, very dreadfully nervous I had been and am; but why *will* you say that I am mad? The disease has sharpened my senses—not destroyed—not dulled them. Above all was the sense of hearing acute. I heard all things in the heaven and in the earth. I heard many things in hell. How, then, am I mad? Hearken! And observe how healthily—how calmly I can tell you the whole story.

It is impossible to say how first the idea entered my brain; but once conceived, it haunted me day and night. Object there was none. Passion there was none. I loved the old man. He had never wronged me. He had never given me insult. For his gold I had no desire. I think it was his eye! Yes, it was this! One of his eyes resembled that of a vulture—a pale blue eye, with a film over it. Whenever it fell upon me, my blood ran cold; and so by degrees—very gradually—I made up my mind to take the

life of the old man, and thus rid myself of the eye forever.

Now this is the point. You fancy me mad. Madmen know nothing. But you should have seen *me*. You should have seen how wisely I proceeded—with what caution—with what foresight—with what dissimulation¹ I went to work! I was never kinder to the old man than during the whole week before I killed him. And every night, about midnight, I turned the latch of his door and opened it—oh, so gently! And then, when I had made an opening sufficient for my head, I put in a dark lantern, all closed, closed, so that no light shone out, and then I thrust in my head. Oh, you would have laughed to see how cunningly I thrust it in! I moved it slowly—very, very slowly, so that I might not disturb the old man's sleep. It took me an hour to place my whole head within the opening so far that I could see him as he lay upon his bed. Ha! Would a madman have been so wise as this? And then, when my head was well in the room, I undid the lantern cautiously—oh, so cautiously—cautiously (for the hinges creaked)—I undid it just so much that a single thin ray fell upon the vulture eye. And this I did for seven long nights—every night just at midnight—but I found the eye always closed; and so it was impossible to do the work; for it was not the old man who vexed me, but his Evil Eye. And every morning, when the day broke, I went boldly into the chamber, and spoke courageously to him, calling him by name in a hearty tone, and inquiring how he had passed the night. So you see he would have been a very profound old man, indeed, to suspect that every night, just at twelve, I looked in upon him while he slept.

Upon the eighth night I was more than usually cautious in opening the door. A watch's minute hand moves

¹ dissimulation (dis sim'yā'ā'shā n): pretense; hiding one's true feelings and plans.

more quickly than did mine. Never before that night had I *felt* the extent of my own powers—of my sagacity.² I could scarcely contain my feelings of triumph. To think that there I was, opening the door, little by little, and he not even to dream of my secret deeds or thoughts. I fairly chuckled at the idea; and perhaps he heard me; for he moved on the bed suddenly, as if startled. Now you may think that I drew back—but no. His room was as black as pitch with the thick darkness (for the shutters were close fastened, through fear of robbers), and so I knew that he could not see the opening of the door, and I kept pushing it on steadily, steadily.

I had my head in, and was about to open the lantern, when my thumb slipped upon the tin fastening, and the old man sprang up in the bed, crying out—"Who's there?"

I kept quite still and said nothing. For a whole hour I did not move a muscle, and in the meantime I did not hear him lie down. He was still sitting up in the bed listening—just as I have done, night after night, hearkening to the deathwatches³ in the wall.

Presently I heard a slight groan, and I knew it was the groan of mortal terror. It was not a groan of pain or of grief—oh, no!—it was the low stifled sound that arises from the bottom of the soul when overcharged with awe. I knew the sound well. Many a night, just at midnight, when all the world slept, it has welled up from my own bosom, deepening, with its dreadful echo, the terrors that distracted me. I say I knew it well. I knew what the old man felt, and pitied him, although I chuckled at heart. I knew that he had been lying awake ever since the first

² sagacity (sə gas'ə tē): intelligence and good judgment.

³ deathwatches: small insects, especially certain beetles, whose heads make a tapping sound. Superstitious people believe this noise is a sign of death.

slight noise, when he had turned in the bed. His fears had been ever since growing upon him. He had been trying to fancy them causeless, but could not. He had been saying to himself—"It is nothing but the wind in the chimney—it is only a mouse crossing the floor," or "it is merely a cricket which has made a single chirp." Yes, he has been trying to comfort himself with these suppositions; but he had found all in vain. *All in vain*; because Death, in approaching him, had stalked with his black shadow before him, and enveloped the victim. And it was the mournful influence of the unperceived shadow that caused him to feel—although he neither saw nor heard—to *feel* the presence of my head within the room.

When I had waited a long time, very patiently, without hearing him lie down, I resolved to open a little—a very, very little crevice in the lantern. So I opened it—you cannot imagine how stealthily, stealthily—until, at length, a single dim ray, like the thread of a spider, shot from out the crevice and fell upon the vulture eye.

It was open—wide, wide open—and I grew furious as I gazed upon it. I saw it with perfect distinctness—all a dull blue, with a hideous veil over it that chilled the very marrow in my bones; but I could see nothing else of the old man's face or person; for I had directed the ray as if by instinct, precisely upon the damned spot.

And now have I not told you that what you mistake for madness is but over-acuteness of the senses? Now, I say, there came to my ears a low, dull, quick sound, such as a watch makes when enveloped in cotton. I knew *that* sound well too. It was the beating of the old man's heart. It increased my fury, as the beating of a drum stimulates the soldier into courage.

But even yet I refrained and kept still. I scarcely breathed. I held the lantern motionless. I tried how stead-

ily I could maintain the ray upon the eye. Meantime the hellish tattoo of the heart increased. It grew quicker and quicker, and louder and louder every instant. The old man's terror *must* have been extreme! It grew louder, I say, louder every moment! Do you mark me well? I have told you that I am nervous: so I am. And now at the dead hour of the night, amid the dreadful silence of that old house, so strange a noise as this excited me to uncontrollable terror. Yet, for some minutes longer I refrained and stood still. But the beating grew louder, louder! I thought the heart must burst. And now a new anxiety seized me—the sound would be heard by a neighbor! The old man's hour had come! With a loud yell, I threw open the lantern and leaped into the room. He shrieked once—once only. In an instant I dragged him to the floor, and pulled the heavy bed over him. I then smiled gaily, to find the deed so far done. But, for many minutes, the heart beat on with a muffled sound. This, however, did not vex me; it would not be heard through the wall. At length it ceased. The old man was dead. I removed the bed and examined the corpse. Yes, he was stone, stone dead. I placed my hand upon the heart and held it there many minutes. There was no pulsation. He was stone dead. His eye would trouble me no more.

If still you think me mad, you will think so no longer when I describe the wise precautions I took for the concealment of the body. The night waned, and I worked hastily, but in silence. First of all I dismembered the corpse. I cut off the head and the arms and the legs.

I then took up three planks from the flooring of the chamber, and deposited all between the scantlings.⁴ I then replaced the boards so cleverly, so cunningly, that no

⁴ scantlings: small crosspieces of wood.

human eye—not even *his*—could have detected anything wrong. There was nothing to wash out—no stain of any kind—no bloodspot whatever. I had been too wary for that. A tub had caught all—ha! ha!

When I had made an end of these labors, it was four o'clock—still dark as midnight. As the bell sounded the hour, there came a knocking at the street door. I went down to open it with a light heart—for what had I *now* to fear? There entered three men, who introduced themselves, with perfect suavity, as officers of the police. A shriek had been heard by a neighbor during the night; suspicion of foul play had been aroused; information had been lodged at the police office, and they (the officers) had been deputed to search the premises.

I smiled—for *what* had I to fear? I bade the gentlemen welcome. The shriek, I said, was my own in a dream. The old man, I mentioned, was absent in the country. I took my visitors all over the house. I bade them search—search *well*. I led them, at length, to *his* chamber. I showed them his treasures, secure, undisturbed. In the enthusiasm of my confidence, I brought chairs into the room, and desired them *here* to rest from their fatigues, while I myself, in the wild audacity⁵ of my perfect triumph, placed my own seat upon the very spot beneath which reposed the corpse of the victim.

The officers were satisfied. My *manner* had convinced them. I was singularly at ease. They sat, and while I answered cheerily, they chatted familiar things. But, ere long, I felt myself getting pale and wished them gone. My head ached, and I fancied a ringing in my ears: but still they sat and still chatted. The ringing became more distinct—it continued and became more distinct: I talked

⁵ audacity (ô das' tē): bold courage; daring.

more freely to get rid of the feeling: but it continued and gained definitiveness—until, at length, I found that the noise was *not* within my ears.

No doubt I now grew *very* pale—but I talked more fluently, and with a heightened voice. Yet the sound increased—and what could I do? It was a *low, dull, quick sound—much such a sound as a watch makes when enveloped in cotton*. I gasped for breath—and yet the officers heard it not. I talked more quickly—more vehemently; but the noise steadily increased. I arose and argued about trifles, in a high key and with violent gesticulations,⁶ but the noise steadily increased. Why *would* they not be gone? I paced the floor to and fro with heavy strides, as if excited to fury by the observation of the men—but the noise steadily increased. Oh God! what *could* I do? I foamed—I raved—I swore! I swung the chair upon which I had been sitting, and grated it upon the boards, but the noise arose over all and continually increased. It grew louder—louder—*louder!* And still the men chatted pleasantly, and smiled. Was it possible they heard not? Almighty God!—no, no! They heard!—they suspected!—they *knew!*—they were making a mockery of my horror!—this I thought, and this I think. But anything was better than this agony! Anything was more tolerable than this derision!⁷ I could bear those hypocritical smiles no longer! I felt that I must scream or die!—and now—again!—hark! louder! louder! louder! *louder!*—

“Villains!” I shrieked, “dissemble⁸ no more! I admit the deed!—tear up the planks!—here, here!—it is the beating of his hideous heart!”

⁶ gesticulations (jes tik' yə lā' shānz); gestures; movements of the hands and arms.

⁷ derision (di rizh'ən): mockery; ridicule.

⁸ dissemble (di sem'b'l): pretend.

“The Tell-Tale Heart” **by Edgar Allan Poe**

Define the following words as they are used in the text and give a synonym for each.
(20)

Evil Eye (107)	profound (107)	suppositions (109)	unperceived (109)
over-acuteness (109)	tattoo (110)	dismembered (110)	manner (111)
vehemently (112)	trifles (112)		

Questions for “The Tell-Tale Heart” (27)

First-person narrators are notoriously unreliable. Think about the narrator in this story as you respond to the questions below. When possible, provide evidence from the story in the form of a direct quote to support your responses.

1. For what reason do you believe the narrator is telling the story? (3)
2. Discuss the reliability of the narrator and provides examples where he is reliable and unreliable. (6)
3. Provide evidence a lawyer might use to prove the narrator is mad. (6)
4. Provide evidence the narrator might use in an effort to prove he's sane. (6)
5. Poe wrote with the intention of producing an intense effect in the reader. Characterize the effect you believe the author intended. What in the story supports your idea? (6)

The Tell-Tale Heart Drawing Activity (10)

You work for a newspaper as the staff's artist. One of your coworkers comes to you with a great story on Edgar Allen Poe's "The Tell-Tale Heart" and asks you to illustrate it. For this news assignment, you must do the following:

- Choose a memorable scene from the story (example: the murder scene, the confession scene, etc.) and illustrate it in color. (3)
- Give an explanation of the picture – what is happening in this scene? Be as specific as possible. (5)
- Finally, you must include two kinds of figurative language, which you come up with on your own, to make your description more interesting (choose two: alliteration, onomatopoeia, metaphor, simile, idiom, and personification) (2)

The Tell-Tale Heart
Edgar Allan Poe
Closing Arguments Assignment

After reading the short story, decide if the protagonist is a male or female based on details from the text and then determine if the narrator is guilty or not guilty of **first degree murder**.

Assignment:

Assume you are a lawyer in this case, either prosecution or defense, and compose your side's closing arguments to the jury. Your speech must be organized, persuasive and outline a minimum of three strong arguments to support your case. Cite evidence from the story to convince members of the jury (our class) to vote in your favour.

Evaluation:

Closing Arguments Rubric

Teacher: Ms. Powell

Student Name and Class: _____

CATEGORY	4 Excellent	3 Proficient	2 Satisfactory	1 Limited
Vocal Expression (Inflection, fluency, volume) x1	An engaging vocal performance.	A confident vocal performance.	An inconsistent vocal performance.	An ineffective vocal performance.
Preparedness X1	Student is completely prepared and has obviously rehearsed. Between 1:45 to 2:00 minutes in length.	Student is significantly prepared and adequate rehearsal is evident. Between 1:30 and 1:44 minutes	The student is adequately prepared with some rehearsal evident. Between 1 and 1:29 minutes in length.	Student is minimally prepared with no evidence of rehearsal. Less than one minute or more than 2 minutes.
Persuasiveness X1	Convincingly supported your side of the case. Very persuasive.	Thoroughly supported your side of the case. Reasonably persuasive.	Adequately supported your side of the case. Partially persuasive.	Superficially supported your side of the case. Not persuasive.